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National & States Affairs

News - 1

- Minister of Civil Aviation – unveiled 2nd phase of rankings for 'Flying Training Organisations (FTOs)'
  - Compiled by – Directorate General of Civil Aviation (Ministry of Civil Aviation)
- Avyanna Aviation Pvt. Ltd. – only institute to achieve top 'A' category
- Training flying hours – increased to 50% (from 32%)
- Number of Commercial Pilot Licences (CPLs) issued – grown more than 2.5 times over past 8 years
- Minister of Civil Aviation: Kinjarapu Rammohan Naidu | Constituency – Srikakulam, Andhra Pradesh
  MoS in Ministry of Civil Aviation: Murlidhar Mohol

News - 2

- CCIC (MoT) – launched its inaugural heritage designer collection titled "Soul Threads"
- Aim: To provide a prestigious platform for leading designers, artisans & cultural performers
- Exclusive exhibition – to be held from April 24th to May 10th 2026, at Jawahar Vyapar Bhawan, Janpath, New Delhi
- HQs of CCIC – New Delhi | Chairman – Akhilesh Kumar

News - 3

- Bengaluru Police – introduced an AI-powered multilingual feature in its "Namma 112" emergency helpline
  - becoming the first police unit in India to deploy such a system
- The new initiative removes language barriers by supporting over 10 Indian & foreign languages
  - Bengali, Malayalam, Gujarati, Odia, Manipuri, Assamese, Kashmiri, Nepali, as well as French, Spanish, & Arabic
- Developed in collaboration with = Monday Ventures + Aeos
- System utilises multilingual **V**oice **A**I for **N**ationwide **K**ey **I**nterventions (VANKI) for communication in multiple languages

News - 4

- Maharashtra – approved "Maharashtra Artificial Intelligence (AI) Policy 2026" to position state as national AI hub
  - Targets – ₹10,000 Cr investment & 1.5 lakh jobs by 2031
- Maharashtra AI Mission + 5 AI innovation cities + 6 sectoral CoE = to be set up
- 7 pillars – Infrastructure, Data Ecosystem, Skilling, Innovation, Startup Support, Sectoral Deployment, Governance
- Compute infrastructure – 2,000+ GPUs under 'compute-as-a-service' model for govt departments
- Datasets in Marathi, regional & tribal languages | State AI Data Exchange linked with national platforms
- 'Maharashtra Centre for Advanced AI Training' via industry-academia partnerships | Target: 2 lakh youth & professionals
- 20% subsidy for AI adoption for 5,000 MSMEs | ₹500 Cr AI startup fund (govt + private equal share)
- Startup ecosystem – Maha AI Tools Hub | 12 AI incubators | grants up to ₹1 Cr (₹1.25 Cr for women-led) | target: at least 1 AI unicorn

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- Sectoral focus – Healthcare, Agri., Education, Urban Development, Marathi language & Culture, Finance & Revenue
- Maharashtra: Capital – Mumbai | CM – Devendra Fadnavis | Governor – Jishnu Dev Varma

News - 5

- India – deployed its flagship "Aarogya Maitri" portable healthcare infrastructure in Jamaica
  - marking a new chapter in humanitarian diplomacy and South-South cooperation under the broader framework of India-CARICOM (Caribbean Community) engagement
- Coordinated under – India's "Humanitarian Assistance and Disaster Relief (HADR)" framework
- Guided by – National Security Council Secretariat (NSCS) | Executed in close coordination with – MEA
- Key partners in on-ground implementation – RailTel & Green Genome India Pvt Ltd
- Core system – "BHISHM Cube" (**B**harat **H**ealth **I**nitiative for **S**ahyog **H**ita & **M**aitri), comprising 72 transportable mini cubes
- Technology includes – RFID-based inventory management, AI-enabled coordination, and 180-language digital support
- Nodal agency – HLL Lifecare Ltd (Thiruvananthapuram, Kerala) for sourcing the BHISHM Cube

News - 6

- Mizoram – launched "Khuarel" mobile application, a real-time disaster incident reporting & management system
  - To enhance coordination & information flow during emergencies
- Mizoram – among 1st in Northeast to adopt such an advanced digital solution for disaster management
- Mizoram: Capital – Aizawl | CM – Lalduhoma | Governor – General V. K. Singh

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News - 7

- Nitin Gadkari – launched India's 1st Multi-Lane Free Flow (MLFF) barrier-less tolling system
  - At – Chorayasi Toll Plaza on Surat-Bharuch section of NH-48 in Gujarat
- MLFF system – began in July 2025
- Indian Highways Management Company + ICICI Bank = to implement MLFF tolling system at Choryasi Fee Plaza
- HQs of IHMCL – Delhi | CMD – Vishal Chauhan | Established in – 2012
- HQs of ICICI Bank – Mumbai, MH | MD & CEO – Sandeep Bakhshi | Taglines – "Hum Hain Na!" & "Khayal Apka"

News - 8

- Sikkim – declared India's 1st paperless judiciary state by CJI Surya Kant
  - During – National Conclave on Technology & Judicial Education (held in Gangtok)
  - Organised by – High Court of Sikkim & Sikkim Judicial Academy
- Sikkim: Capital – Gangtok | CM – Prem Singh Tamang | Governor – Om Prakash Mathur

Join us

News - 9

- Ministry of Communications – launched "Cell Broadcast System (CBS)", an indigenous technology developed by C-DOT
  - in collaboration = National Disaster Management Authority + Ministry of Home Affairs
- Aim: To strengthen India's emergency communication systems and enhance public safety infrastructure
- It is already deployed in disaster situations in states like – Andhra Pradesh, Odisha, & Uttarakhand
- CBS integrated with the Common Alerting Protocol (CAP)-based 'SACHET' platform, India's Integrated Alert System
- Currently, India is using an SMS-based alert system, which is operational across all 36 states & UTs
- Minister of Communications: Jyotiraditya M. Scindia | Constituency – Guna, Madhya Pradesh
  MoS in Ministry of Communications: Dr. Chandra Sekhar Pemmasani

News - 10

- CCEA – approved development of state-of-the-art Ship Repair Facility at Vadinar, Gujarat
- Investment – ₹1,570 Cr | To be implemented by = Deendayal Port Authority + Cochin Shipyard Ltd
- Facility Features – 650-metre jetty, 2 large floating dry docks, workshops, & associated marine infrastructure
- It will repair vessels up to 300 metres in length, addressing the gap in India's ship repair infrastructure
  - Objective – Reduce dependence on foreign shipyards (Dubai, Singapore, Bahrain, Colombo)
- Market Potential – India holds <1% of global ship repair market despite 7-9% of global maritime traffic passing within 300 nautical miles of its coastline
- The facility is expected to handle 34 ships per year

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News - 11

- BIS – Published 6 new standards for medical assistive technologies under the National List of Essential Assistive Products (NLEAP) initiative by ICMR
- Standards:
  - IS 18558 (Part 1): 2025 – Elbow crutches
  - IS 5145: 2026 – Walking sticks
  - IS 18558 (Part 4): 2025 – Multi-leg walking sticks (3+ legs)
  - IS 19631: 2026 – Portable ramps for wheelchair users & persons pushing wheeled objects
  - IS 19189: 2025 – Accessible tactile guide maps for visually impaired individuals
  - IS 17685: 2021 – Braille on signage, equipment, & appliances
- Developed through consensus of technical experts from – ALIMCO, ICMR, & Pandit Deendayal Upadhyaya National Institute for Persons with Physical Disabilities
- Objective – Support 'Accessible India Campaign (Sugamya Bharat Abhiyaan)' by DEPwD
- HQs of BIS – Manek Bhawan, Old Delhi | Director General – Sanjay Garg

Join us

News - 12

- CCEA approved FRP of sugarcane for Sugar Season 2026-27 (Oct-Sep) – Rs 365/qtl for a basic recovery rate of 10.25%
  - Providing a premium of Rs 3.56/qtl for each 0.1% increase in recovery over & above 10.25%
  - Reduction in FRP by Rs 3.56/qtl for each 0.1% decrease in recovery
- Government also decided that there shall not be any deduction in case of sugar mills where recovery is below 9.5%
  - Such farmers will get Rs 338.3/qtl for sugarcane in ensuing sugar season 2026-27
- Cost of production (A2 +FL) of sugarcane for Sugar Season 2026-27 – Rs 182/qtl
- FRP – determined on basis of recommendations of CACP

News - 13

- Cabinet approved 2 more semiconductor projects under 'India Semiconductor Mission (ISM)'
  - India's 1st commercial Mini/Micro-LED display facility based on GaN (Gallium Nitride) Technology
  - A semiconductor packaging facility
- These proposals will set up semiconductor manufacturing facilities in Gujarat | Total investment – Rs 3,936 Cr
- Crystal Matrix Ltd – to establish integrated facility for compound semiconductor fabrication & ATMP in Dholera, Gujarat
  - For manufacturing Mini/Micro-LED display modules
- Annual proposed production capacity for: Mini/Micro-LED Display Panels – 72,000 sq. meters
  - Mini-Micro-LED GaN Epitaxy Wafers – 24,000 sets of RGB wafers
- Suchi Semicon Private Ltd – to set up an Outsourced Semiconductor Assembly and Test (OSAT) facility in Surat, Gujarat
  - For manufacturing discrete semiconductors
- Proposed production capacity of Suchi Semicon – 1033.20 million chips per annum
- Now, total number of approved projects under ISM – 12 | Total investments – Rs 1.64 lakh Cr

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News - 14

- Union govt notified creation of a new zonal railway, South Coast Railway, with HQs at Visakhapatnam, w.e.f. Jun 1, 2026
- It has been carved out of existing East Coast Railway (ECoR) & South-Central Railway (SCR) zones under sub-section (4) of Section 3 of Railways Act, 1989
- This notification also constitutes a new Rayagada division under East Coast Railway from same date
- South Coast Railway (SCoR) will comprise existing Guntakal, Guntur & Vijayawada divisions of SCR & a truncated Waltair division of ECoR
- ECoR (HQs at Bhubaneswar) – to retain Sambalpur division, reorganised Khurda Road division & Rayagada division
- SCoR (HQs at Secunderabad) – to retain Hyderabad & Nanded divisions along with Secunderabad division
- Central Govt also adjusted jurisdictions of Guntur, Guntakal & Vijayawada divisions of SCoR & Secunderabad division of SCR with transfer of sections, w.e.f. Jun 1, 2026

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News - 15

- MoP revised its "Make in India" procurement norms for power sector
  - It introduces a phased roadmap to achieve 60% minimum local content (MLC) in HVDC Substations
- MLC – refers to how much of a project must be sourced/manufactured within India
- Minister of Power: Manohar Lal Khattar | Constituency – Karnal, Haryana

  MoS in Ministry of Power: Shripad Yesso Naik

News - 16

- NITI Aayog – launched "Central Prabhari Officer (CPO) Portal"
- Aim: To strengthen real-time governance, improve coordination among stakeholders & accelerate last-mile delivery under 'Aspirational Districts and Blocks Programme (ADP/ABP)'
- CPO Portal – to allow Central Prabhari Officers (CPOs) to submit observations & recommendations directly from field using mobile devices in real time
- HQs of NITI Aayog – New Delhi | CEO – Nidhi Chhibber | Chair – Narendra Modi | VC – Ashok Lahiri

News - 17

- MoH&FW – released "Rashtriya Bal Swasthya Karyakram (RBSK) 2.0 Guidelines"
- It broadens established 4Ds approach – Defects at Birth, Diseases, Deficiencies & Developmental Delays
- Minister of Health & Family Welfare: Jagat Prakash Nadda | Constituency – Gujarat

  MoS in Ministry of Health & Family Welfare: Jadhav Prataprao Ganpatrao & Anupriya Singh Patel

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News - 18

- Under framework of India-EU Trade & Technology Council-Working Group 2 on Green & Clean Energy Technologies:
- GoI & EU – announced launch of a 3rd coordinated call for proposals focused on Recycling of EV Batteries
  - Submission deadline – Sep 15, 2026
- Aim: To secure critical raw materials, accelerate global transition to a circular economy & strengthen bilateral relations
- Combined funding pool – €15.2 million | It will be funded through – EU's 'Horizon Europe' programme
  - Ministry of Heavy Industries – to support Indian component
- HQs of EU – Brussels, Belgium | Member Countries – 27

  President of European Parliament – Roberta Metsola

  President of European Council – António Costa

  President of European Commission – Ursula von der Leyen

Join us

News - 19

- JP Nadda – launched "Swasth Bharat Portal"
  - during 10th 'National Summit on Innovation & Inclusivity: Best Practices Shaping India's Health Future' in Chandigarh
- Developed by – Ministry of Health and Family Welfare (MoHFW)
- The portal brings multiple national health programmes onto a single interface, eliminating the need for multiple logins
- The system is compliant with 'Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission (ABDM)' and supports integration with 'ABHA'
- It also integrates with national registries such as Healthcare Professionals Registry (HPR) & Health Facility Registry (HFR)
- Minister of Health & Family Welfare: Jagat Prakash Nadda | Constituency – Gujarat
  MoS in Ministry of Health & Family Welfare: Jadhav Prataprao Ganpatrao & Anupriya Singh Patel

News - 20

- MoH&FW launched 'JANANI' (Journey of Antenatal, Natal & Neonatal Integrated Care), service-oriented digital platform
  - At 10th 'National Summit on Innovation and Inclusivity: Best Practices Shaping India's Health Future' – in New Delhi
- Aim: To comprehensively monitor & maintain digital health records of women during their reproductive years
- It is developed as an upgraded version of existing Reproductive and Child Health (RCH) portal
- It is integrated with – 'U-WIN' (India's digital immunisation platform) & 'POSHAN Abhiyaan' (India's nutrition mission)
- Minister of Health & Family Welfare: Jagat Prakash Nadda | Constituency – Gujarat
  MoS in Ministry of Health & Family Welfare: Jadhav Prataprao Ganpatrao & Anupriya Singh Patel

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News - 21

- Gujarat initiated "Battery Energy Storage Systems (BESS)" at 5 locations across state with a total capacity of 870 MW
  - 4 systems operational at – Modhera (Mehsana) & Lakhpat (Kutch)
  - A recently commissioned system at – Charal (Sanand taluka of Ahmedabad)
- Modhera (India's first solar village) – also launched country's first BESS integrated with a solar power plant
- Gujarat registered 13 additional projects across Ahmedabad, Gandhinagar, Banaskantha, Patan & Kutch districts
  - For setting up further battery storage systems
- Gujarat also included advanced energy storage systems as a key component in 'Gujarat Integrated Renewable Energy Policy, 2025'
- Gujarat: Capital – Gandhinagar | CM – Bhupendra Patel | Governor – Acharya Dev Vrat

News - 22

- Central Government notified final rules under all 4 labour codes through 30+ Gazette notifications
  - Fully operationalising new labour framework & consolidating 29 existing labour laws into 4 unified codes
- 4 codes are: "Code on Wages, 2019" | "Industrial Relations Code, 2020"
  - "Code on Social Security, 2020" | "Occupational Safety, Health and Working Conditions (OSHWC) Code, 2020"
- Draft rules were published on – Dec 30, 2025

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- Key provisions across codes include:
  - Weekly working hours – capped at 48 hours (daily flexibility up to 12 hours per day & daily wage workers 8-hour normal working days)
  - Overtime wages – fixed at twice normal rate | Mandatory issuance of appointment letters to all workers
  - Free annual health check-ups for workers aged 40 years & above | At least one weekly rest day
  - Equal work, equal pay & equal opportunity for women across different shifts
- Under Social Security (Central) Rules, 2025, Aadhaar-linked registration of every unorganised worker aged above 16 years is mandatory
- Under Occupational Safety, Health & Conditions (Central) Rules, 2026, government allowed for electronic application for single licence for contractors working in more than one state or for whole country
  - Approval or disapproval – to be granted within 45 days
- For women workers, who have been allowed to work in night shift, consent has to be taken by employers in writing

News - 23

- PM Modi made 7 appeals to citizens centred on guiding principle of "Nation First, Duty Above Comfort"
  - While addressing a BJP public meeting at Secunderabad Parade Grounds in Hyderabad on May 10, 2026
- 7 appeals are:

(1) Reduce petrol & diesel consumption by using metro & public transport
(2) Avoid foreign travel for 1 year & choose domestic tourism instead
(3) Avoid non-essential gold purchases for 1 year to reduce pressure on foreign exchange outflows
(4) Reduce edible oil consumption by every household
(5) Reduce dependence on imported chemical fertilisers & transition towards natural farming
(6) Embrace 'Vocal for Local' by prioritising Made-in-India & locally manufactured products
(7) Revive work-from-home practices, with both government & private offices encouraging remote work

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News - 24

- JP Nadda & Shivraj Chouhan = launched "SEHAT Mission" in Delhi
  - SEHAT – Science Excellence for Health through Agricultural Transformation
- Jointly launched by = Indian Council of Agricultural Research (ICAR) & Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR)
- Delhi: CM – Rekha Gupta | Lt. Governor – Taranjit Singh Sandhu | Chief Secretary – Rajeev Verma

News - 25

- Suvendu Adhikari (WB CM) – chaired his maiden cabinet meeting on May 11, 2026, at state secretariat Nabanna
- Cabinet approved to transfer ~600 acres of pending land to BSF for fencing India-Bangladesh border
  - With process to be completed within 45 days under supervision of Chief Secretary
- As of early 2026, ~3,240 km to 3,243 km of 4,096.7 km India-Bangladesh border is fenced
- 5 Indian states share a total land border of ~4,096.7 km with Bangladesh
  - West Bengal, Tripura, Meghalaya, Mizoram & Assam

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- Cabinet approved immediate implementation of 'Ayushman Bharat' scheme in West Bengal
- Cabinet granted official sanction for immediate implementation of 'Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS)' in West Bengal
  - Replacing – Indian Penal Code (IPC) & Code of Criminal Procedure (CrPC)
- WB announced a 5-year age relaxation for candidates who had missed recruitment opportunities during previous years
- WB reversed an earlier policy restricting IAS/IPS officers from being sent outside state for Central Govt training
- West Bengal: Capital – Kolkata | CM – Suvendu Adhikari | Governor – R N Ravi

News - 26

- The notification by MoL&E has been formalised under Section 100(1) of 'Code on Social Security, 2020'
- Newly notified cess will be levied at 1% of total cost of construction incurred by employers engaged in building & other construction activities
- Revised notification & rules under new Social Security Code are part of Centre's broader labour reforms agenda
- MoL&E's Model Standing Orders, 2026, include a special provision of work from home for service industry
- Minister of Labour & Employment: Mansukh L. Mandaviya | Constituency – Porbandar, Gujarat
  MoS in Ministry of Labour & Employment: Shobha Karandlaje

News - 27

- Mizoram – launched "Mizoram Ginger Mission" to strengthen ginger cultivation, processing & global market access
  - Cost – Rs 189.79 Cr | Implemented under – Ministry of Development of North Eastern Region (DONER)
- Mission built on 4 pillars – Convergence, Value addition, Branding, & Market integration
- Thingpui & Thinglaidum ginger varieties (Mizoram) – received GI tags in 2021
- Mizoram: Capital – Aizawl | CM – Lalduhoma | Governor – General V. K. Singh

News - 28

- CCEA approved an increase in MSP for 14 Kharif crops for the marketing season 2026-27
- Estimated total payout to farmers will be – ₹2.6 lakh Cr
  - Procurement expected to reach approx 824 lakh metric tonnes across all Kharif crops
- Among all crops, the highest absolute increase in MSP was approved for – sunflower seed (₹622 per quintal)
- Latest MSPs (per quintal) of major food grains:
  - Paddy – ₹2,441 | Maize – ₹2,410 | Bajra – ₹2,900 | Ragi – ₹5,205 | Pulses – ₹8,195
  - Moong – ₹8,680 | Urad – ₹9,550
- Increases in MSP maintain the Govt's policy of ensuring at least 50% profit margin over the cost of production
- Revised MSPs align with the Union Budget 2018-19 principle of fixing MSP at 1.5 times the all-India weighted average cost of production

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News - 29

- NSO (MoSPI) – revised release date of Provisional Estimates (PE) of Annual GDP & Quarterly Estimates of GDP for 4th Quarter (Q4) from last working day of May to 7th June (or previous working day if 7th June is a holiday) of every year
- Revision in release schedule has been made after due consultation with Advisory Committee on National Accounts Statistics (ACNAS)
- Press Note on Provisional Estimates (PE) of GDP for FY26 & Quarterly Estimates of GDP for Q4 of FY26 – scheduled to be released on Jun 5, 2026
- HQs of NSO – New Delhi | Chairperson – Prof. Rajeeva Laxman Karandikar

News - 30

- GoI prohibited export of raw, white & refined sugar with immediate effect until Sep 30, 2026
  - Through a notification issued by Directorate General of Foreign Trade (DGFT)
- DGFT amended export policy for these sugar categories from 'restricted' to 'prohibited'
- India's domestic sugar consumption – estimated at ~28 million tonnes annually
- Sugar production in 2025-26 sugar season – reached 27.528 million tonnes as of Apr 30, 2026
- For 2025-26 sugar marketing year (Oct 2025 - Sep 2026), Food Ministry allowed 15 lakh tonnes of exports in Nov 2025
  - Later, quota was increased by 5 lakh tonnes to 20 lakh tonnes in Feb 2026
- If prohibition is not extended beyond Sep 30, 2026, export policy for these sugar categories will revert to 'restricted'

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News - 31

- DGFT introduced stricter monitoring & compliance rules for duty-free gold imports with immediate effect
  - Under – 'Advance Authorisation (AA)' scheme
- Gold imports – max. of 100 kgs per authorisation
- It inserted 5 new notes under Standard Input Output Norms (SIONs) M-1 to M-8 of Handbook of Procedures 2023 for gems & jewellery exports
- Advance Authorisation scheme permits exporters to import raw materials without paying customs duty
  - Provided imported material is used in manufacturing products destined for exports
- India – world's 2nd-largest gold consumer (after China)
- India imported gold worth $71.98 billion in FY26
  - Gold & silver imports (combined) – reached $102.5 billion (14% of India's total imports)
- HQs of DGFT – New Delhi | Director General – Lav Aggarwal

News - 32

- Cabinet approved extension of lease period of AAI's land leased to MIL (MIHAN India Ltd) beyond Aug 6, 2039
  - To enable MIL to license Nagpur Airport to Concessionaire, viz. GMR Nagpur International Airport Limited (GNIAL) for 30 years since Commercial Operation Date (COD)

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- With this extension, airport would now become co-terminus with 30-year concession period of GNIAL
- HQs of MIHAN India Ltd – Nagpur, Maharashtra | CMD – Dr. Vipin Itankar | Established in – 2009

News - 33

- Shivraj Singh Chouhan (Min. of RD) – announced a major rural development package for Maharashtra
  - Including Rs 8,368.50 Cr in central assistance under 'Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana-Gramin (PMAY-G)' for FY27
- He also inaugurated Griha Pravesh ceremony of 5 lakh completed rural houses in Satara
- He also handed over approval for 35 rural road projects under 'Pradhan Mantri Gram Sadak Yojana-IV' to MH CM
- He also announced that NAFED will procure onions at Rs 12.35 per kilogram from farmers of Maharashtra
- He also distributed awards under "Maha Awas Abhiyan" to districts, officials & units
- Minister of Rural Development: Shivraj Singh Chouhan | Constituency – Vidisha, Madhya Pradesh
  MoS in Ministry of Rural Development: Dr. Chandra Sekhar Pemmasani & Kamlesh Paswan

News - 34

- GoI felicitated Gujarat, Karnataka, Kerala, Nagaland & Rajasthan for integrating 'DigiLocker'
  - During – 'National Consultative Workshop on Strengthening Cybersecurity Frameworks for State Data'
- Initiative was led by – National e-Governance Division (NeGD)
- Percentage of services onboarded by states onto DigiLocker – Gujarat (65%), Karnataka (73%),
- Gujarat – also recognised for introducing digital disability certificates for availing free bus transport services
- Karnataka – highest number of DigiLocker accounts
- Rajasthan – rolled out 'Jan Aadhaar Family Register' through DigiLocker
- DigiLocker – a digitization service provided by MeitY under its 'Digital India' initiative

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News - 35

- Tripura – became 1st state in India to complete all Priority Areas under Deregulation Phase-II of the national 'Compliance Reduction and Deregulation' initiative
- With this, Tripura became 1st state to complete all 51 Priority Areas under Phase-I & Phase-II of the reform programme
  - 23 priority areas under Phase-I & 28 priority areas under Phase-II
  - The reforms were launched in Jan 2026
- Tripura launched a centralised e-Gazette system for unified digital access to Acts, Rules, Regulations & Govt Notifications
- An auto-appeal mechanism under the 'Right to Services' framework was also introduced
- Tripura: Capital – Agartala | CM – Manik Saha | Governor – Indra Sena Reddy Nallu

Join us

News - 36

- Karnataka – introduced 2 separate digital systems:
  1. to automatically block the sale of medicines found to be Not of Standard Quality (NSQ)
     - Once a drug batch is declared NSQ, it will be uploaded into the system & immediately locked
     - Alerts will be sent instantly to wholesalers & distributors across the State
     - The portal will also provide real-time data on stock availability, stock-in-hand, & quantities returned to suppliers
  2. to track dispensing of drugs covered under the Narcotic Drugs and Psychotropic Substances (NDPS) Act
     - It focuses on medicines regulated under the NDPS Act, which are vulnerable to misuse & diversion
     - Retailers dispensing such medicines will now be required to mandatorily upload & verify patient details, doctor details and prescription info
- Karnataka: Capital – Bangalore | CM – Siddaramaiah | Governor – Thaawarchand Gehlot

News - 37

- CCEA approved the Ahmedabad (Sarkhej) - Dholera Semi High-Speed Double Line project of Ministry of Railways
  - Total cost – Rs 20,667 Cr | It will be the Indian Railways 1st semi high-speed project
- Gujarat: Capital – Gandhinagar | CM – Bhupendra Patel | Governor – Acharya Dev Vrat

News - 38

- CBI – launched "Abhay", an AI-based Helpbot for Authentication of CBI Notices
  - to help citizens verify the authenticity of official notices & protect themselves from cyber fraud & digital arrest scams
- 'Abhay' provides real-time verification of notices claiming to be from the agency
- HQs of CBI – New Delhi | Director – Praveen Sood | Motto – "Industry, Impartiality, Integrity"

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News - 39

- India – released the country's first-ever satellite-tagged Ganges softshell turtle into the Brahmaputra River at Kaziranga National Park & Tiger Reserve in Assam
- The historic release coincided with 'Endangered Species Day' on May 15
- Ganges softshell turtle (Nilssonia gangetica) – a large freshwater turtle native to the Indus, Ganga, Mahanadi, and Brahmaputra river systems in South Asia (belonging to the family Trionychidae)
  - It is listed as 'Endangered' in IUCN Red List
- Assam – recognized globally as an extremely critical habitat for freshwater biodiversity
  - The state plays host to 21 of India's turtle species
- Assam: Capital – Dispur | CM – Himanta Biswa Sarma | Governor – Lakshman Prasad Acharya

Join us

News - 40

- Goods and Services Tax Appellate Tribunal – formally constituted benches across India & notified a detailed framework for categorisation, scrutiny & listing of appeals
  - GSTAT – established under Section 109 of 'Central Goods and Services Tax Act 2017'
- GSTAT operates as a two-tiered structure with a Principal Bench located in New Delhi & multiple State Benches
  - With each bench comprising 2 Judicial Members, one Technical Member (Centre) & one Technical Member (State)

News - 41

- N Chandrababu Naidu (AP CM) – announced direct cash incentive of ₹30,000 on birth of 3rd child & ₹40,000 for 4th child
- Aim: To reverse state's declining birth rate & counter a looming aging population crisis
- AP's Total Fertility Rate (TFR) – dropped to 1.5 | National replacement level – 2.1
- Andhra Pradesh: Capital – Amaravati | CM – N Chandra Babu Naidu | Governor – Syed Abdul Nazeer

News - 42

- Ministry of Education – unveiled a new pilot programme, a targeted intervention
  - Aim: To reintegrate over 2 Cr out-of-school adolescents aged 14-18 back into the education system
- Chaired by – Sanjay Kumar (Secretary of Department of School Education & Literacy)
- The initiative launches in 10 high-concentration districts across 9 States/UTs:
  - Bihar, Chhattisgarh, Delhi, Gujarat, Karnataka, Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra, & Odisha
- Ground teams will map out-of-school children & track their learning progress digitally
- This policy response tackles a critical drop-out trend in Secondary Education
  - According to a data: only 62 out of every 100 students entering Class I manage to reach Class XII
- NEP 2020 target: achieving a 100% Gross Enrolment Ratio (GER) by 2030
- Minister of Education: Dharmendra Pradhan | Constituency – Sambalpur, Odisha
  MoS in Ministry of Education: Jayant Chaudhary & Sukanta Majumdar

News - 43

- NHAI + Vertis Foundation = launched "Project Saksham" to empower rural women & underserved youth
- HQs of NHAI – New Delhi | Chairman – Santosh Kumar Yadav | Founded in – 1988
- HQs of Vertis Infrastructure Trust – Mumbai | Joint CEOs – Gaurav Chandna & Dr. Zafar Khan | Established in – 2021

News - 44

- Himanta Biswa Sarma – inaugurated India's 1st AI-powered 'phygital' banking branch of Slice SFB at GS Road in Guwahati
- Assam: Capital – Dispur | CM – Himanta Biswa Sarma | Governor – Lakshman Prasad Acharya

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News - 45

- Om Birla (Lok Sabha Speaker) – constituted 'Committee on Empowerment of Women'
  - Chairperson – Dr Daggubati Purandeswari (BJP MP from Lok Sabha)
  - It comprises 18 members from Lok Sabha & 10 members from Rajya Sabha
- Members include: Hema Malini, Harsimrat Kaur Badal & Iqra Choudhary (from Lok Sabha)
  - Sudha Murty, PT Usha & Swati Maliwal (from Rajya Sabha)

News - 46

- Bhopal (MP) – installed India's 1st solar-powered 'Algae Tree' at Swami Vivekananda Park
  - Inaugurated by Vishwas Sarang (MP Cabinet Minister) as part of 'Bhopal Smart City project'
  - Developed by – Mushroom World Group
- 3-metre-tall unit operates on a photo-bioreactor system & has a 1.5-tonne annual carbon dioxide absorption capacity
- It is designed to reduce PM2.5 particulate matter by 45-55% within a 15-metre radius

News - 47

- Jyotiraditya Scindia (Min. of Com.&DoNER) – participated in Sikkim's 51st Statehood Day celebrations on May 16, 2026
- 21 development projects (supported by MoDoNER) – inaugurated & had foundation stones laid | Worth – ₹223 Cr
- Key highlight: "Mission Sikkim Organics" – launched as State's Unique Selling Proposition (USP)
  - It is an ambitious convergence-led initiative to transform Sikkim from a certified organic producer into a globally integrated premium organic economy
  - Outlay – ₹360 Cr
  - Anchored by – MDoNER + Sikkim govt + APEDA + NABARD + NERAMAC + SIOL + FPOs + Cooperatives + Pvt stakeholders
- MDoNER will contribute ₹85 Cr towards core infrastructure, aggregation systems & programme coordination
- Sikkim: Capital – Gangtok | CM – Prem Singh Tamang | Governor – Om Prakash Mathur

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News - 48

- India – nominated as Chair of "Common Criteria Development Board (CCDB)" from Apr 2026 to Apr 2028
- 1st Quarter Meeting of Common Criteria Recognition Arrangement (CCRA) – held in Tokyo, Japan (Apr 14-16, 2026)
- CCRA – foundational international treaty that enables mutual recognition of IT security certificates across borders
  - CCDB – serves as technical core of CCRA
- India has been an active member of CCRA since Sep 16, 2013, as a Certificate Authorizing Nation
  - India serves through MeitY & Standardisation Testing and Quality Certification (STQC) Directorate
- CCRA comprises 20 certificate-authorizing nations & 18 certificate-consuming nations

Join us

News - 49

- Indian Railways – approved Arakkonam-Chengalpattu doubling project (68 km) of Southern Railway at Rs 993 Cr
- HQs of Indian Railways – New Delhi | Chairman & CEO – Satish Kumar

News - 50

- Jyotiraditya M. Scindia – launched "Coffee Value Chain Development Mission" for Nagaland (Outlay - ₹175 Cr)
- The mission envisions 'Brand North East Coffees of Nagaland'
- Nagaland govt's aim: To expand coffee cultivation to 50,000 hectares by 2047 under the 'Viksit Nagaland' vision
- Nagaland: Capital – Kohima | CM – Neiphiu Rio | Governor – Ajay Kumar Bhalla (addi. charge)

News - 51

- BIS – notified fuel specifications for higher ethanol-blended petrol variants under the standard IS 19850:2026
  - covering E22, E25, E27 and E30 fuel blends
  - designating petrol blended with 22%, 25%, 27% & 30% anhydrous ethanol respectively
- India imports over 85% of its crude oil requirements
- HQs of BIS – Manek Bhawan, Old Delhi | Director General – Sanjay Garg

News - 52

- Prataprao Jadhav (MoS (I/C) for Ayush & H&FW) – launched "Ayush Anudan" Portal at Kartavya Bhawan, New Delhi
  - Developed by Ministry of Ayush under 'Ayush Grid' initiative | Integrated with – NGO Darpan Portal
  - To streamline submission, processing, approval & monitoring of funding proposals under various CSSs of Ministry
- NGO Darpan portal – accessible via Ministry's 'MAISP' (My Ayush Integrated Services Portal)
- MoS (I/C) in AYUSH: Jadhav Prataprao Ganpatrao | Constituency – Mehkar, Maharashtra

News - 53

- Jyotiraditya M. Scindia – launched Mission on "Arunachal Kiwi: The USP of Arunachal Pradesh" | Outlay – ₹167 Cr
- It is a cluster-based kiwi cultivation & value chain development initiative
- Anchored by – MoDoNER with MoA&FW, MoRD & MoFPI, NABARD, ICAR-CITH, APEDA, NERAMAC & private investors
- It adopts six integrated cluster-level Post-Harvest Management Hubs across Ziro Valley (Lower Subansiri), Dirang & Kalaktang (West Kameng), Shi Yomi, and Dibang Valley
- Arunachal Pradesh: Capital – Itanagar | CM – Pema Khandu | Governor – Lt. Gen. Kaiwalya Trivikram Parnaik

News - 54

- Anil Vij (Haryana Labour Minister) – launched "ShramMitra" mobile application, a digital platform
  - Developed by – Haryana Building & Other Construction Workers Welfare Board
  - To directly connect workers with employers & digitise unorganised labour market

Join us

- It operates in – Hindi, English & Punjabi | It is available on – Android & Apple devices
- Haryana: Capital – Chandigarh | CM – Nayab Singh Saini | Governor – Prof. Ashim Kumar Ghosh

News - 55

- Ministry of Social Justice & Empowerment – hosted a virtual programme on 'Creating a Well-Functioning Care Economy'
- Virendra Kumar (Minister) – launched "JEEVAN" mobile application for senior citizens & "SHATAYU" dashboard for geriatric caregivers
  - JEEVAN – Joint Elderly Empowerment & Virtual Assistance Network
  - SHATAYU – Senior Holistic Care Assistance and Training For Your Utility
- Minister of Social Justice & Empowerment: Dr. Virendra Kumar | Constituency – Tikamgarh, Madhya Pradesh
  MoS in Ministry of Social Justice & Empowerment: Ramdas Athawale & B. L. Verma

News - 56

- BDIA – launched "Bharat Digital Samvad" at New Delhi
  - It is India's 1st national forum on digital sovereignty & infrastructure policy
- Forum convened senior leaders from cloud, AI, cybersecurity & data sectors
- BDIA principle: 'Data Swaraj' - India's sovereign right over data collection, storage, governance & monetisation
- India's digital economy – projected to reach $1 trillion by 2030 (BDIA President Piyush Somani)
- HQs of BDIA – New Delhi | President – Piyush Somani | Secretary General – Abhishek Bhatt | Established in – 2026

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News - 57

- FCI announced plans to raise ₹50,000 Cr in short-term debt from scheduled banks for a 3-month tenure
  - With a green shoe option permitting additional borrowing of up to ₹25,000 Cr
  - Subject to a ceiling of ₹75,000 Cr total borrowings at any point of time
- Tenders for proposed borrowing are scheduled to open on May 22, with offers remaining valid through Aug 31
- Loans will be unsecured in nature; existing GoI guarantee of ₹6,000 Cr available for food credit to FCI will not cover these borrowings
- For 2026-27 marketing season, government set a wheat procurement goal of 34.49 million tonnes
- As of mid-May, FCI & various state agencies jointly procured ~22.97 million tonnes directly from farmers at MSP
  - Top contributor – Punjab (10.51 million tonnes) | 2nd – Madhya Pradesh (6.72 million tonnes)
- HQs of FCI – New Delhi | CMD – Rabindra Kumar Agarwal

News - 58

- Dr Jitendra Singh (MoS (I/C) for S&T) – launched "UMMID Programme" for rare genetic disorders/diseases
  - UMMID – **U**nique **M**ethods of **M**anagement of **I**nherited **D**isorders
- He also released 'UMMID Compendium' & launched 'UMMID Dashboard'

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- To strengthen nationwide access to diagnostics, counselling, outreach & monitoring for inherited disorders

- ~30 NIDAN Kendras – established to provide advanced diagnostics & counselling services beyond metropolitan centres
- MoS (I/C) in the Ministry of Science & Technology: Dr. Jitendra Singh | Constituency – Udhampur, J&K

News - 59

- MoH&FW notified inclusion of drug "Pregabalin" under Schedule H1 of 'Drugs Rules, 1945'
- It is prescribed for treatment of chronic pain, neuropathies, fibromyalgia & certain neurological conditions
- H1 prescription drug comes with a caution that:
  - It is dangerous to take this preparation except in accordance with medical advice
  - It cannot be sold by retail without prescription of a registered medical practitioner (RMP)
- Minister of Health & Family Welfare: Jagat Prakash Nadda | Constituency – Gujarat
  MoS in Ministry of Health & Family Welfare: Jadhav Prataprao Ganpatrao & Anupriya Singh Patel

News - 60

- An all-woman, 14-member mountaineering team of ITBP – scaled Mount Everest, world's highest peak (8,848 meters)
  - Via – South Col Route from Nepal side
- Expedition was flagged off from – ITBP Headquarters, New Delhi
- As part of ITBP's 'Clean Himalaya - Save Glacier' campaign, this team also carried out environmental awareness activities & collected non-biodegradable waste in Everest region
- ITBP now successfully conducted 232 mountaineering expeditions, including 5 successful Mt Everest summits
- ITBP also scaled 6 of world's fourteen 8,000-metre peaks – Mt Everest, Mt Kanchenjunga, Mt Makalu, Mt Lhotse, Mt Dhaulagiri & Mt Manaslu
- HQs of ITBP – New Delhi | DG – Shatrujeet Singh Kapoor | Established on – October 24, 1962

News - 61

- 'Legal Metrology (Government Approved Test Centre) Rules, 2013' – amended by Department of Consumer Affairs
  - To include verification of petrol, diesel, CNG, LPG, LNG & hydrogen dispensers
  - This move widened role of government-approved test centres (GATC)
- Aim: To enhance availability of verification services, improve efficiency & support growing adoption of cleaner fuels
- Until now, GATCs have handled 18 categories of weights & measures | Now, it has been increased to – 23
- Verification fee per nozzle for: Petrol & diesel dispensers – Rs 5,000 | CNG, LPG, LNG & hydrogen dispensers – Rs 10,000

News - 62

- Google – to bring its "Google AI Educator Series" to India | Announced at – 'Education World Forum 2026' in London
- Aim: To train school & higher education teachers on responsible use of AI tools in classrooms & academic settings
- Google will work with governments of Maharashtra, Chhattisgarh & Assam, Ladakh & Punjab School Education Board

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- To provide practical, mobile-first AI training for educators

- It will initially be localised into 6 Indian languages – Assamese, Hindi, Marathi, Telugu, Odia & Punjabi
- Google + MSDE + Chaudhary Charan Singh University = partnered to develop India's first AI-enabled state university (earlier in 2026)
- HQs of Google – California, US | CEO – Sundar Pichai | Founded in – 1998

News - 63

- Dr. Virendra Kumar (Min. for SJ&E) – launched "PM-AJAY Portal" & "AJAY Mobile App"
  - To digitise & strengthen implementation of 'Pradhan Mantri Anusuchit Jaati Abhyuday Yojana (PM-AJAY)' scheme
- PM-AJAY – a 100% Centrally Sponsored Scheme implemented since FY22 by Ministry of Social Justice & Empowerment
  - It was launched by merging 3 erstwhile schemes – Pradhan Mantri Adarsh Gram Yojana, Special Central Assistance to Scheduled Castes Sub Plan & Babu Jagjivan Ram Chhatrawas Yojana
  - Total budget outlay – ~₹2,050 Cr annually
- Minister of Social Justice & Empowerment: Dr. Virendra Kumar | Constituency – Tikamgarh, Madhya Pradesh
  MoS in Ministry of Social Justice & Empowerment: Ramdas Athawale & B. L. Verma

News - 64

- MeitY launched "Investors Support" portal under 'India Semiconductor Mission'
- Under 'Semicon India Programme', 12 fabrication & packaging projects & 24 semiconductor design projects have already been approved
- India Semiconductor Mission – launched in 2021 | Outlay – Rs 76,000 Cr
- Minister of Electronics & Information Technology: Ashwini Vaishnaw | Constituency – Odisha
  MoS in Ministry of Electronics & Information Technology: Jitin Prasada

News - 65

- GoI constituted a "High-Level Committee to study demographic changes arising from illegal immigration & other abnormal reasons"
- PM Modi announced 'High-powered Demography Mission' on Aug 15, 2025
  - Approved by Cabinet on – Sep 11, 2025 | Chairman – Justice Prakash Prabhakar Navlekar (Retired)
  - Member Secretary of Committee – Joint Secretary (Foreigners-I), Ministry of Home Affairs
  - 3 other members of Committee – Durga Shankar Mishra, Balaji Srivastava & Dr Shamika Ravi
- This Committee will submit its report within 1 year
- Proposed structure & Terms of Reference of Committee are:
  i) To comprehensively deliberate upon challenges arising from demographic changes
  ii) To study possible causes of such demographic changes, economic opportunities & other socio-environmental factors
  iii) To identify underlying factors behind these changes

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iv) To analyse structural population changes at level of religious or social communities

v) To recommend a streamlined & permanent operational mechanism

vi) To recommend an appropriate institutional mechanism

vii) To propose a comprehensive policy framework to enhance coordination between Central & State Governments

News - 66

- Jyotiraditya Scindia (Min. for DoNER) & Dr Manik Saha (Tripura CM) – launched "Tripura Mission Queen Pineapple"
  - It is a Rs 236 Cr convergence-led initiative for pineapple cultivation & value chain development in Tripura
  - It will be implemented for 3 years (Q2 FY26 to Q4 FY28) | Anchored by – MDoNER
- It builds upon convergence with schemes & interventions of MoA&FW, MoFPI, MoC&I, MoMSME, APEDA, DPIIT, ICAR, CSIR, TRIFED, NERAMAC & Government of Tripura
- Pineapple – 'State Fruit' of Tripura
- Tripura: Capital – Agartala | CM – Manik Saha | Governor – Indra Sena Reddy Nallu
- Minister of DoNER: Jyotiraditya M. Scindia | Constituency – Guna, Madhya Pradesh
  MoS in Ministry of DoNER: Sukanta Majumdar

News - 67

- SC Bench (Justices Manoj Misra & Manmohan) – constituted a committee to prepare a "Yamuna Action Plan"
- The committee will be headed by the Union Home Secretary
  - It will comprise the Chief Secretaries of all the States and UTs through which the Yamuna River flows
- The Bench gave them 8 weeks to come up with a comprehensive plan to clean up the river
- Yamuna serves as a lifeline for over 57 million people in the National Capital Region (NCR)

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News - 68

- DARPG – launched 'Portal for National e-Governance Service Delivery Assessment (NeSDA), 2025' to evaluate e-Governance service delivery effectiveness from citizen perspective
- NeSDA is a biennial assessment framework developed by DARPG
- NeSDA are classified into 2 categories:
  (i) State, UT, City and Central Ministry Portals
  (ii) State, UT, City and Central Ministry Service Portals
- Assessment – 59 mandatory services per State/UT | 43 services covering Central Ministries/Departments
- DARPG – works under the Ministry of Personnel, Public Grievances & Pensions

Join us

International Affairs

News - 69

- Donald Trump (US) – launched "Operation Project Freedom" to guide & escort stranded ships through Strait of Hormuz
- Objective – To address navigation crisis caused by Iran's blockade of the Strait of Hormuz during the 2026 Iran war
- Strait of Hormuz – 34 km wide passage, critical for 20 million barrels of oil transit per day (20% of global seaborne oil trade)
- India's Response – executing "Operation Urja Suraksha" since March 25, 2026, deploying 5 warships to escort Indian-flagged cargo ships in Gulf of Oman
- US – Washington, D.C. – US Dollar | 47th President – Donald Trump | 50th VP – James David Vance

News - 70

- EU included India in its revised draft list published for continued export of aquaculture products to EU market from Sep 2026 onwards
- European Commission Delegated Regulation (EU) 2023/905 mandates that animals & animal products exported to EU be free from antimicrobial medicinal products used for growth promotion & reserved for human medical treatment
- EU – India's 3rd-largest seafood export market during 2025-26 (18.94% of total seafood export value at $1.593 billion)
- HQs of EU – Brussels, Belgium | Member Countries – 27
  President of European Parliament – Roberta Metsola
  President of European Council – António Costa
  President of European Commission – Ursula von der Leyen

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News - 71

- Russia – successfully tested the "RS-28 Sarmat Intercontinental Ballistic Missile"
- RS-28 Sarmat, called "Satan II" in the West, has an expected range of over 10,000 km (6,200 miles)
  - Russia claims the range extends to more than 35,000 km (21,750 miles)
- The 35 meters (m)-long RS-28 Sarmat, which weighs over 208 tonnes, is liquid-fueled
- It replace Russia's SS-18 ICBM, which was 1st deployed under Soviet rule in 1970s & codenamed 'Satan' by NATO
- Russia maintains the world's largest inventory of nuclear warheads, with more than 5,500 (US – over 5,000 warheads)
- Russia – Moscow – Russian Ruble | PM – Mikhail Mishustin | President – Vladimir Putin

News - 72

- Netherlands – returned the historic 11th-century Chola dynasty copper plates to India
  - during PM Narendra Modi's official visit to The Hague, Netherlands
- The collection consists of 21 large & 3 small copper sheets
  - It is widely known in Europe as "Leiden Plates" & historically identified as 'Anaimangalam copper plates'

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- The text features royal charters written in both Sanskrit (5 plates) & Tamil (16 plates)
  - Plates weigh nearly 30 kg, bound together by a massive bronze ring carrying the imperial Chola dynasty seal
- The plates were taken from South India around 1712 by a Dutch missionary named Florentius Camper
  - They were donated to Leiden University in 1862 | Now, they will be managed by ASI in New Delhi
- Netherlands – Amsterdam – Euro | PM – Rob Arnoldus Adrianus Jetten (Rob Jetten)

News - 73

- India + Jamaica = signed 3 MoUs covering health cooperation, solarisation of Hugh Lawson Shearer Building, and broadcasting & media collaboration
- As part of health cooperation initiative, India handed over 10 BHISHM emergency medical units
  - BHISHM – Bharat Health Initiative for Sahyog, Hita & Maitri
- India increased ITEC training slots for defence training from 6 to 34
- Jamaica – Kingston – Jamaican Dollar | PM – Andrew Holness

News - 74

- WHO declared 'Ebola' outbreak in Democratic Republic of the Congo (DRC) & Uganda a "Public Health Emergency of International Concern" (PHEIC)
- Ebola spreads through direct contact with infected bodily fluids
  - It can cause fever, vomiting, diarrhoea, internal bleeding & organ failure
- Ebola is a viral disease first identified in 1976 near Ebola River in DRC
- HQs of WHO – Geneva, Switzerland | DG – Tedros Adhanom | Member Countries – 194 | Founded in – 1948

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News - 75

- India + Ethiopia = signed bilateral accession protocol in context of Ethiopia's accession to WTO in Geneva
- Protocol & its annexes – formally handed over & deposited with WTO Secretariat
- India – Ethiopia's 2nd-largest trading partner
- Ethiopia – Addis Ababa – Ethiopian Birr | President – Taye Atske Selassie | PM – Abiy Ahmed Ali

News - 76

- India + Italy = elevated their bilateral ties to a 'Special Strategic Partnership'
  - Both countries committed to expand bilateral trade to €20 billion annually by 2029
  - 'India-Italy Defence Industrial Roadmap' – focused on co-design, co-development & co-production of defence platforms in helicopters & naval systems
  - an MoU on critical minerals cooperation covering sourcing, processing, recycling & circular economy models for recovery of critical minerals from electronic waste & mining residues
  - reaffirmed support for 'India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor (IMEC)'

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- to launch 'INNOVIT India' for cooperation on critical technologies
- a pact to facilitate mobility of Indian nurses to Italy & an agreement promoting India's marine exports to Italy

- 'Joint Strategic Action Plan 2025-2029' – reviewed & confirmed as a comprehensive roadmap for cooperation
- India-Italy bilateral trade – stood at ~$15 billion in 2023-24
- Italy – Rome – Euro | President – Sergio Mattarella | PM – Giorgia Meloni

Banking, Digital/Finance, Economic & Insurance Affairs

(Note: This chapter includes Digital/Financial Awareness and RBI Circulars & Notifications too.)

News - 77

- EPFO – to launch "E-PRAAPTI (EPF Aadhaar-Based Access Portal for Tracking Inoperative Accounts)"
- It is a dedicated digital platform to facilitate identification, tracking, UAN linking, & activation of old EPF accounts
- EPFO has settled a record 8.31 Cr claims in 2025-26, compared to 6.01 Cr in 2024-25
- HQs of EPFO – New Delhi | CEO – Ramesh Krishnamurthi | Established in – 1952

News - 78

- SEBI – has operationalised the "Past Risk and Return Verification Agency (PaRRVA)" platform
- CARE Ratings Ltd – recognised as the agency | NSE will act as the PaRRVA Data Centre (PDC)
- PaRRVA will verify performance for investment advisers, research services and algorithmic trading providers
- PaRRVA will verify performance for investment advisers, research services & algorithmic trading providers
- HQs of SEBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman – Tuhin Kanta Pandey | Established in – 1992

News - 79

- MoF directed banks to adopt "MuleHunter.AI tool", developed by RBIH, at the earliest to identify mule accounts
- Mule account – a bank account used to facilitate illegal activities without knowledge or sometimes with complicity of account holder
- In Mar 2026, RBI rolled out 'MuleHunter.AI' for mule account detection
  - The solution is currently live in 26 banks
- Minister of Finance: Nirmala Sitharaman | Constituency – Karnataka

  MoS in Ministry of Finance: Pankaj Chaudhary

News - 80

- Federal Bank – to acquire a select India credit card portfolio from Standard Chartered Bank of about 450,000 cards
- This portfolio acquisition will enhance Federal Bank's non-co-branded credit cards receivables by about 90%
  - Total outstanding book of portfolio is worth about – Rs 1,500 Cr

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- HQs of Federal Bank – Aluva, Kerala | MD & CEO – Krishnan Venkat Subramanian | Tagline – "Your Perfect Banking Partner"
- HQs of SCB India – Mumbai, Maharashtra | CEO – P. D. Singh

News - 81

- RBI issued final guidelines, titled "Reserve Bank of India (Non-Banking Financial Companies - Registration, Exemptions and Framework for Scale Based Regulation) Amendment Directions, 2026", w.e.f. Jul 1, 2026
- They exempt NBFCs from requirement to register with it under Sections 45IA & 45IC of RBI Act, 1934
  - Eligible NBFCs – that do not avail of public funds, do not have a customer interface & have assets of <Rs 1,000 Cr
- Such existing NBFCs can apply to RBI for deregistration by Dec 31, 2026
  - Including NBFCs holding Certificate of Registration as Type I NBFC & fulfilling prescribed criteria for exemption
- Section 45IA of RBI Act – about requirement of registration
- Section 45IC – NBFCs should create a reserve fund & transfer 20% of their net profit every year into it
- These NBFCs are statutorily required to seek registration as NBFC under section 45IA of RBI Act, 1934, to date
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935
  Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | T. Rabi Sankar | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

News - 82

- Tata AIA Life Insurance – launched "Shubh Health Criti", a unit-linked life insurance plan designed to combine protection with long-term health funding
- The product allows policyholders to build a dedicated health fund that grows through market-linked returns
- It also offers coverage for over 60 critical illnesses | The plan locks in premiums for 30 years
- HQs of Tata AIA Life Insurance – Mumbai, Maharashtra | MD & CEO – Venkatachalam Iyer

News - 83

- Under revised RBI guidelines, w.e.f. Jul 1, 2026, banks will be allowed to extend relief measures to borrowers in calamity-hit areas without waiting for individual requests
  - With an opt-out clause for borrowers at any point till end of 135 days from date of declaration of a natural calamity
- Banks must invoke resolution plans within 45 days of declaration of calamity & implement them within 135 days
- It applies to commercial banks, SFBs, LABs, cooperative banks, NBFCs & All India Financial Institutions
- Banks may also, at their discretion, offer relief for customers in notified disaster-hit regions for a period of up to 1 year
- Borrowers will be eligible for resolution if their accounts are classified as 'Standard' & are not overdue by more than 30 days with lender on date calamity occurred
- Borrower accounts, which may have slipped into NPA between date of occurrence of calamity & implementation of resolution plan, shall be upgraded as 'Standard' upon implementation of resolution plan

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- RBI has also required lenders to make an additional specific provision of 5% of outstanding debt for borrowers whose accounts are restructured under a resolution plan
  - This additional provision will be over & above existing prudential requirements, subject to a maximum of 100%
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935
  Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | T. Rabi Sankar | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

News - 84

- IPPB – introduced a new "Self-Help Group (SHG) Savings Account"
- Aim: To promote financial inclusion & economic equality & empowering women-led SHGs across rural India
- HQs of IPPB – New Delhi | MD & CEO – R Viswesvaran | Chairman – Vandita Kaul | Established on – Sep 1, 2018

News - 85

- NBBL + Juspay = to introduce a switch & software development kit (SDK) for its Banking Connect platform
- HQs of NBBL – Mumbai, Maharashtra | MD & CEO – Noopur Chaturvedi
- HQs of Juspay – Bengaluru, Karnataka | CEO & Co-founder – Vimal Kumar | Founded in – 2012

News - 86

- Ministry of Finance – notified amendments to 'Foreign Exchange Management (Non-debt Instruments) Rules, 2019' through 'Second Amendment Rules, 2026'
- FDI in Insurance – 100% FDI allowed in insurance companies & intermediaries (brokers) under the automatic route
- Foreign investment in LIC capped at 20% under automatic route
- Legislative Backing – 'Sabka Bima Sabki Raksha (Amendment of Insurance Laws) Bill, 2025' passed in Dec 2025, raising FDI cap to 100%
- Minister of Finance: Nirmala Sitharaman | Constituency – Karnataka
  MoS in Ministry of Finance: Pankaj Chaudhary

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News - 87

- Rohit Jain (RBI ED) – appointed as Deputy Governor (DG) of the RBI for 3 years (replacing - T Rabi Sankar)
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935
  Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

News - 88

- JPBL + Ezeepay = partnered to expand banking access across underserved semi-urban & rural regions of India
  - Covering over 12,000 PIN codes nationwide
- Ezeepay – to operate as a Business Correspondent for Jio Payments Bank
- Jio Payments Bank – incorporated in Nov 2016 with RBI approval under Banking Regulation Act, 1949

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- HQs of Jio Payments Bank – Navi Mumbai, Maharashtra | MD & CEO – Vinod Easwaran | Established in – April 2018
- HQs of Ezeepay – Noida, Uttar Pradesh | Founder & CEO – Shams Tabrej

News - 89

- DPIIT issued an updated SOP on May 5, 2026, identifying 40 sub-sectors for expedited clearance of FDI proposals within 60 days from countries sharing land borders with India
- 40 sub-sectors fall under 6 broad categories – capital goods manufacturing; electronic capital goods & electronic component manufacturing; polysilicon & ingot-wafer production; advanced battery components; rare earth permanent magnets; & rare earth processing
- Under revised framework effective May 1, 2026, foreign companies having Chinese or Hong Kong shareholding of up to 10% on a non-controlling basis can now invest in India through automatic route in sectors where FDI is otherwise permitted automatically
- HQs of DPIIT – New Delhi | Secretary – Amardeep Singh Bhatia | Founded in – 1995 (Functions under Ministry of C&I)

News - 90

- SEBI – proposed allowing Online Bond Platform Providers (OBPPs) to offer products or services regulated by IFSCA & certain tax-saving bonds under Income Tax Act
- Currently, OBPPs can offer products or securities or services regulated by a financial sector regulator
- However, there is no provision to permit OBPPs to offer products or securities or services that are regulated by IFSCA
- SEBI proposed that OBPPs be permitted to offer bonds on their platforms to enhance ease of doing business
  - Issued under Section 54EC of Income Tax Act, 1961, as well as under Section 85 of proposed Income-tax Act, 2025
- SEBI proposed to align compliance officer requirements for OBPPs with those applicable to stock brokers
  - Replacing current mandate of appointing a company secretary with a broader framework
  - Under – SEBI (Stock Brokers) Regulations, 2026
- HQs of SEBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman – Tuhin Kanta Pandey | Established in – 1992

News - 91

- NSE – launched "Electronic Gold Receipts (EGRs)" as a new trading segment
- EGRs – dematerialised securities that represent ownership of physical gold, which is securely stored in SEBI accredited vaults & held electronically through depositories
  - Each EGR is fully backed by physical gold & is tradable on the exchange
- NSE also successfully dematerialized a 1,000-gram gold bar into an EGR
- HQs of NSE – Mumbai, Maharashtra | MD & CEO – Ashishkumar Chauhan | Established in – 1992

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News - 92

- As per MoF, Scheduled Commercial Banks (SCBs) have recorded robust credit growth of 15.9% in FY26
- Aggregate credit outstanding in Mar 2026 reached – Rs 212.9 lakh Cr (Rs 29.2 lakh Cr higher than previous year)
- During fiscal year, agriculture & allied sector credit growth – accelerated to 15.7% in FY26 (from 10.4% a year ago)
- Industrial credit – expanded 15% in FY26 (from 8.2% in previous year)
- Services sector credit – contributes 28% to overall credit (expanded 19% y-o-y)
- Personal loan segment (33% share in overall credit) – expanded by 16.2% in FY26 (from 11.7%)
- Minister of Finance: Nirmala Sitharaman | Constituency – Karnataka
  MoS in Ministry of Finance: Pankaj Chaudhary

News - 93

- SEBI – issued advisory for regulated financial entities on emerging cybersecurity risks from advanced AI tools like 'Mythos' used for vulnerability detection
- "cyber-suraksha.ai" task force is constituted to examine AI-based cybersecurity risks & develop mitigation strategies
- Key Responsibilities – Develop mitigation strategies, share threat intelligence, review vulnerabilities and cyber incidents, assess third-party vendor cybersecurity posture
- Security Expectations – Real-time monitoring through security operations centers | Improved automated response systems | Faster onboarding into centralized market cybersecurity infrastructure
- Periodic Risk Assessments – Scenario testing for cyber threats | Adoption of secure system configurations | Implementation of advanced security architectures (e.g., Zero Trust models)
- HQs of SEBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman – Tuhin Kanta Pandey | Established in – 1992

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News - 94

- MoSPI – issued uniform guidelines for calculating GSDP with 2022-23 as the revised Base Year
- The move follows the revision of the national accounts' base year to 2022-23
- GSDP figures are widely used by the Ministry of Finance, Finance Commission, CAG & other agencies
- Under the new guidelines, all states & UTs are required to adopt the new base year
- At present, 34 states & UTs compile GSDP estimates using 2011-12 as the base year
  - except Lakshadweep, Dadra & Nagar Haveli and Daman & Diu
- MoS I/C of Ministry of Statistics & Programme Implementation: Rao Inderjit Singh | Constituency – Gurgaon, Haryana

News - 95

- DFS – approved a revised "Viability Plan 2.0" for a period of 3 years from 2025-26 to 2027-28
  - Aim: To enhance the financial sustainability and long-term competitiveness of 28 RRBs
- Viability Plan 2.0 comprises a defined set of 30 performance parameters anchored around 4 main key pillars:
  - Operational Excellence, Asset Quality, Profitability, & Growth

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- Key critical metrics across these 4 pillars include:
  - CRAR, Credit-deposit Ratio, Digital adoption, NPA levels, Recovery performance, Profitability ratios & performance in implementation of Govt schemes
- Earlier 'Viability Plan' covered the period from FY2021-22 to FY2024-25

News - 96

- SEBI issued a consultation paper in May 2026, proposing additional measures to strengthen buyback framework
  - For re-introduction of open market buybacks through stock exchanges as an additional method under 'SEBI (Buy-Back of Securities) Regulations, 2018'
- It includes a maximum completion timeline of 66 working days from date of opening of offer for open market buybacks
  - With companies required to utilise at least 40% of buyback size within first half of offer period
- 66-day timeline is warranted due to recent amendments under Finance Act, 2026 to Companies Act
- SEBI also proposed removing requirement for a separate trading window for buyback transactions & conducting such trades through normal market mechanism
- Public comments on proposals have been invited until May 29, 2026
- HQs of SEBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman – Tuhin Kanta Pandey | Established in – 1992

News - 97

- Ministry of Finance – empowered Principal Bench of GSTAT, New Delhi
  - Aim: To hear appeals filed under Section 101B of CGST Act, 2017
- Principal Bench of GSTAT – to act as National Appellate Authority for Advance Ruling (NAAAR)
- NAAAR – to resolve disputes involving divergent advance rulings issued by State Appellate Authorities for Advance Ruling
- Authorization effective from – April 1, 2026
- Minister of Finance: Nirmala Sitharaman | Constituency – Karnataka
  MoS in Ministry of Finance: Pankaj Chaudhary

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News - 98

- RBI + ECB = an MoU to strengthen cooperation in the field of central banking
- MoU was signed by = RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra + ECB President Christine Lagarde (in Basel, Switzerland)
- The agreement updates the earlier pact signed between the two central banks in 2015
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935
  Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | T. Rabi Sankar | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta
- HQs of ECB – Frankfurt, Germany | President – Christine Lagarde

Join us

News - 99

- Delhi Metro Rail Corp + Airtel Payments Bank = to launch co-branded RuPay 'On-The-Go' NCMC
  - Aim: To enable seamless payments across metro systems, buses and other transit networks nationwide
- HQs of Airtel Payments Bank – Gurugram, Haryana | MD & CEO – Anubrata Biswas

News - 100

- RBI – revised its capital adequacy norms by easing rules for inclusion of quarterly profits in Common Equity Tier 1 (CET1) capital for computation of CRAR by banks
- It will apply to – commercial banks, small finance banks & payments banks (through separate amendment directions)
- RBI completely removed qualifying condition linked to NPA provisioning, simplifying process for banks
- RBI assigned a lower 2% risk weight to trades cleared through regulated central counterparties
- CRAR – a key indicator used to measure a bank's financial strength & ability to absorb potential losses
- CET1 – highest quality of regulatory capital as it is the first to absorb losses
- RBI enforces a minimum CRAR of 9% for Indian banks (global Basel III standard - 8%)
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935
  Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

News - 101

- SEBI – proposed a new green-channel mechanism, "GARUDA or Green-Channel: AIF Rollout Upon Document Acknowledgement", for AIFs to streamline Processing of Placement Memorandums (PPMs) filed with SEBI
- Regular AIF schemes – to be allowed to launch within 10 working days of filing PPM with SEBI through a merchant banker
  - At present, AIFs can launch schemes only after 30 days from filing
- Number of registered AIFs – rose to 1,849 as of Mar 31, 2026 (from 732 five years ago)
- As of Dec 31, 2025: Cumulative commitments raised by AIFs – Rs 15.74 lakh Cr | Net investments – Rs 6.45 lakh Cr
- For Accredited Investor-only (AI-only) schemes & Angel Funds, fund managers would be allowed to file PPM directly with SEBI, accompanied by an undertaking from CEO & compliance officer of AIF manager
- Number of accredited investors – grew to 2,773 as of Apr 30, 2026 (from 649 a year earlier)
- As of Dec 31, 2025, accredited investors held AIF units with a par value of about Rs 1.91 lakh Cr
- HQs of SEBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman – Tuhin Kanta Pandey | Established in – 1992

News - 102

- SBI's board approved a plan to raise up to $2 billion in long-term funds this fiscal year through overseas bond issuances
  - Fundraising will be carried out in a single or multiple tranches under Reg-S/144A
- Reg-S & Rule 144A issuances – commonly used routes for overseas bond sales
- Last time SBI raised funds through overseas bonds was in Sep 2025, when it borrowed $500 million
  - Through a 5-year dollar-denominated bond issue at a record low coupon of 4.5%

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- For Q4 of FY26, SBI's gross: Advances – grew 17% y-o-y to Rs 49.32 trillion | Deposits – rose 11% to Rs 59.75 trillion
- SBI maintained its credit growth guidance of 13-15% for FY27 in May 2026
- For Indian banking system in FY27: Credit growth – 13-14% | Deposit growth – 11-12%
- HQs of SBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman – Challa Sreenivasulu Setty
  MDs – Rana Ashutosh Kumar Singh | Ashwini Kumar Tewari | Ravi Ranjan | Rama Mohan Rao Amara

News - 103

- GoI raised customs duties, effective immediately, on imports of:
  - Gold & silver – 15% (from 6%) | Platinum – 15.4% (from 6.4%)
- Revised duty structure comprises a 10% Basic Customs Duty & a 5% Agriculture Infrastructure & Development Cess
- India's gold imports – surged 24% to $71.98 billion in FY26
  - Average import prices – rose to $99,825.38/kg in FY26 (from $76,617.48/kg in FY25)
- India – world's 2nd-largest gold consumer (after China)
- India's Current Account Deficit (CAD) – widened to 1.3% of GDP in Q3 FY26 (from 0.2% of GDP in Q1 FY26)
- Trade deficit – reached $93.6 billion during the same period

News - 104

- IEPFA + Prasar Bharati = an MoU to strengthen nationwide investor awareness initiatives
  - through the dissemination of informative scroll messages on Doordarshan across national & regional channels
- HQs of IEPFA – New Delhi | CEO – Anita Shah Akella | Founded in – September 2016

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News - 105

- RBI – removed earlier approval-based framework for non-bank entities for tie-ups with AD Category-I banks for outward remittance services
- Revised framework – applies to cross-border outward remittance of funds via websites, online platforms, software, and mobile apps operated by third-party entities
- RBI clarified: Regulatory compliance, KYC checks & FEMA adherence remain the responsibility of AD banks
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935
  Total Deputy Governors (4) – Swaminathan Janakiraman | T. Rabi Sankar | M. Rajeshwar Rao | Poonam Gupta

News - 106

- CTBC Bank – to open a new branch in India at GIFT City, Gandhinagar
  - approved by the Financial Supervisory Commission (It would become 1st Taiwanese bank in GIFT City)
- CTBC Bank operates two branches in New Delhi & Sriperumbudur (offering services in Mandarin, English, & Hindi)
- Taipei Fubon Commercial Bank – also set to open a branch in GIFT city
- HQs of CTBC Bank – Taipei, Taiwan | Chairman – James Chen | President – Tony Yang | Established in – 1966
- HQs of GIFT City – Gandhinagar, Gujarat | Chairman – Uday Kotak | MD & CEO – Sanjay Kaul | Established in – 2015

Join us

News - 107

- ICICI Bank + Visa = launched India's 1st USD-denominated debit card from its IBU at GIFT City, Gujarat
- Aim: To provide NRI customers with seamless access to offshore banking & global payment solutions
- Debit card is linked to ICICI Bank's 'USD Global Savings Account' & is built on Visa's premium 'Infinite' platform
- HQs of ICICI Bank – Mumbai, MH | MD & CEO – Sandeep Bakhshi | Taglines – "Hum Hain Na!" & "Khayal Apka"
- HQs of Visa – Foster City, California | CEO – Ryan McInerney | Founded in – 1958

News - 108

- PFRDA – launched "Retirement Income Scheme (RIS)"
  - Aim: To provide subscribers greater flexibility in receiving periodic payout options post-retirement
- Subscribers are provided the flexibility to select a phased withdrawal of their designated pension corpus
- Significant reform: mandatory annuity requirement for private-sector and non-govt subscribers
  - revised downward from 40% to 20% of the accumulated corpus
  - thereby freeing up to 80% of the corpus for lump-sum or phased withdrawal (compared to the previous 60%)
- For government subscribers, the mandatory annuity requirement remains at 40% (60% available for withdrawal)
- For subscribers with total corpus below ₹8 lakh, annuity requirement is waived entirely, allowing full withdrawal
- Those with a corpus between ₹8 lakh and ₹12 lakh can withdraw up to ₹6 lakh as a lump sum
- Two structured withdrawal tools enable phased drawdown
  (i) Systematic Payout Rate (SPR), & (ii) Systematic Unit Redemption (SUR)
- 'RIS Steady' fund – designed to reduce market volatility exposure by lowering equity exposure as subscribers age
- HQs of PFRDA – New Delhi | Chairperson – Sivasubramanian Ramann | Founded in – 2003

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News - 109

- Financial Stability and Development Council Sub Committee – called for close monitoring of rising geopolitical frictions
  - Chaired by – Sanjay Malhotra (RBI Governor)
- FSDC – a non-statutory apex council established by an executive order in 2010 & it functions under aegis of MoF
  - Chaired by – Union Finance Minister | Includes heads of financial sector regulators
- Idea for creating FSDC was recommended by – Raghuram Rajan Committee on Financial Sector Reforms in 2008

News - 110

- I4C (MHA) + RBIH = an MoU to strengthen efforts against cyber-enabled financial frauds in India
- 'MuleHunter.ai' – a system designed to identify suspicious financial activities & mule bank accounts at an early stage
- HQs of I4C – New Delhi | CEO – Rajesh Kumar
- HQs of RBIH – Bengaluru, Karnataka | CEO – Sahil Kini | Established in – 2022

Join us

News - 111

- RBI cancelled licence of Sarvodaya Co-operative Bank Ltd. (Mumbai)
- It has been prohibited from conducting banking business, w.e.f. May 12, 2026
- Commissioner for Cooperation & Registrar of Cooperative Societies, Maharashtra – requested to issue an order for winding up bank & appointing a liquidator
- On liquidation, every depositor would be entitled to receive deposit insurance claim amounts of up to Rs 5 lakh
  - From Deposit Insurance & Credit Guarantee Corporation (DICGC), subject to provisions of DICGC Act, 1961
- HQs of Sarvodaya Co-operative Bank Ltd – Mumbai, MH | Chairman – Yogeshbhai J Parikh

News - 112

- IDFC FIRST Bank – launched a fixed deposit-backed "Business Multiplier Credit Card" for founders, entrepreneurs, freelancers & business owners
- The premium metal card displays both the business name & the cardholder's name
- Eligibility requirements: a minimum FD of Rs 50,000 needed to avail the card
- HQs of IDFC First Bank – Mumbai, Maharashtra | CEO – V. Vaidyanathan | Established in – 2018

News - 113

- RBL Bank secured all major regulatory & governmental approvals for $3 billion investment from Emirates NBD Bank
  - Following approvals from RBI, SEBI, CCI & Department of Financial Services (MoF)
- Emirates NBD will acquire a controlling stake of between 49% & 74% in RBL Bank through a preferential issue of approx 95.9 Cr equity shares at ₹280 per share (largest FDI in India's banking sector history)
- HQs of RBL Bank – Mumbai, Maharashtra | MD & CEO – R. Subramaniakumar | Chairman – Chandan Sinha

News - 114

- NPCI is developing a universal soundbox platform to support UPI payments across multiple apps
- It would allow merchants to use a single soundbox regardless of payment application
- HQs of NPCI – Mumbai | Chairman – Ajay Kumar Choudhary | MD & CEO – Dilip Asbe | Established in – 2008

News - 115

- RBI – discontinued requirement for commercial banks to maintain Investment Fluctuation Reserve, w.e.f. May 18, 2026
- Balance – to be transferred 'below the line' to Statutory Reserve, General Reserve, or Balance of Profit & Loss Account
- For a foreign bank operating in India in branch mode, balance shall be transferred directly to statutory reserves kept in Indian books or remittable surplus retained in Indian books
- Banks currently maintain IFR as an additional buffer against depreciation in value of their investments
  - Subject to mark-to-market (MTM) requirements
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935
  Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

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News - 116

- Google (Alphabet) + Blackstone = to launch an AI cloud company using Google's specialized chips
  - Google will supply hardware, including its specialized chips known as 'Tensor Processing Units (TPUs)'
  - Blackstone will contribute $5 billion in equity & hold a majority stake in the unnamed US venture
- Benjamin Treynor Sloss – will serve as CEO for the new venture
- HQs of Google – California, US | CEO – Sundar Pichai | Founded in – 1998
- HQs of Blackstone – New York, USA | Chairman & CEO – Stephen A. Schwarzman | Established in – 1985

News - 117

- Gunveer Singh – appointed as Executive Director of RBI
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935
  Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | T. Rabi Sankar | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

News - 118

- RBI released draft norms on commercial banks' capital adequacy
  - To ensure greater consistency with Basel Pillar 3 disclosure requirements
- Now, Pillar 3 should apply at top consolidated level of banking group to which capital adequacy framework applies
- If a bank is not top consolidated entity in banking group, Pillar 3 disclosures shall be required to be made by bank on a standalone basis
- Banks have been asked to publish Pillar 3 disclosures concurrently with their financial reports for corresponding period
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935
  Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

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News - 119

- Index of Eight Core Industries (ICI) – increased by 1.7% in April 2026 (over April 2025)

	April 2026	During April–March 2025-26
Coal (10.33%)	declined 8.7%	cumulative -0.5%
Crude Oil (8.98%)	declined 3.9%	cumulative -2.8%
Natural Gas (6.88%)	declined 4.3%	cumulative -2.8%
Petroleum Refinery (28.04%)	declined 0.5%	cumulative -0.1%
Fertilizers (2.63%)	declined 8.6%	cumulative -0.1%
Steel (17.92%)	increased 6.2%	cumulative +9.5%
Cement (5.37%)	increased 9.4%	cumulative +8.7%
Electricity (19.85%)	increased 4.1%	cumulative +1%
Final growth of ICI for March 2026	-1.2%	cumulative growth +2.7%

Join us

News - 120

- NCDEX – to launch "RAINMUMBAI", India's 1st SEBI-approved, exchange-traded weather derivatives contract
- RAINMUMBAI contract is based on Monsoon Cumulative Deviation Rainfall (CDR)
- Contracts are available for each of 4 monsoon months – June, July, August & September
- IMD Surface Rainfall & Automatic Weather Stations Observations at Santacruz & Colaba – source of rainfall data
  - Derivative will trade between 10:00 am & 11:30 pm
- HQs of NCDEX – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman – Ashish Bahuguna | MD & CEO – Arun Raste

News - 121

- Bajaj Gen. Ins. Ltd – launched "My Health Care Plan Edge+" (MHCP EDGE+), a comprehensive health indemnity solution
  - It offers a sum insured option from Rs 5 lakhs up to Rs 5 crores
- Tenure – up to 5 years | Coverage starting from – 3 months of age
- HQs of Bajaj General Insurance – Pune, Maharashtra | MD & CEO – Dr. Tapan Singhel

News - 122

- Central Bank of India (CBoI) – to operationalise an IFSC Banking Unit (IBU) at GIFT City in Gandhinagar, Gujarat
- It received regulatory approvals from RBI & International Financial Services Centres Authority (IFSCA) to establish IBU
- IBU will enable CBoI to expand its international banking business and provide specialised banking services to customers
- HQs of Central Bank of India – Mumbai, Maharashtra | MD & CEO – Kalyan Kumar

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News - 123

- RBI – approved a record transfer of ₹2.87 lakh Cr as surplus to Central Govt for FY26 during 623rd Board Meeting
  - surpassing previous record of ₹2.68 lakh Cr for FY25
- RBI balance sheet – expanded 20.61% to ₹91.97 lakh Cr as of Mar 31, 2026 | Increase in gross income in FY26 – 26.42%
- Net income before risk provisions & statutory fund transfers in FY26 – ₹3,95,972.10 Cr
- Contingent Risk Buffer (CRB) for FY26 – ₹1,09,379.64 Cr (more than double of FY25 allocation)
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935
  Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

News - 124

- RBI – unveiled draft "Reserve Bank of India (Capital Adequacy) Amendment Directions, 2026"
  - proposing revised Basel III Pillar 3 disclosure requirements to enhance market discipline & transparency
- Banks – required to publish quarterly disclosures reporting CET 1 capital, total capital, RWAs, leverage ratio, LCR & NSFR
  - beginning from Q2 FY2026-27
- Banks – to maintain "Regulatory Disclosure Section" on official website with archives for minimum 10 years
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935
  Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

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News - 125

- RBI – announced a $5 billion USD/INR Buy/Sell swap auction to inject long-term liquidity into banking system
- Swap auction is scheduled to be conducted on May 26, 2026, between 10:30 AM & 11:30 AM, with a tenor of 3 years
- Near-leg settlement date – fixed for May 29, 2026 | Far-leg maturity date – May 29, 2029
- Authorized Dealers Category-I (AD Category-I) banks will sell US dollars to RBI & agree to buy back same amount of dollars at end of 3-year swap period
- Minimum bid size – set at $10 million
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935
  Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

News - 126

- Eurobank – inaugurated its representative office in Mumbai, India
  - becoming first bank from Greece, Cyprus & Southeastern Europe to establish a physical presence in India
- Inauguration ceremony was attended by – Nikos Christodoulides (President of Cyprus) at Taj Mahal Palace Hotel
- Eurobank + NIPL (India) = a strategic partnership to enable cross-border digital payments from Greece to India through India's UPI system
  - It makes Eurobank first bank across Europe to offer cross-border remittances to India via UPI
- Eurobank + FICCI = an MoU during a Cyprus-India business forum held on May 20, 2026
  - Aim: To position Cyprus & Greece as strategic entry points for Indian companies expanding into European Union
- HQs of Eurobank – Athens, Greece | Chairperson – George Zanias | CEO – Fokion Karavias | Established in – 1924

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News - 127

- RBI – released a revised draft Amendment Directions titled "Conduct of Regulated Entities in Recovery of Loans and Engagement of Recovery Agents"
- For public consultation, proposing strict restrictions on use of mobile phone disabling tools by lenders & a comprehensive overhaul of loan recovery practices to strengthen borrower protection & oversight of recovery agents
- It implements a 90-day overdue threshold before such restrictions may be activated
  - Including a 21-day cure period, followed by an additional 7-day notice
- Lenders will have to restore device functionalities within 1 hour once borrower clears dues
  - Failing which they will have to compensate borrower at rate of ₹250 per hour until issue is rectified
- Recovery agents must undergo mandatory IIBF certification & comply with strict conduct norms prohibiting verbal or physical harassment, threats, intimidation or abusive language
- Contact with borrowers is restricted to 8:00 AM to 7:00 PM
- Lenders are prohibited from sharing excessive borrower information with recovery agents & from contacting borrower's relatives, friends or colleagues
- Draft covers 9 categories of regulated entities including banks, NBFCs, HFCs & Cooperative Banks (CBs)

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- Draft was released for public comments with a deadline of May 31, 2026, with a proposed effective date of Oct 1, 2026
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935
  Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

News - 128

- As per Client Associates' white paper "State of Indian States: 2026":
- Maharashtra + TN + UP + Karnataka + Gujarat = contributed ~48% of India's GDP in FY25
  - Bottom 10 states – accounting for less than 3% of national GDP
- Maharashtra – contributed 13.3% to national GDP, with a projected GSDP of ₹42.67 lakh Cr for FY25
- Tamil Nadu – highest y-o-y growth among top 5 states at 16% in FY25, with a projected GSDP of ₹31.55 lakh Cr
  - Karnataka & Gujarat – approached ₹28 lakh Cr
- UP – emerged as a massive contributor due to its population scale & infrastructure development
- Maharashtra, Karnataka, Gujarat, Delhi & TN – captured 83.3% of all FDI equity inflows in FY25
- India attracted ₹4.22 lakh Cr in FDI equity inflows (a 14.7% y-o-y increase)
- Tamil Nadu & Haryana – emerged as fast-rising FDI destinations
- UP & Rajasthan – becoming investment hubs driven by policy reforms & infrastructure development
- India continues to remain world's fastest-growing major economy (GDP projected at - 7.5% in FY26 & 6.8% in FY27)

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News - 129

- RBI issued directions to Nagar Sahakari Bank Ltd (Etawah, UP) imposing operational restrictions, w.e.f. close of business
  - Under Section 35A of Banking Regulation Act
- Bank cannot grant any loans & advances, make any investment, incur any liability, disburse any payment in discharge of its liabilities & obligations, enter into any compromise, or sell/transfer any asset without prior approval of RBI
- Depositors have been directed to be permitted withdrawals not exceeding ₹10,000 from any account
- Restrictions will remain in force for 6 months & are subject to review
- Deposits of up to ₹5 lakh are covered under Deposit Insurance and Credit Guarantee Corporation (DICGC) scheme
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935
  Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

News - 130

- Sandeep Bakhshi – reappointed as MD & CEO of ICICI Bank for 2 years, w.e.f. Oct 4, 2026
- Under RBI norms, CEO of a private sector bank can continue in office until age of 70
- HQs of ICICI Bank – Mumbai, MH | MD & CEO – Sandeep Bakhshi | Taglines – "Hum Hain Na!" & "Khayal Apka"

Join us

News - 131

- DeGS + SBI = an MoU to implement an integrated e-Payment solution on state government's e-Procurement Portal
  - Aim: To streamline & expedite e-tendering payment ecosystem
- This agreement introduces a comprehensive digital payment platform termed 'e-Pay'
- Delhi: CM – Rekha Gupta | Lt. Governor – Taranjit Singh Sandhu | Chief Secretary – Rajeev Verma
- HQs of SBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman – Challa Sreenivasulu Setty
  MDs – Rana Ashutosh Kumar Singh | Ashwini Kumar Tewari | Ravi Ranjan | Rama Mohan Rao Amara

News - 132

- Karnataka Grameena Bank – honoured with a "National Award" by PFRDA for its performance in enrolment under APY
- Shreekant M. Bhandiwad (Chairman of KGB) – received the award
  - During APY Annual Felicitation Programme in New Delhi
- KGB enrolled 2,49,185 APY accounts against DFS/PFRDA target of 1,75,500 accounts
- KGB – formed in 2025 by amalgamating 2 RRBs of Karnataka
- APY – launched in 2015 to provide financial security & cover future exigencies for people in unorganized sector
  - Eligibility: all bank account holders in age group of 18 to 40 years
  - Subscribers can make contributions to APY on a monthly/ quarterly / half-yearly basis
- Subscribers would receive guaranteed minimum monthly pension of Rs. 1000, Rs. 2000, Rs. 3000, Rs. 4000 or Rs. 5000 at age of 60 years
- Managed by – PFRDA through the National Pension System (NPS)
- HQs of Karnataka Grameena Bank – Ballari, Karnataka | Chairman – Shreekant M. Bhandiwad

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News - 133

- Skydo – received in-principle approval to operate as a Payment Service Provider (PSP) at GIFT City IFSC
- It also received regulatory approval to support outward payment flows under RBI's Payment Aggregator-Cross Border (PA-CB) framework
- Earlier this year, Skydo secured final RBI authorisation to operate as a PA-CB for export collections
- HQs of Skydo – Bengaluru, Karnataka | CEO & Co-Founder – Srivatsan Sridhar | Established in – 2022

News - 134

- jUMPP – secured regulatory approval from IRDAI to commence insurance product distribution through its platform
- It received 'Corporate Agency and Insurance Self Network Platform (ISNP)' licences
- HQs of jUMPP – Mohali, Punjab | Founder & CEO – Sarvjeet Singh Virk | Established in – 2025

Join us

News - 135

- RBI formed an eight-member expert committee for "Quantum Secure and Adaptive Financial Ecosystem (Q-SAFE)"
  - It will submit its report within six months from date of its first meeting
- Anil Prabhakar (Prof. in Department of Electrical Engineering at IIT Madras) – to be convenor of panel
- Secretarial support to committee will be provided by – RBI's FinTech Department
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935
  Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

News - 136

- Elias George – appointed as Chairperson of Federal Bank Ltd for 3 years
- He is currently serving as – independent director on board of Federal Bank (since Sep 5, 2023)
- HQs of Federal Bank – Aluva, Kerala | MD & CEO – Krishnan Venkat Subramanian | Tagline – "Your Perfect Banking Partner"

News - 137

- RBI tightened governance norms for both urban co-operative banks & rural co-operative banks, with immediate effect
  - It mandated a minimum three-year cooling-off period for directors who complete a continuous tenure of 10 years on board of same bank
- During cooling-off period, said director shall not be associated with UCB in any capacity other than as a customer
- Banking Laws (Amendment) Act, 2025 raised max. continuous tenure of directors of UCBs, StCBs & CCBs – to 10 years
  - From – 8 years
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935
  Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

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News - 138

- Nirmala Sitharaman – launched a set of strategic portals & SIDBI Initiatives on its 37th Foundation Day in Mumbai
- 'SIDBI-RRB Co-Lending Platform' – a digital joint lending model
  - To enhance MSME credit penetration in semi-urban & rural areas
- 'Modernization of Rural Enterprises (MoRE) Programme' – a cluster-based intervention providing credit & credit-plus support
- 'Micro Credit Card Scheme for Micro Enterprises' – also launched to enable Udyam-registered micro enterprises to access revolving credit of up to Rs 5 lakh with 75% guarantee coverage & without mandatory primary security
- 'SIDBI MSME Exchange – Machinery Portal' – also launched to integrate machinery discovery with institutional financing support
- Contribution of MSMEs in Indian economy in: Manufacturing – 35% | Exports – 48% | GDP – 31%
- Minister of Finance: Nirmala Sitharaman | Constituency – Karnataka
  MoS in Ministry of Finance: Pankaj Chaudhary

Join us

News - 139

- LIC introduced 2 new plans, "New Jeevan Sathi-Single Premium" & "New Jeevan Sathi-Limited Premium"
  - Both are non-par, non-linked, individual savings plans | Minimum basic sum assured – Rs 3 lakh
  - Both products will be available for purchase from Jun 1, 2026
  - Both are joint life plans that cover a married individual along with his/her spouse in a single policy
- Premium under 'New Jeevan Sathi-Single Premium' is payable only once
  - It offers guaranteed additions at rate of Rs 70 per Rs 1000 basic sum assured every year, throughout Policy Term
- Rate – 7% of total tabular annual premium for premium
- HQs of LIC – Mumbai | CEO – R Doraiswamy | Founded in – 1956 | Tagline – 'Yogakshemam Vahamyaham'

News - 140

- Ketan Merchant – tenure extended as interim CEO of Fino Payments Bank for 3 months, w.e.f. May 27, 2026
- HQs of Fino Payments Bank – Navi Mumbai, Maharashtra | CEO (interim) – Ketan Merchant

News - 141

- Canara HSBC Life Insurance + West Bengal Gramin Bank = a strategic bancassurance partnership
- HQs of Canara HSBC Life Ins – Gurugram, Haryana | CEO – Anuj Dayal Mathur
- HQs of West Bengal Gramin Bank – Berhampore, Murshidabad, West Bengal | Chairman – Shri Alok K Goel

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News - 142

- DBJ (Japan) – made 1st real estate investment in India via HDFC Capital's 'H-DREAM Fund' targeting affordable & mid-income housing
- H-DREAM Fund – target corpus $500 million (greenshoe option - $500 million) | Current commitments > $350 million
- Investment routed through HDFC Capital's offshore feeder fund at GIFT City under IFSC Authority framework
- DBJ – has overseas subsidiaries in Singapore, London, Beijing & New York

Defence Affairs

News - 143

- DRDO + Indian Navy = conducted maiden salvo launch of Naval Anti-ship Missile-Short Range (NASM-SR)
  - From Navy's helicopter platform off the coast of Bay of Bengal in Odisha
- All its critical subsystems are developed indigenously by different laboratories of DRDO & Indian Industries
- Missile system – developed by Research Center Imarat (Hyderabad) in collab with other DRDO laboratories
  - Other DRDO laboratories – Defence Research & Development Laboratory (Hyderabad); High Energy Materials Research Laboratory (Pune); Terminal Ballistics Research Laboratory (Chandigarh & ITR Chandipur)
- Missiles are currently being produced by Development cum Production Partner with other Indian industries & start-ups

Join us

- HQs of DRDO – New Delhi | Chairman – Samir V. Kamat | Established in – 1958
- HQs of Indian Navy – Delhi | Chief – Admiral Dinesh K. Tripathi | Vice Chief – VAdm Sanjay Vatsayan

News - 144

- 4th edition of bilateral diving exercise between India & Sri Lanka, "IN-SLN DIVEX 2026" – held in Colombo, Sri Lanka
  - From – Apr 21 to 28, 2026
- Indian Navy deployed – INS Nireekshak (Diving Support & Submarine Rescue Vessel)
- INS Nireekshak – presented 2 'BHISM (Bharat Health Initiative for Sahyog Hita & Maitri)' cubes
  - As part of Aarogya Maitri programme
- IN-SLN DIVEX 2026 – aligned with 'MAHASAGAR' vision (Mutual and Holistic Advancement for Security and Growth Across Regions)
- Sri Lanka – Colombo/Sri Jayawardenepura Kotte – Sri Lankan Rupee
  PM – Harini Amarasuriya | President – Anura Kumar Dissanayake

News - 145

- Indian Army contingent – departed for 2nd edition of India-Cambodia Bilateral Military Exercise, "CINBAX-II 2026", in Kampong Speu Province, Cambodia
- Indian Army contingent comprises 120 personnel
- HQs of Indian Army – New Delhi | Chief – General Upendra Dwivedi | Vice Chief – Lt. Gen. Dheeraj Seth

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News - 146

- Indian Navy – received delivery of advanced stealth frigate "INS Mahendragiri" under Project 17A (Nilgiri-class)
  - From – Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Ltd (MDL) | Designed by – Warship Design Bureau
- Total 7 stealth guided-missile frigates were constructed by MDL & GRSE under Project 17A
  - 5 already delivered to Navy are – INS Nilgiri, INS Himgiri, INS Udaygiri, INS Taragiri & INS Vindhyagiri
- HQs of Indian Navy – Delhi | Chief – Admiral Dinesh K. Tripathi | Vice Chief – VAdm Sanjay Vatsayan

News - 147

- MoD + BEL = a Rs 1,476 Cr contract for procurement of 5 Ground-Based Mobile Electronic Systems for Indian Army
  - Under – Buy (Indian-Indigenously Designed, Developed and Manufactured) category
- MoD + BEL = a ₹1,950 Cr capital acquisition contract, in March 2026, for procurement of 2 Mountain Radars for IAF
- HQs of BEL – Bengaluru, Karnataka | CMD – Manoj Jain
- Minister of Defence: Rajnath Singh | Constituency – Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh
  MoS in Ministry of Defence: Sanjay Seth

Join us

News - 148

- DRDO + IAF = conducted maiden flight-trial of TARA weapon system off Odisha coast (using IAF Jaguar aircraft)
- TARA – India's 1st fully indigenous glide weapon system
  - It is designed by – Research Centre Imarat (RCI), Hyderabad, & other DRDO labs under DcPP model
  - Key Features – Enhances range, accuracy, & lethality against ground targets
- Modular Kit Integration – Compatible with fighter aircraft including Sukhoi-30MKI, Mirage 2000, and LCA Tejas
- HQs of DRDO – New Delhi | Chairman – Samir V. Kamat | Established in – 1958
- HQs of IAF – New Delhi | Chief – Air Marshal Amar Preet Singh | Vice Chief – Air Marshal Nagesh Kapoor

News - 149

- MBDA (France) + IAF = an agreement for the development of a local capability for the MRO of 'MICA' missiles
- The IAF uses MICA missiles as a versatile air-to-air weapon on its Rafale & upgraded Mirage 2000 fighter jets
- MICA was first incorporated into the IAF in 2016 (developed by MBDA)
- MBDA has supported IAF for over 50 years, providing advanced weapons such as MICA, Meteor, ASRAAM, & Mistral
- HQs of IAF – New Delhi | Chief – Air Marshal Amar Preet Singh | Vice Chief – Air Marshal Nagesh Kapoor

News - 150

- ICG – commissioned ICGS "Achal", 5th in series of 8 new-generation Adamya-class FPV, at Goa Shipyard Ltd
- The ship will be stationed at Vadinar, Gujarat | Commanded by – Commandant (JG) Naveen Kumar
- HQs of ICG – New Delhi | DG – S Paramesh | Founded in – 1977

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News - 151

- Western Command (Indian Army) – received 2 new indigenous combat systems from Adani Defence & Aerospace under emergency procurement (EP-6)

  (i) UAV-Launched Precision Guided Munition (ULPGM)

  (ii) AGNIKAA VTOL-1 First-Person View (FPV) Kamikaze Drone
- ULPGM: Developed in collaboration with – DRDO | It is a loitering munition designed for UAV integration
  - It features a 2-kg warhead with 1-metre circular error probable (CEP) accuracy
- AGNIKAA VTOL-1 – an FPV kamikaze drone, with an endurance of 30 minutes & a speed of 60 km/h
- HQs of Adani Defence & Aerospace – Ahmedabad, Gujarat | CEO – Ashish Rajvanshi

News - 152

- L&T + Exail (France) = a collab to deliver an advanced unmanned mine counter-measure (MCM) Suite for the Indian Navy's mine counter-measure vessels (MCMVs) programme
- Such mines threaten military ships, and block ports & shipping lanes against the threat to merchant vessels
- HQs of L&T – Mumbai, Maharashtra | CEO & MD – S. N. Subrahmanyan | President – Subramanian Sarma

Join us

News - 153

- Indian Army + Indian Navy = a Memorandum of Association (MoA) on Affiliation to institutionalise long-term linkages between Army & Navy units
- The pact comes as the Ministry of Defence examines proposals for 3 Integrated Theatre Commands
  - Maritime command to be led by the Navy, Northern command by the Army & Western command by the Air Force
- HQs of Indian Army – New Delhi | Chief – General Upendra Dwivedi | Vice Chief – Lt. Gen. Dheeraj Seth
- HQs of Indian Navy – Delhi | Chief – Admiral Dinesh K. Tripathi (From May 31 - Krishna Swaminathan) | Vice Chief – VAdm Sanjay Vatsayan

News - 154

- US approved possible sale of support services & related equipment for Apache helicopters to India
  - For an estimated cost of – $198.2 million
- US Department of State also approved a possible sale of sustainment support for M777A2 ultra-light howitzers
  - For an estimated cost of – $230 million
- Cost of total support package – $428.2 million
- Principal contractors for Apache support services deal – Boeing Company & Lockheed Martin
- For howitzers support, principal contractor – BAE Systems (Cumbria, UK)

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News - 155

- Multilateral military exercise “PRAGATI 2026” – began at Umroi Military Station in Meghalaya
- It includes India & 12 partner nations, namely Bhutan, Cambodia, Indonesia, Laos, Malaysia, Maldives, Myanmar, Nepal, Philippines, Seychelles, Sri Lanka & Vietnam
- PRAGATI – “Partnership of Regional Armies for Growth and Transformation in the Indian Ocean Region”

News - 156

- Indian Navy marked successful culmination of landmark Indian Ocean Ship (IOS) SAGAR deployment with flag-in of INS Sunayna at Kochi on May 20, 2026
- Deployment was jointly undertaken by – Indian Navy + partner nations
  - Bangladesh, Indonesia, Kenya, Malaysia, Mauritius, Maldives, Mozambique, Myanmar, Seychelles, Singapore, South Africa, Sri Lanka, Tanzania, Thailand, Timor Leste & UAE
- VAdm Sameer Saxena (FOC-i-C Southern Naval Command) – Chief Guest for flag-in ceremony of IOS Sagar
- IOS Sagar – flagged off from Mumbai on Apr 2, 2026 | By – Sanjay Seth (Raksha Rajya Mantri)
- During deployment, ship undertook port calls at Malé, Phuket, Jakarta, Singapore, Yangon, Chattogram & Colombo
- INS Sunayna (an Offshore Patrol Vessel of Indian Navy) – sailed from Mumbai, designated as IOS SAGAR, for mission
- HQs of Indian Navy – Delhi | Chief – Admiral Dinesh K. Tripathi | Vice Chief – VAdm Sanjay Vatsayan

Join us

News - 157

- GRSE launched "Sanghamitra", first of 4 next-generation offshore patrol vessels (NGOPVs) being built for Indian Navy
- 'Sanghmitra' is part of Indian Navy's programme to build 11 NGOPVs simultaneously at 2 shipyards
  - Goa Shipyard Limited (Goa) & GRSE (Kolkata)
- Specifications: Length – 113 metres | Breadth – 14.6 metres | Displacement – 3,000 tonnes
  - Endurance – 8,500 nautical miles at a cruising speed of 14 knots | Maximum speed – 23 knots
- HQs of GRSE – Kolkata, West Bengal | Chairman & MD – P. R. Hari | Founded in – 1884

News - 158

- Tonbo Imaging – secured a contract from Indian Navy under 'ADITI 3.0' innovation framework
  - To integrate & commission a High Power Microwave (HPM) system for naval platforms
  - ADITI – **A**cing **D**evelopment of **I**nnovative **T**echnologies with **i**DEX
- Supported by – Innovations for Defence Excellence (iDEX) & Defence Innovation Organisation (MoD)
- ADITI scheme – launched in 2024 & offers grants of up to Rs 25 Cr for developing 30 key defence technologies under iDEX framework
- ADITI 2.0 – introduces 19 new challenges in areas like AI, quantum technology, etc
- ADITI 3.0 – features a challenge from Indian Navy to design an HPM weapon system
- HQs of Indian Navy – Delhi | Chief – Admiral Dinesh K. Tripathi | Vice Chief – VAdm Sanjay Vatsayan
- HQs of Tonbo Imaging – Bengaluru, Karnataka | MD & CEO – Arvind Kondangi Lakshmikumar

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News - 159

- Indian Army launched "Q-FORCE", an integrated app to streamline logistics & sustainment management across force
- 2026 – declared as 'Year of Networking & Data Centricity'
- HQs of Indian Army – New Delhi | Chief – General Upendra Dwivedi | Vice Chief – Lt. Gen. Dheeraj Seth

News - 160

- MoD issued a request for proposal (RFP) to 3 shortlisted private players for development & production of Advanced Medium Combat Aircraft (AMCA)
  - Tata Advanced Systems Ltd, Larsen & Toubro (in collab with BEL) & Bharat Forge (in collab with BEML)
  - For 1st time, HAL won't be part of a big-ticket fighter jet programme
- Selected entities will work with Aeronautical Development Agency (ADA) for developing 5 prototypes of aircraft
- AMCA – to be manufactured at upcoming Integration & Flight-Testing Complex in Andhra Pradesh
  - Its prototype phase is budgeted at – Rs 15,000 Cr
  - It will be a medium-weight, multi-role & twin-engine stealth fifth-generation fighter aircraft
- Once it is inducted, India will join an exclusive list of countries with fifth-generation fighters
  - As of May 2025, only US (F-22 and F-35), China (J-20) & Russia (Su-57) have these

Join us

Sports & Games

News - 161

- Vaibhav Sooryavanshi (Rajasthan Royals) – created history in IPL 2026 by becoming the fastest player to reach 400 runs
  - in a single season in terms of balls faced, getting there in just 167 deliveries
  - surpassing Andre Russell (188 balls in 2019 season)
- Others in top 5:
  - Abhishek Sharma (195 balls in 2024)
  - Nicholas Pooran (197 balls in 2025)
  - Glenn Maxwell (200 balls in 2014)

News - 162

- Virat Kohli – became 1st batter in IPL to hit 800 fours during his knock of 81 runs in RCB's match against Gujarat Titans
  - 2nd – Shikhar Dhawan (768 fours)
- Virat Kohli now has 807 boundaries to his name in 274 IPL matches (most by any batter in tournament's history)
- Virat Kohli – also became 3rd batter to smash 300 sixes in IPL history (303)
  - 1st – Chris Gayle (357 sixes) | 2nd – Rohit Sharma (310 sixes)

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News - 163

- India – to host "SAFF Women's Championship 2026", scheduled for May 24 to Jun 7, 2026
  - At – Pandit Jawaharlal Nehru (Fatorda) Stadium in Margao, Goa
- Total teams to compete in tournament – 6
  - Group A comprises – Nepal, Sri Lanka & Bhutan | Group B comprises – India, Bangladesh & Maldives
- India won 'SAFF Women's Championship' 5 times in a row in 2010, 2012, 2014, 2016 & 2019
- HQs of SAFF – Dhaka, Bangladesh | President – Kazi Md. Salahuddin

News - 164

- Rithika Sri (Salem) – became 1st transgender umpire from Tamil Nadu
- Tamil Nadu: Capital – Chennai | CM – Muthuvel Karunanidhi Stalin | Governor – Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar

News - 165

- "Thomas Cup 2026" & "Uber Cup 2026" – held in Horsens, Denmark
- China (13th overall title and 2nd win in a row) – won "Thomas Cup 2026" title | Defeated – France | Bronze – India
- South Korea (3rd title) – won "Uber Cup 2026" title | Defeated – China | Bronze – Japan & Indonesia
- Thomas & Uber Cup 2026 – biennial world team championship in badminton
- It was: 34th edition of – Thomas Cup (men's) | 31st edition of – Uber Cup (women's)

Join us

News - 166

- India's U-17 women's football team – qualified for quarterfinals of "AFC U-17 Women's Asian Cup China 2026"
  - Defeated – Lebanon | At – Suzhou Taihu Football Sports Centre in China | Nickname – Young Tigresses
- Pritika Barman – led charge with a brace (7th & 85th minutes) | Alva Devi Senjam (36th) & Joya (72nd) – also scored
- Head coach of India U-17 Women's Football Team – Pamela Conti (an Italian coach, appointed in Jan 2026)

News - 167

- Indian women's recurve team – won gold medal at the "Archery World Cup 2026" in Shanghai, China
  - beating – Chinese archery team (comprising - Zhu Jingyi, Huang Yuwei & Yu Qi)
  - Indian team comprises – Deepika Kumari, Ankita Bhakat & Kumkum Mohod
- This was Deepika's 39th Archery World Cup medal, Ankita's 8th & Kumkum's 1st
- With this gold, India concluded the Shanghai leg of the Archery World Cup 2026 series with 2 medals (1G + 1B)
  - Bronze winner – Sahil Jadhav (in men's individual compound event)
- Turkiye – topped the medal tally with 6 medals (2 gold)
  - Followed by – China with 5 medals (2 gold) & South Korea with 5 medals (2 gold)

News - 168

- Faustino Oro (Argentina), nicknamed "Messi of Chess" – became 2nd-youngest Grandmaster (GM) at age 12
  - He secured his final norm at – Sardinia World Chess Festival 2026
  - By drawing against – Ian Nepomniachtchi (Russia)
- His earlier norms: 1st – in Madrid in 2025 | 2nd – at Magistral Szmetan-Giardelli event in Dec 2025
- Youngest Grandmaster (GM) – American Abhimanyu Mishra (12 years, 4 months)
  - He became youngest International Master (IM) in June 2024 at 10 years, 8 months & 16 days

News - 169

- Virat Kohli – became 1st Indian & 6th all-time player to score 14,000 runs in T20 cricket, achieving feat in IPL 2026
  - Top 5 – Chris Gayle (14,562), Kieron Pollard (14,482), Alex Hales (14,449), David Warner (14,284) & Jos Buttler (14,200)
- Kohli – also became fastest player to reach 14,000 T20 runs in terms of innings taken, achieving milestone in 409 innings
  - Previous record – Chris Gayle (423 innings)
- Chris Gayle – leads list for most centuries in T20 cricket (22 centuries)
  - Followed by – Babar Azam (13) and David Warner & Virat Kohli (10 each)

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News - 170

- Elina Svitolina (Ukraine) – won the women's singles title at the "Italian Open 2026" (defeating - Coco Gauff of US)
  - It was Elina's 3rd Italian Open title
- Jannik Sinner – won the men's singles title (defeating - Casper Ruud of Norway)
  - becoming the 1st Italian man to win the tournament in 50 years & completing his Career Golden Masters
- Winners of Men's Doubles – Simone Bolelli & Andrea Vavassori (1st all-Italian duo to lift the trophy)
- Winners of Women's Doubles – Mirra Andreeva and Diana Shnaider (Russian duo)

News - 171

- Vaibhav Sooryavanshi – became 1st Indian batter in IPL history to smash 50 sixes in a single season
  - During a match against – Lucknow Super Giants (LSG)
- He now sits 2nd on all-time list for most sixes in a single IPL season with 53 maximums
  - 1st – Chris Gayle's 59 sixes from 2012 season
- He also became youngest cricketer to hit 100 T20 sixes, at 15 years & 43 days

News - 172

- "Asian Weightlifting Championships 2026" – held in Gandhinagar, Gujarat
  - India – finished with 10 medals (1 silver & 9 bronze)
  - It was held in India for 2nd time | 1st time – New Delhi (in 1982)
- Medal tally topped by – China with 41 medals (21 gold, 12 silver & 8 bronze)
  - 2nd – North Korea with 30 medals (18 gold, 11 silver & 1 bronze)
  - 3rd – Chinese Taipei with 13 medals (3 gold, 7 silver & 3 bronze)
- At Asian Weightlifting Championships 2026, separate medals were awarded for 'snatch' and 'clean & jerk' disciplines
- Indian winners:



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News - 173

- Swara Lakshmi Nair – became 2nd chess player from Karnataka to achieve Women's International Master (WIM) status
  - 1st – Isha Sharma | Swara Lakshmi – also 1st WIM from Bengaluru
- Swara Lakshmi scored: 1st norm – at Sardinia World Chess Festival in 2025 (Italy)
  - 2nd norm – at Grand Hotel Kielce Open 2025 (Poland) | 3rd & final norm – at Ptuj IM tournament in 2026 (Slovenia)

News - 174

- Asian Athletics Association awarded hosting rights to Indian cities:
  - Chandigarh – 3rd "Asian Relays 2027" | Bhubaneswar (Kalinga Stadium) – "Asian Indoor Championships 2028"
- Executive council meeting of Asian Athletics Association (AAA) – held in Hong Kong, China
- Previous editions of 'Asian Relays': 1st – Bangkok (2024) | 2nd – Shaoxing, China (Jun 20 to 21, 2026)
- Bhubaneswar (Kalinga Stadium) – to also stage 'World Indoor Championships 2028' from March 3 to 5
- 1st 'National Open Indoor Athletics Championships' – also organised at Kalinga Stadium indoor facility

News - 175

- Esha Singh (India) – won gold in Women's 25m pistol at ISSF World Cup 2026, Munich, Germany
  - breaking world record by earning 43 points out of 50 in final (previous 42 by Kim Yeji, South Korea)
- Silver – Doreen Vennekamp (Germany) 38 points | Bronze – Miroslava Mincheva (Bulgaria) 31 points
- It was India's 1st individual shooting medal of the ISSF World Cup season across rifle, pistol & shotgun events
- India – 3rd medal this season across World Cup events:
  - Mukesh Nelavalli & Palak Gulia – gold in 10m air pistol mixed team, Granada, Spain
  - Vivaan Kapoor & Neeru Dhanda – bronze in mixed team trap, Almaty, Kazakhstan

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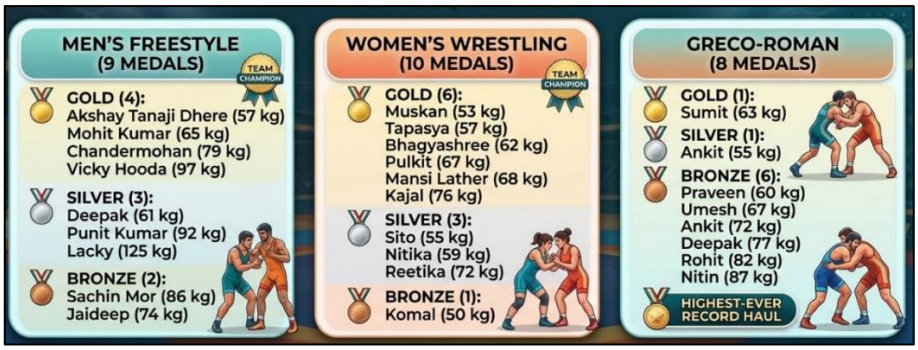
News - 176

- Dr Jitendra Singh – joined 150-year celebrations of Indian Association for the Cultivation of Science (IACS), Kolkata
- He also inaugurated indigenously built PECVD system for India's 1st amorphous silicon solar cell fabrication
- He also launched 'RETINA (**R**esearch **E**ntrepreneurship for **T**ranslation, **I**nnovation and **NA**vigation)' centre
- IACS – founded in 1876 by Dr Mahendralal Sircar | Hosted scientific luminaries like – J.C. Bose, S.N. Bose & C.V. Raman
- C.V. Raman – discovered Raman Effect at IACS, awarded India's 1st Nobel Prize in Physics, 1930

News - 177

- "Under-23 Asian Wrestling Championships 2026" – held in Da Nang, Vietnam
- India's under-23 wrestlers – won a record 27 medals (11 gold, 7 silver, 9 bronze)

Join us



Persons in News

News - 178

- Ishank Singh (Ranchi) – became youngest swimmer in world to cross Palk Strait between India & Sri Lanka
  - Ishank swam across Palk Strait, a 29-km stretch, on Apr 30, 2026
  - He started from Talaimannar in Sri Lanka & reached Dhanushkodi in Tamil Nadu in 9 hours & 50 minutes
- Ishank has been conferred titles 'Youngest and Fastest Palk Strait Swimmer' by Universal Records Forum & '2026 OWSAT World Record' by Open Water Swimming Academy, Theni
- Previous record was held by – Jay Jaswanth (Tamil Nadu)

News - 179

- Kami Rita Sherpa (Nepal) – broke his own for highest number of ascents of Mt. Everest for 32nd time
  - He was leading an expedition operated by 14 Peaks Expedition | He climbed Mt. Everest for 1st time in 1994
- Ascent was confirmed by – Department of Tourism's field office stationed at Everest Base Camp
- Lhakpa Sherpa (Mountain Queen - 1st Nepali woman to summit Mt. Everest) – broke her own world record by completing her 11th successful ascent of peak

News - 180

- Squadron Leader Saanya – became 1st woman officer to achieve Cat-A Qualified Flying Instructor qualification in IAF
- Cat-C – for trainee or probationary instructors | Cat-B – for instructors capable of standard flying instruction
  - Cat-A – allows pilot to train other instructors & assess advanced flight skills
- HQs of IAF – New Delhi | Chief – Air Marshal Amar Preet Singh | Vice Chief – Air Marshal Nagesh Kapoor

News - 181

- Gp Capt. K.K. Venugopal – became 1st Indian test pilot to be elected as a Fellow of Society of Experimental Test Pilots
- Currently, he is Executive Director & Chief Test Pilot (Fixed Wing) in Hindustan Aeronautics Limited
- SETP – based in Lancaster, California, USA

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Join us

Science & Technology

News - 182

- MeitY – launched two Silicon Photonics technology solutions:
  - "Silicon Photonics Process Design Kit (PDK)"
  - "Universal packaged PPIC (Programmable Photonic Integrated Circuit) Test Engine"
- Both technologies have been developed at the MeitY-supported CoE-CPPICS at IIT Madras
- PDK includes more than 50 verified components
- PPIC Engine offers a state-of-the-art automated platform for testing & characterising photonic & optoelectronic modules
- Next phase of the project will enable multi-project wafer (MPW) fabrication runs starting in Q3 FY27
- Minister of Electronics & Information Technology: Ashwini Vaishnaw | Constituency – Odisha
  MoS in Ministry of Electronics & Information Technology: Jitin Prasada

News - 183

- Sahajanand Medical Technologies – obtained 'ISO 50001:2018 Energy Management System Certification' for its manufacturing facilities in Surat & Hyderabad
  - becoming the first domestic cardiovascular manufacturing unit to do so
- It implements a structured approach to energy management that not only optimizes energy use but also strengthens our environmental goals
- HQs of Sahajanand Medical Technologies – Mumbai | Chairperson – Jose Calle Gordo | MD & CEO – Bhargav Kotadia

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News - 184

- ISRO completed high-resolution Land Use & Land Cover mapping for entire country at a scale of 1:10000
  - It means 1 cm on map represents just 100 metres on ground
- According to 2011 Census, there were 649,481 villages on ground
- Land Cover – Physical material on surface of Earth
  - Land Use – how humans use that land, whether for agriculture, housing or industry
- Dataset is now available to government organisations & has been integrated into 'Gram Manchitra' web portal
- Gram Manchitra – a Geographic Information System (GIS) portal designed by Ministry of Panchayati Raj
- HQs of ISRO – Bengaluru, Karnataka | Director – Dr. V. Narayanan | Formed on – August 15, 1969

News - 185

- M. Ravichandran – inaugurated "Open-Field Observatory of Coastal Atmospheric Research Testbed" at Andhra Uni.
  - It is a facility set up by Indian Institute of Tropical Meteorology (IITM), Pune, under Centre's 'Mission Mausam'
- Total project cost – ~Rs 180 Cr
- The initiative follows an MoU signed between IITM and Andhra University

Join us

- to generate high-quality coastal weather & climate data for research and disaster risk reduction

- In 2024, the Govt approved 'Mission Mausam' with an outlay of Rs 2,000 Cr over the next 2 years
- Implemented by – IMD + IITM + National Centre for Medium-Range Weather Forecasting

News - 186

- India's 1st State-led CoE SpaceTech Foundation – launched in Bengaluru, Karnataka
- Aim: To strengthen India's capabilities to translate space innovation into scalable, commercial outcomes
- CoE is established through – Karnataka Innovation & Technology Society (in collab with SIA-India)
- Karnataka: Capital – Bangalore | CM – Siddaramaiah | Governor – Thaawarchand Gehlot

News - 187

- "Mission Drishti" – World's 1st OptoSAR satellite developed by GalaxEye (Bengaluru)
  - successfully launched by SpaceX aboard Falcon 9 from Vandenberg, California
- Weight - 190 kg | India's largest privately developed Earth observation (EO) satellite
- It is the 1st satellite globally to integrate Electro-Optical (EO) & Synthetic Aperture Radar (SAR) sensors into a single platform for all-weather, day-and-night imaging
- HQs of GalaxEye – Bengaluru, Karnataka | CEO & Co-Founder – Suyash Singh

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News - 188

- India – conducted 2nd flight test of DRDO-developed long-range hypersonic anti-ship missile off the Odisha coast
  - Strike range – 1,500 km | Speed – Mach 10
- The 2nd test focused on a two-stage hypersonic glide vehicle design
  - 1st test of the missile was conducted in Nov 2024
- The missile is developed by laboratories of Dr APJ Abdul Kalam Missile Complex, Hyderabad
- HQs of DRDO – New Delhi | Chairman – Samir V. Kamat | Established in – 1958

News - 189

- SpaceX – successfully launched South Korea's "Compact Advanced Satellite 500-2 (CAS500-2)"
  - Aboard a Falcon 9 rocket from Space Launch Complex 4 East (SLC-4E) at Vandenberg Space Force Base, California
  - Deploying satellite into a Sun-synchronous orbit at an altitude of 528 km & inclination of 98.1 degrees
- Developed by – Korea Aerospace Research Institute (KARI) under Korea AeroSpace Administration (KASA)
- It is an Earth-observation satellite equipped with 'Advanced Earth Imaging Sensor System (AEISS-C)' payload
- It was originally scheduled to launch in 2022 on a Russian Soyuz rocket
- It also carried 44 additional rideshare payloads from multiple operators including:
  - Planet Labs, Argotec, Lynk Global, True Anomaly & others
- CAS500 programme – aims to operate a total of 5 satellites

Join us

- CAS500-3 – launched aboard South Korea's indigenous Nuri rocket (KSLV-II) in Nov 2025
- CAS500-4 & CAS500-5 – yet to be launched

- HQs of SpaceX – Texas, U.S. | Founder & CEO – Elon Musk | Founded in – 2002

News - 190

- IITM Pune (operating under 'Mission Mausam') established a state-of-the-art "Urban Testbed and Aerosol Observatory"
  - At SRM Institute of Science and Technology (SRMIST) in Ramapuram, Chennai
- Dr M. Ravichandran (Secretary of MoES) – inaugurated lab & 'Centre for Atmospheric Science Research and Innovation
- Mission Mausam – approved by GoI in 2024 | Outlay – Rs 2,000 Cr over next 2 years
  - To enhance India's ability to predict & respond to extreme weather events & impacts of climate change
  - Being implemented by – IMD, IITM & National Centre for Medium-Range Weather Forecasting
  - Supported by other MoES bodies – Indian National Centre for Ocean Information Services, NCPOR & NIOT

News - 191

- IIT Madras Global Research Foundation (IITM Global) – established its first US centre in Menlo Park, California
  - in partnership with CA Startups
  - announced at the 'SelectUSA Investment Summit' in National Harbor, Maryland
- The project involves a total planned investment of $7.5 million (including a $4.5 million IITM Global)
- Prof V. Kamakoti – Director of IIT Madras and Chairman of IITM Global

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News - 192

- Pixxel – awarded contract by National Reconnaissance Office (NRO) for advanced commercial remote sensing capabilities under CSO
- Objective – Support US Govt's effort to integrate commercial hyperspectral data into NRO's remote sensing architecture
- 'Firefly Constellation' – Pixxel's operational constellation of 6 hyperspectral satellites launched in 2025
  - It is India's 1st private commercial satellite constellation
- Pixxel was founded in 2019 by = Awais Ahmed + Kshitij Khandelwal (BITS Pilani)
- "Shakuntala", India's First Hyperspectral Satellite by Pixxel – launched in April 2022 aboard a SpaceX mission
- Global hyperspectral imaging market – to reach $299.8 million by 2026 & $619.47 million by 2031 (CAGR: 15.62%)
- HQs of Pixxel – Bengaluru, Karnataka | Founder & CEO – Awais Ahmed

News - 193

- Skyroot Aerospace – became India's 1st space-tech unicorn after raising $60 million (~ ₹510 Cr) in funding
  - Investors – Co-led by Sherpalo Ventures & GIC (Singapore)
- Skyroot Aerospace was founded in 2018 by = Pawan Kumar Chandana + Naga Bharath Daka
- Milestone – Launched "Vikram-S" in Nov 2022, India's 1st privately built rocket to reach space in a sub-orbital mission

Join us

- Future Plans – Vikram-1 maiden flight in June 2026 | Goal: 72-hour assembly-to-launch capability
- HQs of Skyroot Aerospace – Hyderabad, Telangana | CEO – Pawan Kumar Chandana

News - 194

- DRDO – opened a CBRN field training & demonstration centre at Burari plains in Delhi
- The centre will comprise a dedicated radiological & nuclear test bed facility and heavy ion research facility
- The centre is part of the upcoming DRDO-CBRN CoE under Institute of Nuclear Medicine & Allied Sciences (INMAS)
- HQs of DRDO – New Delhi | Chairman – Samir V. Kamat | Established in – 1958

News - 195

- India – conducted flight-trial of Advanced "Agni" missile with MIRV system from Dr APJ Abdul Kalam Island, Odisha
  - MIRV – **M**ultiple **I**ndependently Targeted **R**e-Entry **V**ehicle (developed by = DRDO + BARC)
- Agni-5 (with range over 5,000 km) – became India's longest-range missile tested
- India – joined exclusive group of nations possessing MIRV technology including US, Russia, China, UK & France

News - 196

- DRDL, Hyderabad (DRDO) – conducted a long-duration test of its 'Actively Cooled Full Scale Scramjet Combustor'
  - at Scramjet Connect Pipe Test (SCPT) Facility in Hyderabad (achieving a run-time of over 1,200 secs)
- HQs of DRDO – New Delhi | Chairman – Samir V. Kamat | Established in – 1958

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News - 197

- Prabhat Kumar (India's High Commissioner to South Africa) – formally handed over a banner of India's Inter-University Centre for Astronomy and Astrophysics (IUCAA) to the South African Astronomical Observatory (SAAO)
- A centrepiece of the India-South Africa astronomy partnership is – "Southern African Large Telescope (SALT)"
  - the largest single optical telescope in the Southern Hemisphere, located near Sutherland in the Northern Cape
  - Funded by international consortium of partners from – South Africa, US, Germany, Poland, India, UK, & New Zealand
- India currently holds the '2026 BRICS' chairship
- SAAO – a facility of the National Research Foundation (NRF) of South Africa
- HQs of IUCAA – Pune, Maharashtra | Director – Prof. R. Srianand | Established in – 1988

News - 198

- OpenAI announced "Daybreak", a new cybersecurity-focused initiative
  - To help software developers & security teams detect vulnerabilities, validate fixes & patch systems using AI tools
- OpenAI introduced multiple cyber-focused configurations of GPT-5.5
- HQs of OpenAI – California, US | CEO – Sam Altman | President – Greg Brockman

Join us

News - 199

- Dr Jitendra Singh (MoS (I/C) for S&T) – launched 2 advanced weather forecast products developed under MoES
- These 2 products include introduction of first-ever AI driven system by IMD in form of AI-enabled "Forecast of Monsoon Advance over Different Parts of the Country" & a "High Spatial Resolution Rainfall Forecast for Uttar Pradesh" as a pilot service
- Developed jointly by – IMD + IITM (Pune) +NCMRWF
- 'High Spatial Resolution Rainfall Forecast for UP' – developed as a pilot service
  - To generate rainfall forecasts at 1-km spatial resolution up to 10 days in advance
- MoS (I/C) in the Ministry of Science & Technology: Dr. Jitendra Singh | Constituency – Udhampur, J&K

News - 200

- Flying Wedge Defence & Aerospace – established its 1st international manufacturing node in Portugal for its flagship autonomous combat aircraft, "Kaal Bhairava" under Operation 777
- 'Kaal Bhairava' (India's 1st AI-powered combat aircraft) – will be manufactured in Portugal
  - In partnership with – SKETCHPIXEL LDA (Portugal)
  - It is a 'MALE (Medium Altitude Long Endurance)' autonomous combat aircraft (range - 3,000)
- Objective of 'Operation 777': To establish manufacturing, integration, and deployment partnerships for Indian-origin autonomous warfare systems across 7 continents & 77 countries
- HQs of FWDA – Bangalore, Karnataka | Founder & CEO – Suhas Tejaskanda

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News - 201

- Ashwini Vaishnaw – virtually inaugurated India's 1st SME semiconductor facility of Sahasra Semiconductors Pvt Ltd
  - Semiconductor Assembly, Testing, Marking & Packaging (ATMP/OSAT) facility | At – Bhiwadi, Rajasthan
- Developed under – MeitY's 'Scheme for Promotion of Manufacturing of Electronic Components & Semiconductors'
  - Set up with an investment of over ₹150 Cr across 57,000 sq. ft. & is equipped with Class 10K & 100K cleanrooms
- Capacity: Current annual packaging – 60 million semiconductor units | SPECS-supported projected – 43 million units
- 'Electronics Manufacturing Cluster (EMC)' – also inaugurated, developed by ELCINA at Salarpur, Khushkhera, Bhiwadi
  - Project cost – ₹46.09 Cr | Government of India's direct support (under EMC scheme) – ₹20.24 Cr

News - 202

- "Solar wind Magnetosphere Ionosphere Link Explorer (SMILE)" spacecraft – launched on May 19, 2026
  - From – Europe's Spaceport in French Guiana | Aboard – European Vega-C rocket
  - It is a joint mission between European Space Agency & Chinese Academy of Sciences
- It is equipped with 4 science instruments including a Soft X-ray Imager led by UK researchers & an Ultraviolet Imager

Join us

News - 203

- DRDO – completed the final development trials of the "Unmanned Aerial Vehicle Launched Precision Guided Missile (ULPGM)-V3" at a DRDO test range near Kurnool in Andhra Pradesh
- The tests were successful in both air-to-ground and air-to-air modes
- ULPGM-V3 (aka ULM-ER) is an indigenous, fire-&-forget, precision-guided missile
  - Developed by – Research Centre Imarat (RIC), Hyderabad | In collab with other DRDO laboratories
- DRDO partnered with BDL and Adani Defence Systems & Technologies for the production of the missiles
- The system is integrated with UAVs developed by Newspace Research and Technologies, Bengaluru

News - 204

- NIBE Ltd carried out firing demonstration of EXTRA & Predator Hawk "Suryastra" rockets from ITR Chandipur, Odisha
  - Range: EXTRA – 150 km | Suryastra – 300 km
- Suryastra – India's 1st indigenous, universal multi-caliber rocket launcher system
- NIBE Ltd received a Rs 293 Cr purchase order in Jan 2026 from Indian Army under emergency procurement
  - For supply of Suryastra universal rocket launcher & rockets
- HQs of NIBE Ltd – Pune, Maharashtra | CEO – Ranjan Choudhary | MD – Ganesh Nibe

News - 205

- ICAR-CRRI – developed & experimentally validated "Plant-OpenCRISPR1 (POC1)"
  - It is world's 1st AI-designed genome-editing tool for plants
  - It is developed by a team of scientists, led by Kutubuddin Ali Molla
- It builds on OpenCRISPR-1 (OC1), an AI-generated nuclease developed for human cells
- HQs of ICAR-CRRI – Cuttack, Odisha | Director – Dr. A.K. Nayak | Established in – 1945

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News - 206

- Kerala – created India's 1st dedicated AI portfolio at cabinet level following UDF Govt's formation
  - P. K. Kunhalikutty – assigned newly created AI department
- Advocate T. Asaf Ali – appointed as Director General of Prosecution
- Advocate Jaju Babu – appointed as Advocate General
- Kerala: Capital – Thiruvananthapuram | CM – V D Satheesan | Governor – Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar

News - 207

- NIBE Ltd completed no-cost, no-commitment (NCNC) demonstration of its loitering munition "Vayu Astra-1"
  - During trials conducted at Pokhran in Rajasthan & Joshimath (Malari) in Uttarakhand | Range – 100 km
- NCNC means government neither pays for trials nor commits to purchasing products afterwards
- HQs of NIBE Ltd – Pune, Maharashtra | CEO – Prakash Khose | MD – Ganesh Nibe

Join us

News - 208

- Department of Space approved establishment of Common Technical Facilities (CTFs) in Gujarat & Tamil Nadu
- To be developed with support from – Indian National Space Promotion and Authorisation Centre (IN-SPACe)
- Gujarat government identified land at Khoraj for a Space Manufacturing Park
- Tamil Nadu plans to establish a Space Vehicles Cluster at Thoothukudi
  - Located near upcoming small launch vehicle complex at Kulasekharapatnam
- Gujarat: Capital – Gandhinagar | CM – Bhupendra Patel | Governor – Acharya Dev Vrat
- Tamil Nadu: Capital – Chennai | CM – C Joseph Vijay | Governor – Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar

News - 209

- India test-launched short-range ballistic missile Agni-1 from Integrated Test Range in Balasore, Odisha
  - Carried out under aegis of – Strategic Forces Command
- Agni-1 – a road-mobile, solid-fuelled missile with a range of around 700 km
- DRDO developed Agni-1 under Integrated Guided Missile Development Programme (IGMDP)
  - It was inducted into Indian Armed Forces in 2004
- On May 8, 2026, India carried out a flight trial of an advanced Agni missile with a 'MIRV' off coast of State
  - MIRV – Multiple Independently Targetable Re-Entry Vehicle

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News - 210

- Anusandhan National Research Foundation – selected 10 Convergence Research CoEs to promote multidisciplinary research
  - IIT Gandhinagar, NIAS Bengaluru, IIT Madras, NIT Agartala, IHD Delhi, IIT Dharwad, IIM Jammu, IIT Kanpur, Chanakya University & PSGR Krishnammal College for Women
- ANRF Convergence Research Centres of Excellence Program draws inspiration from National Education Policy (NEP) 2020
- HQs of ANRF – New Delhi | CEO – Shivkumar Kalyanaraman | Established in – 2023

News - 211

- China – launched "Shenzhou-23" spacecraft with 3 astronauts heading to its Tiangong space station
- Launched using – Long March-2F Y23 carrier rocket from Jiuquan Satellite Launch Center in northwest China
- Astronauts on mission – Li Jiaying (1st from Hong Kong), Zhu Yangzhu & Zhang Yuanzhi (China)
- China became 1st country, in June 2024, to recover lunar samples from moon's far side, using robots
- China – also conducting world's 1st human artificial embryo experiment in space
- China – Beijing – Renminbi | President – Xi Jinping | PM – Li Qiang

Join us

News - 212

- NASA – announced 3 missions to moon as part of efforts to establish a permanent base on earth's natural satellite
- Jared Isaacman (NASA Administrator) – unveiled a $20 billion plan to set up a permanent base on moon
- NASA selected Blue Origin's Blue Moon Mark 1 Endurance lander for Moon Base-I mission, planned until Sep 2026
  - It will land on Shackleton Connecting Ridge
- Moon Base II mission – to deliver 1,100+ pounds of cargo on Astrobotic's Griffin lander
- Moon Base III mission – to carry NASA's Lunar Vertex science mission to study mysterious lunar swirls
- Under this 3-phased programme, NASA will test technologies & prepare for surface operations over next 3 years
- Aim: To deliver at least one lunar terrain vehicle for use by astronauts expected to return to lunar surface in 2028
- Moon base's 2nd phase (from 2029 to 2032) – to start building up permanent infrastructure
- HQs of NASA – Washington D.C., US | Administrator (15th) – Jared Isaacman | Founded in – 1958

News - 213

- ICMR organized "Medical Innovations Patent Mitra: Innovators-to-Industry Connect", at Manekshaw Centre, New Delhi
  - It is India's largest biomedical & technology transfer facilitation event
- During this event, 'Indian Biomedical Patent Landscape Report' & 'Technology Compendium' were also released
- HQs of ICMR – New Delhi, India | Director General – Rajiv Bahl | Established in – 1911

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News - 214

- Andhra Pradesh – launching an 'angel fund' to help startups in AI, deep tech, electronics, quantum technologies & advanced manufacturing
- This initiative is in partnership with SIDBI & through Ratan Tata Innovation Hub (RTIH), it will provide capital & resources
- Angel fund – a sub-category of Venture Capital Fund under Category I Alternative Investment Fund (AIF)
- Andhra Pradesh: Capital – Amaravati | CM – N Chandra Babu Naidu | Governor – Syed Abdul Nazeer

News - 215

- "Centre for HR Information Systems, Research and Analytics in Governance (CHIRAG)" – inaugurated at SCR Grounds, in Moula-Ali, Secunderabad, Telangana

News - 216

- Red Balloon Aerospace – launched "Mission SANA", India's 1st indigenous high-altitude super-pressure balloon
  - carrying commercial payloads from 7 national & international partners
- VISTA platform – ascended ~25 km from Indira Gandhi Stadium, Vijayawada
  - It provides persistent telecom, disaster monitoring, earth observation & surveillance capabilities
- Stratospheric platform – bridges 20-50 km gap between aircraft (<10 km) & satellites (>160 km) offering high-resolution imaging, longer dwell time, flexible deployment & rapid disaster response

Join us

- Mission SANA – validates Red Balloon Aerospace's 3-platform roadmap:
  - VISTA balloons, ALTIS tethered aerostats, HELIX long-endurance stratospheric airships with autonomous navigation
- India – becomes 1 of 5 nations with indigenous stratospheric (hydrogen) balloon capability
  - alongside US, France, Japan & China
- HQs of Red Balloon Aerospace – Vijayawada, Andhra Pradesh | CEO – Dr. C. V. S. Kiran | Established in – 2025

News - 217

- IIT Madras – launched a state-of-the-art "Circulating Water Tunnel facility" at 'Discovery', its satellite campus in Chennai
  - Constructed with Rs 4.5 Cr in CSR funding from Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited (MDL)
- The facility provides a stable, uniform-flow test section designed for advanced hydrodynamic investigations
- Director of IIT Madras – Prof. V. Kamakoti

News - 218

- IAF + IIT Bombay = signed 3 contracts to develop 'health index' for Su-30 MKI engines under midlife maintenance to reduce service costs, increase availability & operational life
- IIT Bombay – developing AI digital twins model for diagnostics & prognostics of Su-30 MKI gas turbine engines
- Director of IIT Bombay – Prof. Shireesh Kedare
- HQs of IAF – New Delhi | Chief – Air Marshal Amar Preet Singh | Vice Chief – Air Marshal Nagesh Kapoor

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Appointments & Resignations

News - 219

- Dilip Kumar – appointed as Chief Vigilance Officer of SAIL w.e.f. Apr 27, 2026
- HQs of SAIL – New Delhi | CMD – Krishna Kumar Singh (addi. charge) | Founded – January 24, 1973

News - 220

- Anugraha Narayana Das – assumed charge as the Controller General of Defence Accounts (CGDA)
  - Succeeding - Vishvajit Sahay

News - 221

- Justice (retired) Anupinder Singh Grewal – appointed as President of the National Company Law Tribunal (NCLT)
  - He was a former judge of Punjab & Haryana HC
  - He succeeds Justice (retired) Ramalingam Sudhakar (former Chief Justice of Manipur HC)
- He will hold office for 5 years
- Justice Grewal is the first senior puisne judge of a high court to be appointed to the role

Join us

News - 222

- Vishvajit Sahay – took charge as Secretary (Defence Finance) in Ministry of Defence
- Previously, he was serving as Controller General of Defence Accounts
- Minister of Defence: Rajnath Singh | Constituency – Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh
  MoS in Ministry of Defence: Sanjay Seth

News - 223

- MoI&B – appointed noted filmmaker Ashutosh Gowariker as Festival Director for 57th edition of IFFI to be held in Goa
- IFFI (1952) – South Asia's oldest & most enduring celebration of cinema
- Jointly hosted by = NFDC + Entertainment Society of Goa
- Minister of Information and Broadcasting: Ashwini Vaishnaw | Constituency – Odisha
  MoS in Ministry of Information & Broadcasting: Dr. L. Murugan

News - 224

- Dr R. Balasubramaniam & Dr Joram Aniya – appointed as full-time members of NITI Aayog
- Appointments were approved by the Prime Minister, who serves as the Chairperson of NITI Aayog
- Dr Joram Aniya became the 1st woman from North East India to hold this position
  - She is the 1st woman from Nyishi community to earn a PhD & 1st in the state to do so in Hindi language
- R. Balasubramaniam – wrote "Power Within: The Leadership Legacy of Narendra Modi" book
  - He is the brain behind the 'Karmayogi Competency Framework' developed by CBC
- HQs of NITI Aayog – New Delhi | CEO – Nidhi Chhibber | Chair – Narendra Modi | VC – Ashok Lahiri

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News - 225

- Kumar Mangalam Birla – appointed as Non-Executive Chairman of Vodafone Idea Limited's Board of Directors
  - W.e.f. – May 5, 2026 | Succeeding – Ravinder Takkar
- HQs of Vodafone Idea Ltd – Gandhinagar, Gujarat | Chairman – Kumar Mangalam Birla | CEO – Abhijit Kishore

News - 226

- Shashi Shekhar Vempati (Co-founder of AI4India Org) – appointed as CBFC for 3 years (succeeding - Prasoon Joshi)
- CBFC – a statutory body under MoI&B, regulating public exhibition of films under provisions of Cinematograph Act, 1952
- CBFC consists of non-official members & a chairman (all appointed by central government)
- HQs of CBFC – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairperson – Shashi Shekhar Vempati | CEO – Rajendra Singh

News - 227

- Prasoon Joshi – appointed as Chairman of Prasar Bharati
  - He previously served as – Chairperson of Central Board of Film Certification

Join us

- Prasar Bharati – established under Prasar Bharati Act of 1990 & operational since 1997
- HQs of Prasar Bharati – New Delhi | CEO – Gaurav Dwivedi | Chairman – Prasoon Joshi

News - 228

- Priyanka Mittal (Director, KRBL Ltd) – nominated as Co-Chair of Indian side of the Saudi-India Business Council (SIBC)
- SIBC is a premier bilateral platform jointly established by = FICCI + Federation of Saudi Chambers (FSC)
  - It facilitates investment opportunities between India and the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia
- Siddeek Ahmed (Co-Chair, FICCI Arab Council & Chairman, Eram Holdings) – nominated as Chair of Indian side of SIBC
- HQs of SIBC (Indian side) – New Delhi | Chair – Dr. Siddeek Ahmed | Co-Chair – Priyanka Mittal
- HQs of FICCI – Delhi | DG – Jyoti Vij | President – Anant Goenka | Founded – 1927

News - 229

- Vice Adm Krishna Swaminathan (PVSM, AVSM, VSM) – appointed as 26th Chief of Naval Staff, w.e.f. May 31, 2026
  - Succeeding – Admiral Dinesh Kumar Tripathi | He also became 34th to lead Indian Navy since Independence
- Currently, he is serving as – 34th Flag Officer Commanding-in-Chief of Western Naval Command (HQs in Mumbai)
- He is recognised with – Param Vishisht Seva Medal (2026), Ati Vishisht Seva Medal (2021) & Vishisht Seva Medal (2017)
- HQs of Indian Navy – Delhi | Chief – Admiral Dinesh K. Tripathi (From May 31 - Krishna Swaminathan) | Vice Chief – VAdm Sanjay Vatsayan

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News - 230

- LG NS Raja Subramani (PVSM, AVSM, SM, VSM (Retd)) – appointed as 3rd Chief of Defence Staff, w.e.f. May 31, 2026
  - Succeeding – General Anil Chauhan
  - He will also function as – Secretary to Government of India, Department of Military Affairs
- He is currently serving as – Military Adviser to National Security Council Secretariat (NSCS)
- He is 2nd consecutive CDS to be recalled from retirement, after General Anil Chauhan (recalled in Sep 2022)
- Post of CDS – created in Dec 2019 | On recommendation of – Kargil Review Committee
  - General Bipin Rawat – became 1st CDS on Jan 1, 2020
- He has been recognised with – Param Vishisht Seva Medal (PVSM), Ati Vishisht Seva Medal (AVSM), Sena Medal (SM) & Vishisht Seva Medal (VSM)

News - 231

- Suvendu Adhikari (BJP) – sworn in as CM of West Bengal on May 10, 2026
  - It marks first time since independence that BJP has formed a government in West Bengal
  - Oath was administered by – Governor R N Ravi
  - 5 Cabinet Min. (also appointed) – Dilip Ghosh, Agnimitra Paul, Ashok Kirtania, Nisith Pramanik & Kshudiram Tudu
- West Bengal: Capital – Kolkata | CM – Suvendu Adhikari | Governor – R N Ravi

Join us

News - 232

- C. Joseph Vijay (Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam) – sworn in as CM of Tamil Nadu on May 10, 2026
  - Oath was administered by – Governor Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar | 9 ministers were also sworn in
- Tamil Nadu: Capital – Chennai | CM – C. Joseph Vijay | Governor – Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar

News - 233

- Laura Fernández Delgado – sworn in as 50th President of Costa Rica (for a 4-year term from 2026 to 2030)
  - Succeeding – Rodrigo Chaves Robles (2022-2026)
- She became Costa Rica's 2nd female President (after Laura Chinchilla Miranda)
- Under Costa Rica's constitution, Presidents are not allowed to serve 2 consecutive terms
- Costa Rica – San José – Costa Rican Colón | President – Laura Fernández Delgado

News - 234

- Rumen Radev – elected as the new Prime Minister of Bulgaria (replacing - Andrey Gyurov)
- Radev served as Bulgaria's President from 2017 until his resignation in 2026
- Bulgaria – Sofia – Lev | President – Iliana Iotova | PM – Rumen Radev

News - 235

- Ashok Kumar Panda – appointed as CMD of SAIL (succeeding - Amarendu Prakash)
- HQs of SAIL – New Delhi | CMD – Krishna Kumar Singh (addi. charge) | Founded – January 24, 1973

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News - 236

- Himanta Biswa Sarma – took oath as CM of Assam for 2nd successive term (first time for a non-Congress leader in Assam)
- Governor Lakshman Prasad Acharya administered the oath of office and secrecy to Sarma
  - This is the NDA's 3rd consecutive term in Assam
- The only other non-Congress Chief Minister who served 2 terms (but not successive) is – Prafulla Kumar Mahanta
  - Tarun Gogoi (Congress) – the only one to serve three complete terms (from May 2001 to May 2016)
- Assam: Capital – Dispur | CM – Himanta Biswa Sarma | Governor – Lakshman Prasad Acharya

News - 237

- Anant Swarup – appointed as Secretary General of FICCI
- Prior to joining FICCI, Swarup served as Senior Advisor at Lumiere Law Partners (EY India)
- HQs of FICCI – Delhi | DG – Jyoti Vij | President – Anant Goenka | Founded – 1927

Join us

News - 238

- Dinesh Trivedi – appointed as the next High Commissioner of India to Bangladesh (succeeding - Pranay Verma)
  - making him 1st political appointee to head Indian High Commission in Dhaka (traditionally held by IFS officers)
- Pranay Verma – named India's next Ambassador to Belgium & European Union (EU)
- Bangladesh – Dhaka – Taka | President – Mohammed Shahabuddin | PM – Tarique Rahman

News - 239

- N. Rangasamy (Leader of AINRC) – appointed as Chief Minister of Puducherry for a record 5th term
- The elections recorded the highest-ever voter turnout for a Puducherry assembly election at 89.87%
- Puducherry: CM – N. Rangasamy | Lt. Governor – K. Kailashnathan | CM – N. Rangasamy

News - 240

- Dr Harvansh Chawla – appointed as Chairman of BRISEC Chamber of Commerce & Industry (BRISEC CCI)
- He previously served as – Chairman of BRICS Chamber of Commerce & Industry (BRICS CCI
- BRISEC Chamber of Commerce & Industry – recognised by NITI Aayog

News - 241

- R Mukundan (MD & CEO of Tata Chemicals) – appointed as President of Confederation of Indian Industry for 2026-27
  - Succeeding – Rajiv Memani
- Suchitra K Ella (Co-Founder & MD of Bharat Biotech) – appointed as President-Designate for 2026-27 of CII
- Shashwat Goenka (Vice-Chairman of RP-Sanjiv Goenka Group) – appointed as Vice President of CII
- HQs of CII – New Delhi | President – R Mukundan | VP – Shashwat Goenka | DG – Chandrajit Banerjee

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News - 242

- Sunil Bharti Mittal – reappointed as Chairman of Bharti Airtel for 5 years (from Oct 2026 to Sep 2031)
- Nisaba Godrej – reappointed as an Independent Director of Bharti Airtel for a 2nd term for 5 years
- HQs of Bharti Airtel – New Delhi | MD & CEO – Shashwat Sharma | Chairman – Sunil Bharti Mittal

News - 243

- Yoweri Museveni – sworn as the President of Uganda (7th term)
  - extending his 40-year tenure following a landslide victory in the Jan 2026 elections
- Since taking office in 1986, Museveni has twice changed the constitution to remove term & age limits
- Uganda – Kampala – Ugandan Shilling | President – Yoweri Museveni | PM – Robinah Nabbanja

Join us

News - 244

- Akash Ambani – appointed MD of Jio Platforms for 5 years
- Akash Ambani – serving as Chairman of Reliance Jio Infocomm Ltd (RJIL), the telecom arm of Jio Platforms
- HQs of Jio Platforms – Mumbai, MH | Chairman – Mukesh Ambani | MD – Akash Ambani | CEO – Kiran Thomas

News - 245

- V. D. Satheesan (All India Congress Committee) – sworn in as 13th Chief Minister of Kerala
- He served as Leader of the Opposition in Kerala Assembly from 2021 to 2026
- Kerala: Capital – Thiruvananthapuram | CM – V. D. Satheesan | Governor – Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar

News - 246

- Praveen Sood – tenure extended as CBI Director for 1 year
- CBI – set up in 1963 by a resolution of Ministry of Home Affairs
  - Now, it comes under administrative control of Department of Personnel and Training (MoPPG&P)
  - It derives its powers from – Delhi Special Police Establishment Act, 1946
- HQs of CBI – New Delhi | DG – Praveen Sood | Motto – "Industry, Impartiality, Integrity"

News - 247

- Periasamy Kumaran – assumed charge as India's new High Commissioner to UK (succeeding - Vikram Doraiswami)
- Vikram Doraiswami – took over as India's Ambassador to China
- UK – London – Pound Sterling | PM – Keir Starmer | New King – King Charles III
- China – Beijing – Renminbi | President – Xi Jinping | PM – Li Qiang

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News - 248

- Ali Falih Kadhim al-Zaidi – became youngest PM of Iraq (succeeding - Mohammed Shia-al-Sudani)
- Iraq – Baghdad – Iraqi dinar | PM – Ali Falih Kadhim al-Zaidi | President – Nizar Amedi

News - 249

- Vadasseri Damodara Menon Satheesan – sworn in as 13th Chief Minister of Kerala (succeeding - Pinarayi Vijayan)
  - He belonged to – United Democratic Front
- Oath was administered by – Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar (Governor of Kerala)
- Kerala: Capital – Thiruvananthapuram | CM – V D Satheesan | Governor – Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar

Join us

News - 250

- Saurabh Vijay – assumed charge as CEO of UIDAI (succeeding - Vivek Chandra Verma)
- UIDAI – statutory authority established under Aadhaar Act, 2016, under MeitY
- Aadhaar – a 12-digit biometric identification number issued by UIDAI
- HQs of UIDAI – New Delhi | Chairman – Neelkanth Mishra | CEO – Saurabh Vijay

News - 251

- RBI decided against activating countercyclical capital buffer (CCyB) after review & empirical analysis of CCyB indicators
- The framework on CCyB laid out in 'RBI (Commercial Banks - Prudential Norms on Capital Adequacy) Directions, 2025'
- CCyB framework (established by RBI in Feb 2015) – envisages the credit-to-GDP gap as the main indicator
- The mechanism serves two broad objectives:
  - requiring banks to build additional capital buffers during periods of economic expansion
  - curbing indiscriminate lending during phases of excessive credit growth to prevent system-wide risk build-up in the banking sector
- The concept of countercyclical capital measures emerged following the 2008 global financial crisis
  - proposed by – Basel Committee on Banking Supervision
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935
  Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | T. Rabi Sankar | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poon

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News - 252

- Medha Vishram Kulkarni (BJP member) – nominated as chairperson of Department-related Parliamentary Standing Committee on Science & Technology, Environment, Forests & Climate Change
- Sudheer Gupta (BJP member) – appointed as chairperson of Joint Committee on Corporate Laws (Amendment) Bill, 2026
- Currently, there are 24 Department-related Parliamentary Standing Committees (DRSCs)
- Out of 24, Chairman of 8 Committees are appointed by Chairman of Rajya Sabha
  - Chairman of remaining 16 Committees are appointed by Speaker of Lok Sabha

News - 253

- Bharat Singh Chauhan – re-elected as Chairman of Commonwealth Chess Association (CCA) for a 4-year term
  - currently the Chairman of FIDE's advisory board & the Deputy President of Asian Chess Federation (ACF)
  - previously served as Secretary of All-India Chess Federation (AICF)
- Akhramsyah Muammar Ubaidsh Sanusi (Malaysia) – elected unopposed as the CCA's Deputy Chairman
- G. Luxman Wijesuriya (Sri Lanka) – elected as the General Secretary | Vicky Magu (South Africa) – became the Treasurer
- 1st edition of 'Commonwealth School Chess Championship' – to be held in Malaysia (in Oct 2026)
- Annual General Body Meeting of the Commonwealth Chess Association – held in Wasakaduwa, Sri Lanka
- HQs of CCA – Meetings rotate among members | Chairman – Bharat Singh Chauhan | Established in – 1980

Join us

News - 254

- Anurag Garg – extension approved as Director General of NCB till July 31, 2027 (superannuation)
- Originally appointed as NCB DG on – Sep 2024
- Under Garg's leadership, NCB conducted multiple anti-drug operations including first-ever Captagon seizure in India
- HQs of NCB – New Delhi | DG – Anurag Garg | Established in – 1985

News - 255

- Rohit Rajpal (India's Davis Cup captain) – appointed as India's Chef de Mission for '2026 Commonwealth Games' in Glasgow (July 23 to August 2, 2026)
  - Ravi Bengani – Deputy Chef de Mission
  - Vandana Rao & Rahul Swami – to travel with Indian contingent as General Team Managers for Games
- P T Usha (IOA President), Raghuram Iyer (IOA CEO) & Vignesh Vengalil Ujjwal – to be part of senior leadership delegation
- Rajpal – an Executive Committee member of IOA & Vice-President of All-India Tennis Association (AITA)

News - 256

- C. P. Radhakrishnan (Rajya Sabha Chairman) – reconstituted 10-member 'Committee on Petitions'
  - Raghav Chadha (Punjab Rajya Sabha MP) – appointed as its Chairman
- Raghav Chadha – a youngest Rajya Sabha MP ever appointed at age 33 (in Apr 2022 as a Punjab representative)

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News - 257

- Ahmadou Al Aminou Lo – appointed as PM of Senegal (replacing - Ousmane Sonko)
- Ousmane Sonko (Senegal former PM) – elected Speaker of National Parliament (replacing - El Malick Ndiaye)
- Senegal – Dakar – West African CFA Franc | PM – Ahmadou Al Aminou Lo | President – Bassirou Diomaye Faye

News - 258

- P. Jawahar – assumed charge as Chairman of Marine Products Export Development Authority (MPEDA) for 5 years
  - Succeeding – Dodda Venkata Swamy
- Previously, he served as – Chief Electoral Officer & Commissioner/Secretary to Government of Puducherry
- MPEDA – established in 1972 & is apex body under Ministry of Commerce & Industry
- HQs of MPEDA – Kochi, Kerala | Chairman – P. Jawahar | Established in – 1972

News - 259

- Piyush Singla – appointed as Director in National Health Authority-Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission (NHA-ABDM)
  - Under Ministry of Health & Family Welfare | The tenure co-terminus with the mission

Join us

Awards, Rewards, Recognition & Prizes

News - 260

- Anand RK and Suparna Sharma (2 Indian journalists) – won "Pulitzer Prize 2026" (along with Natalie Obiko Pearson)
  - In 'Illustrated Reporting and Commentary' category
  - Award was given for project titled 'trAPPed'
- Pulitzer Prize – highest journalism award in US & started in 1917
- Administered by – Columbia University & Pulitzer Prize Board
- Pulitzer Prize Board – composed of judges appointed by Columbia University
- Each award winner carries – a certificate & prize money of $15,000
  - Award winner in 'Public Service Category' receives a gold medal
- Key Winners of the Pulitzer Prize 2026:
  - Public Service: The Washington Post
  - Breaking News Reporting: The Minnesota Star Tribune
  - Investigative Reporting: The New York Times
  - Explanatory Reporting: Susie Neilson, Megan Fan Munce, and Sara DiNatale (San Francisco Chronicle)
  - Local Reporting: Dave Altimari & Ginny Monk (The Connecticut Mirror) and Sophie Chou & Haru Coryne (ProPublica)
  - National Reporting: Reuters
  - International Reporting: Dake Kang, Garance Burke, Byron Tau, Aniruddha Ghosal and Yael Grauer, contributor (Associated Press)
  - Feature Writing: Aaron Parsley (Texas Monthly)
  - Audio Reporting: Meadowlark Media (Pablo Torre Finds Out)
  - Special Citation: Julie K. Brown of Miami Herald for her groundbreaking reporting in 2017 and 2018 that exposed Jeffrey Epstein's systematic abuse of young women, the justice system that protected him.

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News - 261

- O.P. Jindal Global University (JGU) – 1st Institution of Eminence in India accredited by Data Science Council of America
  - awarded under the World Data Science & AI Initiative (WDSAI), a global platform led by DASCA
- 7 of JGU's flagship AI & Data Science-related programmes – aligned with DASCA standards under WDSAI framework
- The accreditation is valid until 2031 | JGU is based in – Sonipat, Haryana

Join us

News - 262

- Winners of "National Panchayat Awards 2025 (NPA-2025)" – announced by Ministry of Panchayati Raj
  - Award distribution ceremony – scheduled for Jun 3, 2026, in New Delhi
  - MoPR selects 42 Panchayats from 17 States & UTs for their outstanding achievements in local governance
- Highest number of awards secured by – Karnataka (6 Panchayats) | Followed by – Andhra Pradesh & Odisha (5 each)
- Awards are conferred under 2 primary categories:
  - 'Deen Dayal Upadhyay Panchayat Satat Vikas Puraskar (DDUPSVP)' – for performance across 9 LSDGs themes
  - 'Nanaji Deshmukh Sarvottam Panchayat Satat Vikas Puraskar (NDSPSVP)' – across 3 administrative tiers (District, Block & Gram Panchayat levels)
- 9 Localisation of Sustainable Development Goals (LSDGs) themes:
  - Poverty-Free and Enhanced Livelihoods | Healthy Panchayat | Child-Friendly Panchayat
  - Water-Sufficient Panchayat | Clean and Green Panchayat | Self-Sufficient Infrastructure
  - Socially Just and Socially Secured Panchayat | Good Governance | Women-Friendly Panchayat
- Under DDUPSVP – 34 Gram Panchayats across 17 States & UTs were selected
- Key winners under NDSPSVP include:
  - Sepahijala (Tripura) – 'Best District Panchayat' (₹5 Cr)
  - Harippad (Alappuzha) – 'Best Block Panchayat' (₹2 Cr)
  - New Napam Gaon Panchayat (Assam) – 'Best Gram Panchayat' (₹1.5 Cr)
- Winning Panchayats receive financial incentives ranging from ₹50 lakh to ₹5 Cr (depending on tier & category)
  - Under – 'Incentivization of Panchayats (IoP)' scheme, a central component of CSS 'Rashtriya Gram Swaraj Abhiyan'
- Under NPA-2025, 8 Panchayats have been selected as winners, comprising:
  - 3 – Best District Panchayat category | 2 – Best Block Panchayat category | 3 – Best Gram Panchayat category

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News - 263

- CSIR-CRRI + BPCL = recognized by India Book of Records & Asia Book of Records for establishing the record titled "First Roadblock Section Constructed Using Technical Textile Geocell Made from End-of-Life Plastic"
- Technology uses – technical textile geocells manufactured from processed end-of-life plastic
  - Project supported by – NHAI
- HQs of CSIR-CRRI – New Delhi | Director – Dr. Chalumuri Ravi Sekhar
- HQs of BPCL – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman & MD – Sanjay Khanna | Founded in – 1952

Join us

News - 264

- Droupadi Murmu (President) – conferred "National Florence Nightingale Awards 2026" upon 15 nursing professionals
- National Florence Nightingale Award – instituted by Ministry of Health & Family Welfare
- Each award includes – a Certificate of Merit, a cash prize of Rs 1,00,000 & a medal
- The complete list of winners is here:

Category	Name	State
ANM	Kulwinder Parhi	Ladakh
ANM	Ujwala Mahadev Soyam	Maharashtra
ANM	Lalenthangi Hnamte	Mizoram
ANM	Madhu Mala Gurung	Sikkim
ANM	Pooja Parmar Rana	Uttarakhand
ANM	Gita Karmakar	West Bengal
Nurse	Poonam Verma	Chandigarh
Nurse	Deepa Biju	Dadra & Nagar Haveli and Daman & Diu
Nurse	Dr Sharwan Kumar Dhaka	Delhi
Nurse	Raksha Rupo Parvatkar	Goa
Nurse	Kavitha Jagannath	Karnataka
Nurse	Manju Mol V S	Keralam
Nurse	Aysha Beebi K	Lakshadweep
Nurse	Prof (Dr) R Shankar Shanmugam	Tamil Nadu
Nurse	Major Gen Lissamma P V	IHQ of MoD (Army), Delhi

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News - 265

- Piyush Goyal – felicitated winners of "LEAPS Awards 2025" (4th edition) across 13 categories
  - Organised by – DPIIT, Ministry of Commerce & Industry
- Piyush Goyal – released 7th edition of LEADS 2025 report
- LEADS 2025 framework: 4-tier performance – Exemplars, High Performers, Accelerators, Growth-Seekers
- **Exemplars:** Tamil Nadu (Coastal), Uttar Pradesh (Landlocked), Mizoram (North-East), Delhi (UT)
- **High Performers:**
  - Gujarat, Kerala, Maharashtra (Coastal) | Jammu & Kashmir, Puducherry (UTs)
  - Haryana, Telangana, Chhattisgarh, Bihar (Landlocked) | Tripura, Meghalaya (North-East)
- **Accelerators:**
  - Andhra Pradesh, Odisha, Goa, Karnataka (Coastal)
  - Punjab, Jharkhand, Madhya Pradesh, Uttarakhand, Himachal Pradesh (Landlocked)
  - Nagaland, Arunachal Pradesh, Manipur, Assam (North-East)
  - Dadra & Nagar Haveli & Daman & Diu, Chandigarh, Ladakh, Lakshadweep (UTs)
- **Growth Seekers:** West Bengal (Coastal), Rajasthan (Landlocked), Sikkim (North-East), Andaman & Nicobar Islands (UTs)
- **Winners of LEAPS 2025:**

Join us



News - 266

- Narendra Modi – awarded Sweden's highest honour, "Royal Order of the Polar Star, Degree Commander Grand Cross"
  - This is Prime Minister Modi's 31st international honour
- The award is the highest distinction that can be given to a Head of Government
- Sweden – Stockholm – Krona | PM – Ulf Kristersson

News - 267

- Ishaan Khatter (Actor) – conferred honorary membership of 45 Cavalry of Indian Armoured Corps
  - In recognition of his authentic portrayal of Captain Balram Singh Mehta in war film 'Pippa'
- 45 Cavalry – a distinguished armoured regiment of Indian Army
- 'Pippa': Produced by – Ronnie Screwvala's RSVP Movies & Siddharth Roy Kapur's Roy Kapur Films
  - Directed by – Raja Krishna Menon

News - 268

- "2026 L'Oréal-UNESCO For Women in Science International Awards" – announced by UNESCO & Fondation L'Oréal
- Professor Liesl Zühlke (University of Cape Town) – received Africa & Arab States award
  - For cardiovascular research on childhood rheumatic heart disease
- Professor Felice Jacka (Deakin University) – won Asia & Pacific award
  - For establishing nutritional psychiatry & demonstrating how diet impacts mental health
- Professor Sarah A. Teichmann – European laureate
  - For her work in single-cell biology & genomics
- Professor Raquel Lia Chan – Latin America & Caribbean award
  - For developing drought-resistant crops through agricultural biotechnology
- Professor Gordana Vunjak-Novakovic (University Professor at Columbia University) – North America award
  - For pioneering work in tissue engineering & regenerative medicine (including 'organs-on-a-chip' technology)
- Each laureate receives – €100,000 | Awards will be presented at – UNESCO headquarters in Paris on Jun 11, 2026

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News - 269

- PM Modi – conferred with "Agricola Medal for 2026" by FAO, at FAO Headquarters in Rome
  - He received award from Dr. Qu Dongyu (Director General of FAO)
  - He is 2nd leader from India to receive this award | 1st – Dr Manmohan Singh (in 2008)
- PM Modi's visit to FAO Headquarters was 1st by an Indian Head of Government in last 30 years
- Agricola medal – established by FAO in 1977
- HQs of FAO – Rome, Italy | DG – Dr. Qu Dongyu | Founded in – 1945

News - 270

- "Global Water Summit 2026" – held in Madrid, Spain
- Bangalore Water Supply & Sewerage Board (BWSSB) – emerged as one of top 5 global utilities at the summit
- BWSSB – became only Indian water utility to secure a place among global top 5 in 3 major award categories
  - 'utility of the year' category | 'water project of the year' category

News - 271

- 'Taiwan Travelogue' – won International Booker Prize 2026 | Authored by – Yáng Shuāng-z | Translated by – Lin King
  - It is Yáng's 1st to be translated into English & 1st translation from Mandarin Chinese to win International Booker Prize
- This is also 2nd year in a row that independent press & Other Stories, has taken home prize
  - Following 'Heart Lamp' in 2025
- Yang & Lin King – also 1st Taiwanese & Taiwanese-American winners of prize
- Prize for 2026 was announced by – Natasha Brown (Chair of 2026 judges) at a ceremony at London's Tate Modern
- 'International Booker Prize' – an annual award for translated fiction for short story collections published in UK or Ireland
- Awarded by – Booker Prize Foundation, UK | Award prize – £50,000 (equally shared between author & translator)
  - Each shortlisted author & translator receives £2,500

News - 272

- India's Chandrayaan-3 lunar mission – honoured with '2026 Goddard Astronautics Award', presented in Washington DC
  - By American Institute of Aeronautics & Astronautics (AIAA)
- Vinay Kwatra (India's Ambassador to US) – accepted award on behalf of ISRO
- Chandrayaan-3 – launched on Jul 14, 2023 & entered lunar orbit on Aug 5, 2023
  - Chandrayaan-3 – consists of an orbiter, a lander (Vikram) & a rover (Pragyan)

News - 273

- Prof. Salim Abdool Karim & Prof. Keertan Dheda (South Africa) – awarded "Order of Mapungubwe"
  - By – Cyril Ramaphosa (South Africa's President) | It is South Africa's highest civilian honour
- Karim was awarded in Gold for his contributions to medical science & public health

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- Dheda was awarded in Silver for his scientific research in pulmonology
- President Cyril Ramaphosa presented 'Order of Mapungubwe' to 38 distinguished recipients
- South Africa – Cape Town – South African Rand | President – Cyril Ramaphosa

News - 274

- Major Abhilasha Barak (Indian Army) – awarded with "2025 UN Military Gender Advocate of the Year"
  - for UNIFIL Female Engagement Team leadership & gender sensitisation initiatives
- She is the 3rd Indian peacekeeper to receive award after Major Suman Gawani (2019) & Major Radhika Sen (2023)
  - She is also the 1st woman combat helicopter pilot of Indian Army
- Award ceremony – to be held at UN HQs on May 29, 2026 during International Day of UN Peacekeepers
- In UNIFIL force (7,538 peacekeepers), India contributed 642 personnel, which is 4th-highest after:
  - Italy (784), Indonesia (756) & Spain (660)

News - 275

- Droupadi Murmu (President of India) – presented Padma Vibhushan, Padma Bhushan & Padma Shri Awards
- At Rashtrapati Bhavan in New Delhi, on May 25, 2026, honouring 66 distinguished personalities from diverse fields
- Total Padma Awards for 2026 – 131 | Comprising – 5 Padma Vibhushan, 13 Padma Bhushan & 113 Padma Shri
  - Among recipients: Women – 19 | Posthumously awarded – 16
- Padma Awards – instituted in 1954, announced annually on Republic Day
- 'Padma Vibhushan' (2nd highest civilian award after Bharat Ratna) – awarded for exceptional & distinguished service
- 'Padma Bhushan' (3rd highest civilian award) – awarded for distinguished service of high order
- 'Padma Shri' (4th highest civilian award) – awarded for distinguished service in any field
- Recipients receive – a Sanad (certificate) signed by President & a medallion, along with small replica for ceremonial use
  - No cash prizes are involved
- Padma Awards – instituted in 1954 & originally named as 'Pahela Varg', 'Dusra Varg' & 'Tisra Varg' (renamed in 1955)
  - Suspended from 1978 to 1979 & again from 1993 to 1997
- **Padma Vibhushan (5):**

Name	Field	State / Country
Shri Dharmendra Singh Deol (Posthumous)	Art	Maharashtra
Shri K T Thomas	Public Affairs	Kerala
Ms. N Rajam	Art	Uttar Pradesh
Shri P Narayanan	Literature and Education	Kerala
Shri V S Achuthanandhan (Posthumous)	Public Affairs	Kerala

- **Padma Bhushan (13):**

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Name	Field	State / Country
Ms. Alka Yagnik	Art	Maharashtra
Shri Bhagat Singh Koshyari	Public Affairs	Uttarakhand
Shri Kallipatti Ramasamy Palaniswamy	Medicine	Tamil Nadu
Shri Mammootty	Art	Kerala
Dr. Nori Dattatreyudu	Medicine	United States of America
Shri Piyush Pandey (Posthumous)	Art	Maharashtra
Shri S K M Maeilanandhan	Social Work	Tamil Nadu
Shri Shatavadhani R Ganesh	Art	Karnataka
Shri Shibu Soren (Posthumous)	Public Affairs	Jharkhand
Shri Uday Kotak	Trade and Industry	Maharashtra
Shri V K Malhotra (Posthumous)	Public Affairs	Delhi
Shri Vellappally Natesan	Public Affairs	Kerala
Shri Vijay Amritraj	Sports	United States of America

- **Some important awardees of 'Padma Shri':**
  - Rohit Sharma (cricket), Harmanpreet Kaur (cricket), Savita Punia (hockey), Praveen Kumar (para-athlete), I.M. Vijayan (former Indian football team captain), Anke Gowda (social work), Armida Fernandez (medicine), R. Madhavan (Art)

News - 276

- "Fjord" (directed by Cristian Mungiu) – won "Palme d'Or" top prize at 79th Cannes Film Festival closing ceremony
  - Mungiu became only 10th filmmaker in history to win festival's highest honor twice
- 2026 jury was presided over by – Park Chan-wook (South Korean auteur)
- Other winners of 79th Cannes Film Festival:

Category	Winner(s)	Film / Notes
Palme d'Or	Cristian Mungiu	*Fjord* (Romania)
Grand Prix	Andrey Zvyagintsev	*Minotaur* (Russia)
Best Actress (Shared)	Virginie Efira & Tao Okamoto	*All of a Sudden* (Japan)
Best Actor (Shared)	Valentin Campagne & Emmanuel Macchia	*Coward* (Belgium)
Best Director (Shared)	Paweł Pawlikowski Javier Ambrossi & Javier Calvo ("Los Javis")	*Fatherland* (Poland) *The Black Ball* (Spain)
Jury Prize	Valeska Grisebach	*The Dreamed Adventure* (Germany)
Camera d'Or	Marie-Clementine Dusabejambo	*Ben'Imana* (Rwanda)
Honorary Palme d'Or	Barbra Streisand	Awarded in absentia for her legendary career

Join us

Schemes & Initiatives

News - 277

- Sanjay Seth – introduced "Namo Stall Distribution Scheme" for street vendors in Ranchi under 'PM SVANidhi Scheme'
- Modern mobile stalls (pushcarts) costing approx ₹50,000 each are provided to 5% of the vendors at no cost
- The scheme specifically prioritises women and differently-abled (divyang) street vendors to promote self-reliance
- Jharkhand: Capital – Ranchi | CM – Hemant Soren | Governor – Santosh Kumar Gangwar

News - 278

- As per impact evaluation study of SVAMITVA scheme by IIM Ahmedabad, supported by World Bank:
- SVAMITVA scheme is unlocking an estimated Rs 135 lakh Cr worth of rural land assets while significantly expanding access to institutional credit, with 10,900+ loans sanctioned using property cards | Worth – Rs 1,679 Cr
  - SVAMITVA – Survey of Villages & Mapping with Improvised Technology in Village Areas
- In MP, loan amounts linked to SVAMITVA-surveyed residential properties increased by Rs 22,000+ annually per parcel
  - Overall credit uptake – rose by around 6.5% across states (including Maharashtra, Gujarat & MP)
- Distribution of property cards led to a 4.71% increase in gram panchayat property tax revenue & a 4.08% rise in overall own-source revenue
- Registered mutations of residential properties – increased by 6.2% annually
  - Agricultural land mutations – declined by 4.87%
- A research paper, 'Credit Impacts of Titling Rural Habitation Land: Evidence from India's SVAMITVA Scheme', also underlined scheme's role in enhancing rural credit access
- SVAMITVA scheme – launched in 2020

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News - 279

- Mini. of Mines – completed eligibility assessment under 'Incentive Scheme for Promotion of Critical Mineral Recycling'
  - with 58 companies approved as eligible for participation
- Total outlay – ₹1,500 Cr under the 'National Critical Mineral Mission'
- Aim: To develop domestic recycling capacity for critical minerals from lithium-ion batteries, e-waste, & industrial scrap
- Minister of Coal & Mines: G. Kishan Reddy | Constituency – Secunderabad, Telangana
  MoS in Ministry of Coal & Mines: Satish Chandra Dubey

News - 280

- Union Cabinet approved "Emergency Credit Line Guarantee Scheme (ECLGS) 5.0" (outlay - Rs 18,100 Cr)
  - Aim: To provide targeted credit support to MSMEs, non-MSMEs, and the airline sector
- Credit Flow – expected to unlock Rs 2,55,000 Cr in credit (including Rs 5,000 Cr for airlines)
- Credit Guarantee – 100% coverage for MSMEs | 90% for non-MSMEs & airlines

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- Support Details – Up to 20% of peak working capital utilised in Q4 FY26
  - Capped at – Rs 100 Cr for MSMEs/non-MSMEs) | Airlines can access up to Rs 1,500 Cr
- Loan Tenure – 5 years for MSMEs/non-MSMEs (1-year moratorium) | 7 years for airlines (2-year moratorium)
- Loan Availability – From NCGTC notification date until March 31, 2027
- ECLGS launched in May 2020 during the Covid-19 pandemic

News - 281

- Nagaland Health Protection Society – launched "100 Days Ayushman Student Coverage Mission"
  - In collaboration with district administration
- It is a statewide initiative running from May to Aug 2026 to enrol all eligible students under 2 health insurance schemes
  - 'Ayushman Bharat Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana (AB PM-JAY)'
  - 'Chief Minister Health Insurance Scheme (CMHIS)'
- AB PM-JAY – provides a health cover of ₹5 lakh per family per year for secondary & tertiary care hospitalisation
- CMHIS – a flagship public health insurance initiative by Government of Nagaland
  - Providing cashless treatment to eligible beneficiaries not covered under AB PM-JAY
  - Offering ₹20 lakh per year per family for government employees & pensioners under CMHIS (EP)
  - ₹5 lakh per year per family for indigenous inhabitants & permanent residents under CMHIS (GEN)
- Nagaland: Capital – Kohima | CM – Neiphiu Rio | Governor – Ajay Kumar Bhalla (addi. charge)

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News - 282

- PMSBY + PMJJBY + APY = completed 11 years on May 9, 2026
- All 3 Jan Suraksha Schemes – launched on May 9, 2015 by PM Narendra Modi
- Key highlights of PMJJBY:
  - Life insurance cover – Rs 2 lakh (annual premium - Rs 436)
  - Age criteria – 18-50 years
  - 27.43+ Cr enrolments & settled 10.75 lakh claims worth Rs 21,512.50 Cr till April 29, 2026
- Key highlights of PMSBY:
  - Accidental death/disability cover – Rs 2 lakh (annual premium - Rs 20)
  - Age criteria – 18-70 years
  - Administered by – Public Sector General Insurance Companies (PSGICs)
  - 58.09+ Cr enrolments & settled 1.84 lakh claims worth Rs 3,667.52 Cr till April 29, 2026
- Key highlights of APY:
  - Administered by – PFRDA under National Pension System framework
  - Age criteria – 18-40 years
  - Guaranteed monthly pension – Rs 1,000-Rs 5,000 (after age 60)
  - 9.04+ Cr subscribers till April 30, 2026

Join us

News - 283

- Ministry of Labour & Employment – launched nationwide "Annual Health Check-Up Initiative" for workers aged 40+ under 4 New Labour Codes
- The initiative offers free annual health check-ups at ESIC hospitals across India
- India's social security coverage – increased from 19% to 64% over past decade
- Social security beneficiaries – increased from ~30 Cr to ~94 Cr over past decade
- ESIC coverage – increased from ~7 Cr beneficiaries to nearly 15 Cr beneficiaries over past decade
- Key labour reforms under 4 Labour Codes:
  - Maternity leave – increased from 12 weeks to 26 weeks
  - Workers in hazardous occupations – brought under ESIC coverage
  - Employees in establishments with less than 10 workers – brought under ESIC coverage
- Minister of Labour & Employment: Mansukh L. Mandaviya | Constituency – Porbandar, Gujarat
  MoS in Ministry of Labour & Employment: Shobha Karandlaje

News - 284

- Cabinet approved "Mission for Cotton Productivity" for 2026-27 to 2030-31 | Outlay – ₹5,659.22 Cr
  - to position the country as a competitive player in global textile markets by 2030-31
- India is the world's 2nd-largest cotton producer with 297 lakh bales (170 kg lint each) in 2024-25
  - Target: enhancing cotton production to 498 lakh bales by 2031
- The mission is aligned with the Government's '5F' vision – Farm to Fibre to Factory to Fashion to Foreign
- The Mission will be jointly implemented by = Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare + Ministry of Textiles
  - involving 10 ICAR institutes, 1 CSIR institute & 10 AICRP centres on cotton
- It will initially focus on 140 districts in 14 states & 2,000 ginning/processing factories

News - 285

- CJI Surya Kant – launched "One Case One Data", a major digital initiative
  - To integrate judicial administration at every level of courts into a unified system
- CJI also launched 'Su Sahay', an AI-powered assistance chatbot integrated with Supreme Court website
  - To facilitate easier access to justice & court-related services for litigants
- Chatbot has been developed by – National Informatics Centre (NIC) in collaboration with Supreme Court Registry

News - 286

- Bhagwant Singh Mann (Punjab CM) – launched "CM Meri Rasoi Yojna" from Bhalwan village in Sangrur
- Nutritional food kits will be distributed among nearly 40 lakh poor & economically weaker families across Punjab
  - Each kit would include – 2kg moong-chana dal, 2kg sugar, 1kg iodised salt, 200 grams turmeric & 1 litre mustard oil
- Beneficiary families would receive kitchen kit every 3 months

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- It targets families under National Food Security Act (NFSA) or those holding blue ration cards
- Kits will be assembled by – MARKFED (Punjab State Cooperative Supply & Marketing Federation Ltd.)
  - To be distributed by – Department of Food & Civil Supplies
- Punjab: Capital – Chandigarh | CM – Bhagwant Mann | Governor – Gulab Chand Kataria

News - 287

- Shivraj S. Chouhan – launched 4th phase of "Pradhan Mantri Gram Sadak Yojana (PMGSY-IV)" in Bhairunda, Sehore, MP
- Under PMGSY-IV, MP received approval for 973 rural roads covering length of 2,117.52 km | Cost – Rs 1,763.08 Cr
- He also handed over Pradhan Mantri Janjati Adivasi Nyaya Maha Abhiyaan (PM-JANMAN) road project approvals
  - Worth – Rs 261.81 Cr | Length – 384.34 km
- Centre's total indicative PMGSY allocation for FY27 – Rs 18,907 Cr | MP's share from this amount – Rs 830 Cr
- He also handed over a mother sanction under Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana-Gramin (PMAY-G) to MP
  - Worth – Rs 2,055 Cr
- Awards recognising states for outstanding performance under PMGSY over last 25 years:
  - Among large states for completing highest road length under PMGSY: 1st – MP (90,766 km)
  - State connecting highest number of habitations – Bihar
  - State with green technology usage in rural road construction: 1st – Gujarat | 2nd – Tamil Nadu | 3rd – Haryana
  - Outstanding performance in rural road maintenance: 1st – UP | 2nd – Bihar | 3rd – West Bengal
  - Among northeastern & hill states, highest road length & highest number of habitations connected by – Assam
- Phase I – launched in 2000 | Phase II – launched in 2013 | PMGSY-III – being extended to complete existing targets
- PMGSY-IV – launched in September 2024 | For FY26, govt allocated Rs 19,000 Cr in Union Budget 2026-27

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News - 288

- MoE is making a fresh & urgent push for implementation of "Pradhan Mantri Schools for Rising India (PM SHRI)" scheme in West Bengal, Tamil Nadu & Kerala
- Currently, 34 states & UTs have moved forward with scheme
- PM SHRI scheme – a centrally sponsored initiative launched on Sep 7, 2022
  - Funding pattern between Centre & State Govts & UTs: 60:40 – for all states & UTs with legislature (except J&K)
  - 90:10 – for North Eastern & Himalayan states & UT of J&K | 100% – central funding for UTs without legislature
- Minister of Education: Dharmendra Pradhan | Constituency – Sambalpur, Odisha
  MoS in Ministry of Education: Jayant Chaudhary & Sukanta Majumdar

News - 289

- Cabinet approved "Scheme for Promotion of Surface Coal/Lignite Gasification Projects" (total outlay - ₹37,500 Cr)
- It targets gasification of ~75 million tonnes of coal & lignite through new surface gasification projects
- It expected investment mobilisation ₹2.5-3 lakh Cr across ~25 major projects

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- Financial incentives: max 20% of plant/machinery cost (selection via transparent competitive bidding)
  - Incentives is disbursed in 4 equal instalments linked to project milestones; per-project capped at ₹5,000 Cr, per-product at ₹9,000 Cr, per-entity group at ₹12,000 Cr
- Gasification: a process that converts coal or lignite into synthesis gas (syngas)
- India's import bill for key substitutable products (LNG, urea, ammonia, etc) in FY 2025-26 – ~ ₹2.77 lakh Cr
- Coal utilisation – expected to generate ₹6,300 Cr annually from 75 million tonnes of gasification
- Govt extended coal linkage tenure up to 30 years under Production of Syngas
- India – possesses ~401 billion tonnes coal reserves & 47 billion tonnes lignite reserves
  - Coal accounts for >55% of energy mix

News - 290

- DPIIT – released detailed operational guidelines for implementation of "Bharat Audyogik Vikas Yojna (BHAVYA) Scheme"
  - Aim: To develop investment-ready, world-class industrial parks across India
- It provides for development of 100 industrial parks over 6 years (2026-27 to 2031-32) | Outlay – Rs 33,660 Cr
- Minimum land requirements prescribed at: 100 acres – for non-hilly states | 25 acres – for hilly states, northeastern states, UTs & smaller states
- Implementation of projects under BHAVYA will be undertaken through Special Purpose Vehicles (SPVs) incorporated under the Companies Act, 2013
- National Industrial Corridor Development Corporation (NICDC) – designated as 'Project Management Agency (PMA)'
  - For implementation & monitoring of scheme
- HQs of DPIIT – New Delhi | Secretary – Amardeep Singh Bhatia | Founded in – 1995 (Functions under Ministry of C&I)

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News - 291

- Chhattisgarh – to launch a new scheme titled "Adarsh Shahar Samriddhi Yojana" | Outlay – Rs 200 Cr
  - To equip emerging towns & urban centres with modern civic infrastructure & facilities
- It is conceptualised on lines of 'Mukhyamantri Nagarotthan Yojana', launched for municipal corporations
- For 1st phase, Urban Administration & Development Department – selected 32 ULBs across state's 5 revenue divisions
  - Bilaspur (9), Bastar (6), Surguja (6), Raipur (6) & Durg (5)
- Chief Engineer of Mechanical Cell of Directorate – appointed as nodal officer for all 5 revenue divisions of state
- Chhattisgarh: Capital – Raipur | CM – Vishnu Deo Sai | Governor – Ramen Deka

News - 292

- CCEA approved "SARTHAK-PDS" scheme for 5 years to improve food security | Outlay – Rs 25,530 Cr
  - SARTHAK-PDS – Scheme for Assistance in Ration Transport and Handling-Income with Automation in Public Distribution System

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- It's an umbrella scheme integrating 'Assistance to State Agencies for intra-State movement of foodgrains & FPS dealers' margin under NFSA & 'Scheme for Modernisation & Reforms through Technology in PDS (SMART PDS)'
- The merged scheme is slated to operate up to March 31, 2031

News - 293

- West Bengal Govt – began enrolment for 'Annapurna Yojana' providing Rs 3,000/month to women
- Eligibility: Women aged 25-60, not permanent Govt employees, not paying income tax, not receiving salaries or pensions
- Existing Lakshmir Bhandar beneficiaries – to be migrated to Annapurna Yojana
  - except dead, shifted, deleted, absentee electors, or ASDD cases
- West Bengal: Capital – Kolkata | CM – Suvendu Adhikari | Governor – R N Ravi

Meetings, Conferences and Summits

News - 294

- BIS – organised 35th Plenary & Working Groups meetings of ISO TC 20/SC 14 'Space Systems and Operations'
- India – hosted ISO International Subcommittee Meetings on 'Space Systems and Operations' for the 1st time
- Event witnessed participation of 131 international delegates from 13 countries
- ISO TC 20/SC 14 – develops international standards for lifecycle of space systems, covering design, production, launch, operations & space-based services
- HQs of BIS – Manek Bhawan, Old Delhi | Director General – Sanjay Garg

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News - 295

- MoCA + IFSCA + FICCI = organised 2nd edition of "India Aircraft Leasing & Financing Summit 2.0" at GIFT City, Gandhinagar
- Key industry announcements:
  - AI Fleet Services IFSC Ltd (Air India) – plans to expand portfolio from 50+ aircraft to 76 aircraft by March 2027
  - InterGlobe Aviation Financial Services IFSC (IndiGo) – plans to expand portfolio from ~75 aircraft to nearly 150 aircraft by March 2027
  - Akasa Air – established 'Akasa Air Leasing IFSC Private Limited' (AALI) at GIFT City
  - AALI – to support leasing of ~60 aircraft for Akasa Air over next 5 years
  - Star Air – established Ghodawat Aviation IFSC Pvt Ltd at GIFT IFSC to lease Embraer E190 aircraft from May 2026
  - Star Air – aims to lease 6-8 additional regional aircrafts from GIFT IFSC in FY27
  - Vistra – announced SPV structures for aircraft leasing from GIFT IFSC under amended IFSCA (TechFin C Ancillary Services) Regulations, 2025
  - KPMG + MoCA + FICCI = released report "Advancing the aircraft leasing ecosystem in India - From reforms to powering future growth"

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- IFSCA & FICCI – signed MoU to promote GIFT IFSC as global hub for aviation finance

- India's commercial aircraft fleet – expected to reach 1,100 aircraft by 2027 & 2,250+ aircraft by 2035
- India's aircraft leasing ecosystem – projected ~$50 billion opportunity over coming decade

News - 296

- Kimberley Process Intersessional Meeting 2026 – commenced at Jio World Convention Centre, Mumbai (May 11-14)
  - Being chaired by – Suchindra Misra (3rd year in which KP Chair has been held by an Indian government appointee)
- India assumed Chairship of Kimberley Process on Jan 1, 2026 (succeeding - UAE)
  - Chairship theme centred on "3Cs" – Credibility, Compliance & Consumer Confidence
- "Kimberley Process Certification Scheme (KPCS)" – an international initiative established in 2003

News - 297

- National Conference on Enabling Nationwide EV Charging Infrastructure under PM E-DRIVE Scheme – organized by MHI
  - In – Bengaluru | Chaired by – H.D. Kumaraswamy (Minister for Heavy Industries & Steel)
- He approved proposals for installation of 4,874 EV chargers across various states & CPSEs | Worth – ₹503.86 Cr
- A specific allocation of ₹123.26 Cr for 1,243 chargers in Karnataka
- PM E-DRIVE Scheme – allocates ₹2,000 Cr specifically for public EV charging infrastructure | Total outlay – ₹10,900 Cr
- "Unified Bharat eCharge (UBC)" – a national unified EV charging app being developed
- India had 27,737 public EV charging stations installed as of March 2026, of which 22,753 were operational
- Complementary initiatives highlighted at conference include:
  - ₹25,938 Cr 'Production Linked Incentive (PLI) Auto' scheme
  - ₹18,100 Cr 'PLI Advanced Chemistry Cell (ACC)' scheme – for battery cell manufacturing
  - ₹3,435 Cr 'Payment Security Mechanism' | ₹7,280 Cr 'Rare Earth Permanent Magnets (REPM)' scheme
- Minister of Heavy Industries: H. D. Kumaraswamy | Constituency – Mandaya, Karnataka
  MoS in Ministry of Heavy Industries: Bhupathi Raju Srinivasa Varma

News - 298

- India's flagship global textile event, "Bharat Tex 2026" – to be held in New Delhi (in July'26)
  - Organized by – Bharat Tex Trade Federation
- Ministry of Textiles – launched the 'Bharat Tex Mobile App'
- The event is based on the Govt's "5F Vision" - Farm to Fibre to Factory to Fashion to Foreign

News - 299

- 3rd "India-Nordic Summit" – held in Oslo, Norway
- Nordic countries (Norway, Denmark, Finland, Sweden & Iceland) – committed to invest $100 billion in India over next 15 years

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- India offered 100% FDI to Nordic defence firms in defence industrial corridors
- India's bilateral trade with Nordic countries – stood at ~$19 billion in 2024
- Summit outcomes included a 'Green Technology and Innovation Strategic Partnership' & enhanced cooperation in Arctic & polar research
- As per MEA, Norway's 'Government Pension Fund (GPFG)', with assets close to $28 billion, holds investments in Indian capital market & can play a significant role in financing infrastructure & energy transition projects

News - 300

- PM Modi – chaired the 51st PRAGATI meeting and urged states to settle inter-state water disputes through cooperation and faster administrative action
- During the meeting, he reviewed 7 major infrastructure projects in railways, roads, & the power sector across 9 states
  - These projects are valued at nearly Rs 30,000 Cr
- Apart from Ken-Betwa river-linking project, the PM reviewed the progress of 'Swachh Bharat Mission-Urban 2.0'
- KBLP is India's 1st river-interlinking project | It transfers surplus water Ken (MP) → Betwa (UP), both Yamuna tributaries
  - Declared National Project – 2008 | Union Cabinet approval – Dec 2021 | Estimated cost – ₹44,605 Cr
- PRAGATI – an ICT-based platform designed to improve governance
  - 1st PRAGATI Meeting was held on – 25 March, 2015

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Ranks, Reports & Surveys

News - 301

- "Times Higher Education (THE) Asia University Rankings 2026" has been released
  - 929 universities evaluated across 36 countries & territories
- China leads the Asia University Rankings, with five of the top 10 spots
- Top 10 in the "Times Higher Education (THE): Asia University Rankings 2026"

Rank	Institution	Country/Territory	Score
1	Tsinghua University	China	93.6
2	Peking University	China	93.1
3	National University of Singapore (NUS)	Singapore	91.1
=4	Nanyang Technological University (NTU)	Singapore	85.1
=4	The University of Tokyo	Japan	85.1
6	University of Hong Kong (HKU)	Hong Kong	84.3
7	Fudan University	China	82.9
8	Zhejiang University	China	82.6
9	Shanghai Jiao Tong University	China	82.1
10	The Chinese University of Hong Kong (CUHK)	Hong Kong	81.1

- India is the most-represented nation, with 128 institutions ranked | Followed by – Japan (115) & Turkey (109)
- India has 12 institutions in the top 200 this year

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- "India's Top Institutions: THE Asia University Rankings 2026"

Asia Rank	Institution Name	Overall Score
=43	Indian Institute of Science (IISc Bengaluru)	65.1
=128	Saveetha Institute of Medical and Technical Sciences	52.0
=141	Indian Institute of Technology Indore	50.6
=158	Shoolini University of Biotechnology and Management Sciences	49.4
=160	Jamia Millia Islamia	49.3
=169	KIIT University	48.0
=186	Aligarh Muslim University	46.7
=186	National Institute of Technology Rourkela	46.7
=197	Lovely Professional University	46.0
=197	Manipal Academy of Higher Education	46.0
=197	Thapar Institute of Engineering and Technology	46.0

News - 302

- 80th Round Household Consumption: Health Survey – released by NSO
- Health-seeking behaviour in India improved in 2025 to:
  - 12.2% – in rural areas (from 6.8% in 2017-18) | 14.9% – in urban areas (from 9.1% in 2017-18)
- Expansion in coverage under government health insurance and financing schemes in 2025 rose to:
  - 45.5% – in rural areas (from 12.9%) | 31.8% – in urban areas (from 8.9%)
- Institutional deliveries of infants – rose to 95.6% in rural areas & to 97.8% in urban areas
- Median out-of-pocket medical expenditure (OOPE) per case of hospitalisation in 2025 – Rs 11,285
  - OOPE in more than half of entire hospitalisation cases in public health facilities incur – Rs 1,100
  - For non-hospitalisation (outpatient) care, median OOPE in public health facilities – zero
- Utilisation of public healthcare facilities in rural areas – increased to 35% (from 33%)
- Percentage of population covered under these government health finance & insurance schemes in India reached:
  - To 45.5% – in rural areas (from 12.9%) | To 31.8% – in urban areas (from 8.9%)
- Rural population heading to public facilities for outpatient care – 35% in 2025 (from 28% in 2014)
- HQs of NSO – New Delhi | Chairperson – Prof. Rajeeva Laxman Karandikar
- MoS I/C of Ministry of Statistics & Programme Implementation: Rao Inderjit Singh | Constituency – Gurgaon, Haryana

News - 303

- MoSPI – released 27th edition of its publication titled "Women and Men in India 2025: Selected Indicators and Data"
  - at National Deliberative Summit on 'Data for Development' at Bhubaneswar, Odisha
- The publication is an annual statistical compendium institutionalised in 1995
- A metadata for 50 key indicators has also been added to enhance clarity
- Key highlights of the report:
  - Sex ratio at birth improved from 904 (2017-19) to 917 (2021-23) at all-India level

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- Sustained decline in infant mortality rate for both female & male infants (2008-2023)
- Gender parity achieved in all school education levels (Primary to Higher Secondary)
- GER in higher education – Female: 28.5 to 30.2 | Male: 28.3 to 28.9 (2021-23)
- LFPR (ages 15+) – Rural females: 37.5% to 45.9% (2022-2025)
- Women in managerial positions – Increased by 102.54% (2017-2025), outpacing men's 73.80% increase

News - 304

- MHA notified 'Citizenship (Amendment) Rules, 2026' to modernise & digitise OCI framework & citizenship procedures
- Fully digital OCI system introduced – applications must be filed online at ociservices.gov.in, replacing paper-based process
- Rule 33 – registered OCI cardholders issued either physical OCI card or e-OCI registration, with records maintained in a centralised digital registry
- New Rule 3 – minor child holding Indian passport cannot hold passport of any other country
- New consent clause – OCI applicants can share biometric data for Fast Track Immigration Programme
- Existing OCI cardholders – must update new passport details within 3 months | Delayed updates attract $25 fine
- Renunciation of OCI status – must surrender original card to nearest Indian Mission, Post, or Foreigners RRO
- Minister of Home Affairs: Amit Shah | Constituency – Gandhinagar, Gujarat
  MoS in Ministry of Home Affairs: Nityanand Rai & Bandi Sanjay Kumar

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News - 305

- Tamil Nadu – topped the marine fish production chart with 6.85 lakh tonnes
  - 2nd – Gujarat (6.4 lakh tonnes) | 3rd – Kerala (6.2 lakh tonnes)
- India's marine fish production rose by almost 3% year-on-year to 3.57 million tonnes (35.7 lakh tonnes) in 2025
- Most landed marine resource in India – Indian mackerel (0.27 million tonnes)
  - Followed by – Cephalopods (0.25 million tonnes) | Oil sardine (0.25 million tonnes)
- Marine fish landings generated an estimated economic value of Rs 69,254 Cr at landing centres across India
- National marketing efficiency improved to – 70.88% | Kerala – recorded the highest marketing efficiency at 72.83%

News - 306

- A special report – released by Office of United States Trade Representative (USTR)
- India – among 6 countries on "Special 301 Priority Watch List"
- India – remained 'inconsistent in its progress' on protection & enforcement of IP
- 6 countries on priority watch list include – Chile, China, India, Indonesia, Russia & Venezuela
- Vietnam – identified as a 'Priority Foreign Country'
- Argentina – moved out of priority watch list | European Union (EU) – added to watch list

Join us

News - 307

- Ministry of Panchayati Raj – released "Panchayat Advancement Index (PAI) 2.0" for FY2023-24
- It is world's 1st nationwide framework to measure the progress of rural local bodies using verifiable indicators
- PAI 2.0 – Covers 2.5 lakh GPs, assessing 150+ parameters across sectors like health, water, infra., & sustainability
- GPs classified into 5 performance categories – Achiever (A+: ≥90), Front Runner (A: 75-89), Performer (B: 60-74), Aspirant (C: 40-59), Beginner (D: <40)
  - Overall, 3,635 GPs emerged as Front Runners (Grade A)
- Strongest outcomes – Theme 1 (Poverty Free & Enhanced Livelihoods) & Theme 2 (Healthy Panchayat) with A+ grades for 3,313 & 1,015 GPs
- Top Performers – Tripura: 80% of GPs rated as Front Runner | Followed by – Kerala & Odisha
- Top Rank – Jugal Kishore Nagar Village Committee, Tripura (Score: 88.44)
- West Bengal – did not participate in PAI 2.0 exercise
- No panchayat achieved 'Achiever' category
- Thematic Framework:

PAI assesses Gram Panchayat/Equivalent to GP performance across the following nine LSDG themes:

Theme 1	Theme 2	Theme 3	Theme 4	Theme 5	Theme 6	Theme 7	Theme 8	Theme 9
Poverty Free and Enhanced Livelihoods in Panchayat	Healthy Panchayat	Child-Friendly Panchayat	Water Sufficient Panchayat	Clean and Green Panchayat	Panchayat with Self-Sufficient Infrastructure	Socially Just and Socially Secured Panchayat	Panchayat with Good Governance	Women Friendly Panchayat

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News - 308

- "World Migration Report 2026" – released by International Organization for Migration
- Top remittance recipient country in world in 2024 & only nation to surpass 100 billion dollars – India ($137 billion)
  - Followed by – Mexico ($67.6 billion), Philippines ($40.3 billion), France ($38.8 billion) & Pakistan ($34.9 billion)
- Highest growth in remittances in 2024 (among regions) – South Asian region (11.8%)
- Top remittance-sending country in world in 2024 – US (with total outflow surpassing $100 billion)
  - Followed by – Saudi Arabia (over $46 billion), Switzerland ($40 billion) & Germany (nearly $24 billion)
- Asia – to account for largest share of internationally mobile students
  - Single largest origin country worldwide – China | 2nd – India

News - 309

- "Crime in India - 2024" report – released by NCRB
- India recorded 58.85 lakh crimes in 2024 (6% decrease from 62.41 lakh in 2023)
- Crime Rate – decreased from 448.3 (2023) to 418.9 (2024) per lakh population
- Crimes Against Women – declined by 1.5%, with 4.41 lakh cases in 2024 | Crime rate: 64.6 per lakh female population
- Crimes Against SCs – decreased by 3.6% | Crimes Against STs – declined by 23.1%

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- Crimes Against Senior Citizens – increased by 16.9% | Juvenile Crimes – increased by 11.2%
- Economic Offences – increased by 4.6% | Environment-related Offences – declined by 16.4%
- Telangana – recorded a sharp rise in cognisable crimes in 2024 & high crime rates per lakh population
- UP – recorded the highest per capita crime rate (7.4) | Followed by – Arunachal Pradesh & Jharkhand
- Nagaland – continued to record the lowest crime rate in India
- Highest Charge-Sheeting Rate – Kerala (94.5%) | Followed by – Puducherry (91.0%) & West Bengal (90.6%)
- Delhi – recorded over 2.7 lakh cognisable offences in 2024
  - With the lowest charge-sheeting rate among 19 metropolitan cities
- ADSI Report: 1,70,746 suicides recorded in 2024
  - Bengaluru – registered 2,403 suicides in 2024 (rate - 20 per lakh population over the 3 years)
- HQs of NCRB – New Delhi | Director – Alok Ranjan | Established in – 1986

News - 310

- "School Education System in India: Temporal Analysis and Policy Roadmap for Quality Enhancement" – by NITI Aayog
  - Assessment Period: 2014-15 to 2024-25 (using data from UDISE, UDISE+, PARAKH, NAS, & ASER)
- Key findings of the report:
  - School System Size – 14.71 lakh schools serving 24.69 Cr students, making India's system the largest in the world
  - Primary Education – Near-universal access achieved at primary level | Higher Secondary GER – 58.4%
  - Enrollment Distribution – 49.25% students in Govt Schools | 38.8% in Private Unaided Schools
  - 13 recommendations to improve school education quality: 8 systemic + 5 academic
  - 33 pathways across short, medium, & long-term timelines with 125+ measurable performance indicators

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News - 311

- As per "Annual Survey of Unincorporated Sector Enterprises (ASUSE)" for 2023-24 (Oct'23 - Sep'24) & 2025 (Jan - Dec):
- Among major states in India's informal economy (employing more than 2 million workers) across 3 key dimensions:
  - State with fastest growth in unincorporated non-agricultural employment – Haryana (29.8%)
  - Sharpest contraction – Gujarat (12.6%)
  - 3 key dimensions – employment, number of establishments & worker productivity
- State with country's largest informal employer – Uttar Pradesh with 18.6 million workers (16% growth)
  - Followed by – West Bengal with 13.3 million workers (10.4% growth)
  - Other strong performers – Jharkhand (19.4%) & Rajasthan (15.3%)
- In terms of establishments, state with: Sharpest expansion – Haryana (21.8%) | Sharpest decline – Gujarat (5.7%)
- Worker productivity: Highest – Delhi (₹2.49 lakh per worker annually) | 2nd – Uttarakhand (₹2.09 lakh)
  - National average – ₹1.57 lakh
  - Employment-heavy states lagged in productivity – West Bengal (₹1.18 lakh), UP (₹1.26 lakh) & Bihar (₹1.3 lakh)
- Gujarat – only state to register a decline across all three dimensions

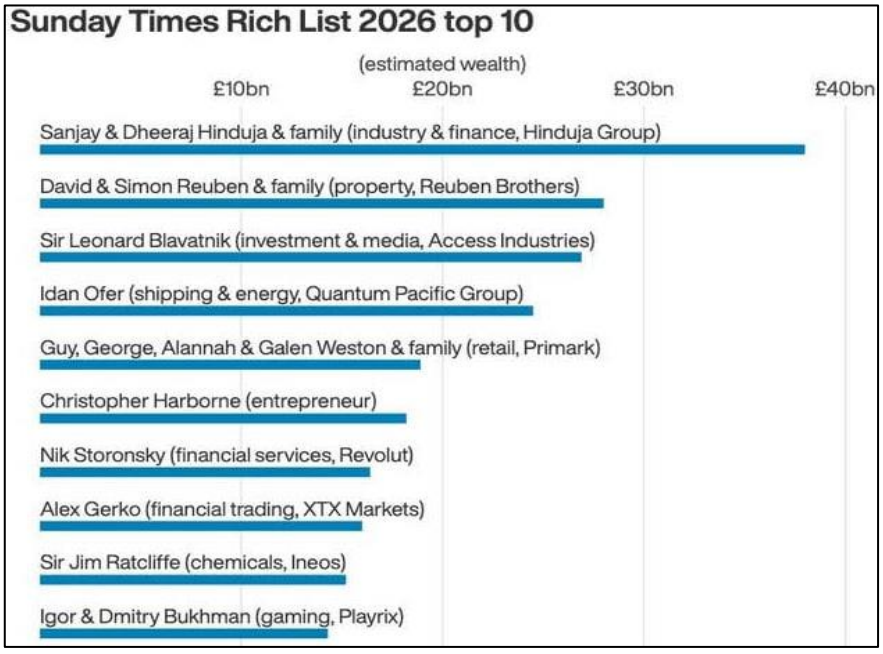
Join us

News - 312

- "Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS) Quarterly Bulletin: January-March 2026" – released by NSO (MoSPI)
  - 4th in series of PLFS Quarterly bulletins covering both rural & urban areas under CWS framework
- Overall Labour Force Participation Rate (LFPR) among persons of age 15 years & above – 55.5% (from 55.8%)
  - Rural areas – 58.2% (from 58.4%) | Urban areas – 50.2% (from 50.4%)
  - For females: Overall – 34.7% (from 34.9%) | Rural – 39.2% (from 39.4%) | Urban – 25.4% (from 25.5%)
- Overall Worker Population Ratio (WPR) for persons of age 15 years & above – 52.8% (from 53.1%)
  - Rural WPR – 55.7% (from 56.1%) | Urban WPR – 46.9% (from 47.1%)
- Overall Unemployment Rate (UR) for persons of age 15 years & above in:
  - Urban areas – 6.6% (from 6.7%) | Rural areas – 4.3% (from 4.0%)
- In rural areas: Regular wage/salaried employees – 15.5% (from 14.8%)
  - Share of self-employed persons aged 15 years & above – 62.5% (from 63.2%)
  - Share of workers engaged in agriculture stood – 55.8% (from 58.5%)
  - Share of employment in tertiary sector – 21.7% (from 20.6%)
  - Share of employment in secondary sector – 22.6% (from 20.9%)
- HQs of NSO – New Delhi | Chairperson – Prof. Rajeeva Laxman Karandikar

News - 313

- As per 2026 edition of "Sunday Times Rich List 2026":
- Top of UK's wealth rankings – Hinduja Group with wealth of £38 billion (for 5th consecutive yr)
  - 2nd – David Reuben & Simon Reuben (£27.97 billion) | 3rd – Sir Leonard Blavatnik (£26.852 billion)
  - 4th – Idan Ofer (£24.481 billion) | 5th – Guy, George, Alannah & Galen Weston & family (£18.939 billion)
- Among Indian-origin billionaires: 28th – Prakash Lohia (£6.44 billion) | 43rd – Anil Agarwal (£3.85 billion)



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News - 314

- A new UN assessment, "Global Forest Goals Report 2026," warned that demand for fuelwood is accelerating forest loss across parts of Africa & Asia
- Report was prepared by – UN Department of Economic and Social Affairs & UN Forum on Forests Secretariat
- Forests worldwide shrank to 4.14 billion hectares in 2025 (from 4.18 billion hectares in 2015)
- Highest annual decline – South America (4.1 million hectares) | 2nd – Africa (3 million hectares)
- Biggest cause of deforestation globally – Agricultural expansion
- Primary forests lost during decade (globally) – 16 million hectares | Largest share of losses – South America
- 91 countries pledged to restore ~190 mn hectares of forests, although only 44 mn hectares had been restored by 2025
  - Highest progress – Asia (restored more than 31 million hectares or 42.2% of pledged area)
- Globally, forests cover 4.14 billion hectares

	WOOD REMOVALS (MILLION M³)					
	INDUSTRIAL ROUNDWOOD		WOODFUEL		TOTAL	
REGION	2015	2024	2015	2024	2015	2024
Africa	75	79	679	742	754	821
Asia	401	481	735	683	1 136	1 163
Europe	580	591	168	173	748	764
North and Central America	517	451	136	154	652	605
Oceania	64	64	10	10	74	74
South America	218	290	172	188	389	478
WORLD	**1 853**	**1 956**	**1 900**	**1 949**	**3 754**	**3 905**

Source: FAO (2026). FAOSTAT: Forestry production and trade

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News - 315

- As per latest monthly foreign trade statistics released by Bangladesh Bureau of Statistics (BBS)
- India – emerged as Bangladesh's 2nd-largest trading partner
  - India – accounted for 8.47% of Bangladesh's total external trade, valued at Tk1,232.8 Cr
  - Followed by – United States with 8.46% market share (Tk1,231.7 Cr)
- Bangladesh's largest trading partner – China (21.21% of total external trade, equivalent to Tk3,087.9 Cr)
- EU & US – primary drivers of Bangladesh's foreign exchange earnings

Country	Trade Share (%)	Value (in BDT)	Primary Trade Drivers
China	21.21%	Tk3,087.9 crore	Capital machinery, electronic parts, textile raw materials, chemicals
India	8.47%	Tk1,232.8 crore	Essential food items (onions, rice, sugar), raw cotton, yarn, intermediate goods
United States	8.46%	Tk1,231.7 crore	Readymade garments (RMG exports), agricultural produce, grains, LPG

Join us

News - 316

- "State and Trends of Carbon Pricing 2026" report – released by World Bank
- India – one of world's largest new carbon markets with launch of its 'Carbon Credit Trading Scheme' in 2026
- Global carbon pricing systems now cover 29% of GHG emissions & annual revenues from emissions trading systems
  - Carbon taxes – crossed $107 billion in 2025
- India's emissions trading system currently covers 7 sectors & ~490 industries | Estimated coverage – ~477 million tCO2e
- Globally, average carbon prices – rose to nearly $21/tCO2e in 2026 (from $10/tCO2e in 2016)
  - Carbon credit issuances – rose 8% between 2024 & 2025
- Only China's national China's ETS, European Union ETS & Republic of Korea ETS currently cover larger absolute volumes of GHG emissions than India's newly implemented system
- ETS (emissions trading system) coverage of global emissions – rose to around 26% (from 8% in 2016)
- Number of carbon pricing instruments covering industry – increased 44% | Waste sector coverage – expanded by 129%
- 1st credits under 'Paris Agreement Crediting Mechanism' – provisionally issued to a clean cookstoves project in Myanmar
- HQs of World Bank – Washington D.C., US | President – Ajay Banga | MD/CFO – Anshula Kant | Members – 189

News - 317

- "Third Advance Estimates of production of major agricultural crops for 2025-26" – released by DA&FW (MoA&FW)
- India's total foodgrain production – 376.563 million tonnes (highest-ever foodgrain production)
- Production for: Rice – 154.024 million tonnes | Wheat – 120.657 million tonnes | Maize – 55.093 million tonnes
  - Shree Anna – 17.584 million tonnes | Tur – 3.592 million tonnes | Gram – 12.514 million tonnes
  - Lentil – 1.762 million tonnes | Total oilseed – 43.059 million tonnes | Groundnut – 13.074 million tonnes
  - Soybean – 12.596 million tonnes | Rapeseed & mustard – 13.768 million tonnes
  - Sugarcane – 500.063 million tonnes | Cotton – 29.024 million bales | Jute – 9.176 million bales
- In 2025-26, ICAR released 339 crop varieties suitable for different agro-climatic regions of India

News - 318

- MoHFW – released "National Health Accounts (NHA) estimates for India 2022-23"
  - 10th report by NHATS under System of Health Accounts (2011) framework
- Government Health Expenditure (GHE) – rose from 1.15% of GDP in 2013-14 to 1.43% in 2022-23
  - New GDP series 2022-23 – 1.48%
- GHE share in General Government Expenditure – increased from 3.78% to 4.89%
- Per capita GHE – increased ~2.7x from Rs 1,042 to Rs 2,786 between 2013-14 & 2022-23
- GHE share in Total Health Expenditure (THE) – rose from 28.6% to 43.7%
- Out-of-Pocket Expenditure (OOPE) – declined from 64.2% to 43.4%
- Social Security Expenditure (SSE) – increased from 6% to 9.9%
- Private Health Insurance share in THE – increased from 3.4% to 9.2%

Join us

- Minister of Health & Family Welfare: Jagat Prakash Nadda | Constituency – Gujarat

  MoS in Ministry of Health & Family Welfare: Jadhav Prataprao Ganpatrao & Anupriya Singh Patel

News - 319

- Taiwan – overtook India to become 5th largest stock market by m-cap at $4.95 trillion (over India's $4.92 trillion)
  - Key factor in Taiwan's surpassing India – TSMC (world's largest chip foundry, which surged 45%)
- Markets ahead of Taiwan – US, China, Japan & Hong Kong | South Korea – 7th largest at $4.54 trillion
- Taiwan – Taipei – New Taiwan dollar | President – Lai Ching-te

Amount & Agreements

News - 320

- ADB – announced $70 billion in energy and digital infrastructure initiatives by 2035
- Pan-Asia Power Grid Initiative (PAGI) – $50 billion investment to mobilise cross-border power infrastructure, integrate 20 GW of renewable energy, connect 22,000 circuit-km transmission lines, improve energy access for 200 million people, and cut regional power emissions by 15%
- Asia-Pacific Digital Highway – $20 billion to finance digital corridors, data infrastructure, & AI-ready economies
- Centre for AI Innovation and Development – Established in Seoul with a $20 million contribution from South Korea to train 3 million people in digital and AI skills by 2035
- ADB – to provide $10 million in technical assistance for PAGI's regulatory alignment & feasibility studies
- HQs of ADB – Mandaluyong, Philippines | President – Masato Kanda | Members – 69

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News - 321

- Bihar – approved $500 million loan from World Bank for urbanization & infrastructure development in cities
- Quality AI training will be imparted to State legislative members, officials, & staff to establish Bihar as a leader in AI
- 'Bihar Artificial Intelligence Mission' – constituted to lead AI development in the state
- Bihar Industrial Investment Promotion Package (BIIPP) – extended up to June 30, 2026
- 7th State Finance Commission – extended until Sep 30, 2026
- Cabinet approved the proposal to purchase 400 electric AC buses under 'PM E-Bus Sewa Yojana'
  - ₹517.16 crore cash gap subsidy sanctioned for running 400 e-buses over 12 years
- Cabinet approved 'Bihar Building (Amendment) Bylaws, 2026' to reduce commercial land loss & easing urban pressure
- Bihar: Capital – Patna | CM – Samrat Choudhary | Governor – Lt. Gen. (Retired) Syed Ata Hasnain

Join us

News - 322

- GoI launched a $1.5 billion "Bharat Maritime Insurance Pool (BMIP)" with a sovereign guarantee of $1.4 billion
  - To facilitate continuous maritime insurance coverage amid war in West Asia
- BMIP will extend insurance protection to vessels carrying cargo between international ports & India in both directions
- Under BMIP, NIACL issued 1st policy providing financial protection against war perils while navigating through high-risk war zones
- Policy has been handed over by M Nagaraju (DFS Secretary) to Hoger Offshore & Marine Pvt Ltd
- Another marine cargo war policy was presented to – Vedanta Sterlite Copper Ltd
- Policy was also issued to – Balrampur Chini Mills Ltd
- Underwriting Committee (UC) – formed
  - Responsible for ensuring prudent, consistent & technically sound underwriting of risks ceded to pool
- GIC Re – pool administrator
- For claims arising up to $100 million – pool will service claim using its own capacity
- For claims $100+ million – sovereign guarantee will be invoked to service claims as a contingent backstop of last resort
- India's maritime sector handles over 70% of country's trade by volume & nearly 95% by value

News - 323

- GoI + IFAD = launched a new 8-year "Country Strategic Opportunities Programme (COSOP)" for period 2026-2033
  - At 'IFAD-India Partnership for Rural Prosperity' event – held at Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi
- Aim: To enhance rural incomes, strengthen resilience & scale sustainable livelihood opportunities across country
- IFAD + NABARD = a strategic partnership agreement to strengthen rural finance systems & support innovation in agricultural & allied sectors
- HQs of IFAD – Rome, Italy | President – Alvaro Lario | Established in – 1977

News - 324

- AIIB launched a $10 billion fund, 'Energy, Food Security & Economic Resilience Facility'
  - To support member countries affected by economic fallout of ongoing Middle East conflict
- India – 2nd-largest shareholder in AIIB (after China)
- It will also provide a time-bound financing envelope of up to $10 billion over 2 years
- Largest shareholder in AIIB – China (26.54% voting rights)
  - Followed by – India (7.58%), Russia (5.9%) & Germany (4.1%)
- HQs of AIIB – Beijing, China | President – Zou Jiayi | Established in – 2016 | Members – 110

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Ordinance, Bills & Acts

News - 325

- Cabinet approved proposal to introduce the "Supreme Court (Number of Judges) Amendment Bill, 2026" in Parliament
  - to amend 'Supreme Court (Number of Judges) Act, 1956', for increasing the No. of Judges of Supreme Court
- SC judges strength will be increased by 4 from 33 to – 37 (excluding CJI) | Total sanctioned strength – 38
- As per 'Article 124(1) of the Constitution: SC shall consist of a CJI & such No. of other judges as Parliament may prescribe
- Present CJI of Supreme Court – Justice Surya Kant (53rd) | Established on – Jan 26, 1950
  - Retirement age: Chief Justices & Judges of HC – 62 years | CJI & judges of the SC – 65 years
  - Sanctioned strength of judges in the SC – 38 (including CJI)

News - 326

- Centre notified implementation of "Viksit Bharat - Guarantee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission (Gramin) Act, 2025"
  - To be rolled out from Jul 1, 2026, replacing "Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act, 2005"
- Wage employment to unskilled manual work to every eligible rural household – 125 days per financial year
  - From – MGNREGA's 100-day provision
- Budgetary allocation – ₹95,692.31 Cr for FY27 | Combined Central & state outlay – exceed ₹1.51 lakh Cr
- Funding architecture – state-wise normative allocations setting fixed ceilings for expenditure
  - Any spending beyond these limits – to be borne by states
- Wages will be paid through DBT into workers' accounts on a weekly basis or within 15 days
  - Government aims to process payments within – 3 days
- All projects must originate from 'Viksit Gram Panchayat Plans' & link to 'Viksit Bharat National Rural Infrastructure Stack'
- Social audits – to occur twice a year supported by GPS-based monitoring
- Digital attendance systems & administrative expenditure ceilings – to rise to 9% (from 6%)
- Existing e-KYC verified MGNREGA job cards will remain valid until new 'Gramin Rozgar Guarantee Cards' are issued

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News - 327

- "Viksit Bharat-Guarantee for Rozgar & Ajeevika Mission (Gramin) Act 2025" – notified for nationwide rollout from July'26
  - 'VB-G RAM G Act 2025' replaces 'MGNREGA 2005'
- Wage employment guarantee – increased from 100 days to 125 days per financial year for rural households
- Fund-sharing structure:
  - 60:40 (Centre-States) for all states
  - 90:10 (Centre-Northeast/Himalayan states/UTs with legislature)
  - 100% central share for UTs without legislature
- e-KYC verified MGNREGA Job Cards – remain valid under VB-G RAM G until Gramin Rozgar Guarantee Cards issued
- Implementation timeline – states get 6 months from Act commencement to operationalize schemes

Join us

- FY 2026-27 budget allocation – Rs 95,692.31 Cr (highest-ever budget allocation for rural employment programme)
- Total programme outlay (with state contributions) – estimated to exceed Rs 1.51 lakh Cr

News - 328

- Union notified "National Sports Governance (National Sports Board) Rules, 2026" & "National Sports Governance (National Sports Tribunal) Rules, 2026" under provisions of 'National Sports Governance Act, 2025'
- Under 'National Sports Governance (National Sports Board) Rules, 2026':
  - National Sports Board shall consist of a Chairperson & 2 members (to be appointed by central government)
  - National Sports Board – to also function as central authority for granting recognition to national sports Bodies
- 'National Sports Governance (National Sports Tribunal) Rules, 2026':
  - Provides for term of office of Chairperson & members of tribunal, their appointment & re-appointment process, salary & allowances, service conditions & powers of tribunal
- National Sports Tribunal – to also serve as a dedicated adjudicatory body for sports-related disputes in India

MoUs, Collaborations & Partnerships

News - 329

- NIPER (Hajipur) + Boehringer Ingelheim (Germany) = MoU to Advance Pharmaceutical Research Collaboration in Delhi
  - To foster synergy between academia & industry
- NIPER – an autonomous body set up under aegis of Department of Pharmaceuticals, Ministry of Chemicals & Fertilizers
- Director of NIPER, Hajipur – Prof. K. Ruckmani

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News - 330

- Paras Defence & Space Tech + Complus Systems & JV Micronics = an MoU to jointly pursue opportunities in anechoic & semi-anechoic chambers
- It will focus on design, development, manufacturing, & installation of such chambers in India & international markets
- HQs of Paras Defence & Space Technologies – Navi Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman – Sharad Virji Shah
- HQs of Complus Systems – Bangalore, Karnataka | MD – K.V. Ramakrishna

News - 331

- DPIIT + Chamber India = an MoU to strengthen India's startup ecosystem & promote innovation-led growth
- HQs of Chamber India – New Delhi | President & CEO – Abhinav Balyan

News - 332

- Reform-linked MoUs under JJM 2.0 – signed with Uttarakhand, Karnataka, & Tripura
- Reform-linked MoU mandates GP-led, service-based & community-centred model of rural water governance

Join us

- State Progress – Uttarakhand: 98% coverage | Karnataka: 87% | Tripura: 86%
- Union Cabinet Approval – Extended JJM period to Dec 2028 with enhanced outlay of ₹8.69 lakh Cr
- JJM 2.0 Goal – Tap water connections to all 19.36 Cr rural households by Dec 2028 (current coverage: 15.80 Cr, 81.61%)

News - 333

- NLC India Ltd + EDF (France) = signed a Non-Disclosure Agreement (NDA) to explore development of nuclear power plants in India using advanced nuclear technologies
- EPR – a Generation III+ reactor technology known for advanced safety features & operational efficiency
- Union Budget 2025-26 allocated ₹20,000 Cr under 'Nuclear Energy Mission for Viksit Bharat' to develop at least 5 indigenously designed SMRs by 2033
- HQs of NLCIL – Neyveli, Tamil Nadu | CMD – Prasanna Kumar Motupalli

News - 334

- UIDAI + NFSU = a 5-year MoU to enhance cybersecurity, digital forensics & advanced technology research
- HQs of UIDAI – New Delhi | Chairman – Neelkanth Mishra | CEO – Bhuvnesh Kumar
- HQs of NFSU – Gandhinagar, Gujarat | VC – Dr. J. M. Vyas | Established in – 2020

News - 335

- India + Japan – signed two key agreements to strengthen cooperation in health research and quantum technologies
  - during bilateral meeting in New Delhi
- Health Cooperation – MoC exchanged between AMED (Japan), ICMR (India), and DST (India)
- Quantum Cooperation – LoI signed between Japan's Cabinet Office and DST
- Both countries discussed strengthening collaboration under India's "National Quantum Mission (NQM)"
  - NQM: approved with a Rs 6003.65 Cr budget (2023-2031)
- Japan – Tokyo – Yen | PM – Sanae Takaichi

News - 336

- Cape Breton University (Canada) – signed 3 MoUs with Indian institutions during a multi-city outreach programme
  - in New Delhi, Gurugram, Noida, Vadodara, Ahmedabad & Hyderabad
- MoU 1 – 5-year agreement with BML Munjal University's School of Engineering & Tech. for student/faculty exchange
- MoU 2 – National Education Forum (NEF) designated as CBU's official convening partner in India
- MoU 3 – Partnership formalised with Lok Jagruti Kendra (LJ) University in Gujarat

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News - 337

- IndiaAI + ICMR = MoU to accelerate responsible & scalable AI applications in healthcare & biomedical research in India
- Collaboration Framework – IndiaAI's compute infrastructure, dataset platforms, and AI skilling initiatives combined with ICMR's biomedical research expertise and MIDAS framework
- In Sep 2025, IndiaAI & ICMR's NIRDHDS recognised as Pioneer Countries under 'HealthAI Global Regulatory Network'
- HealthAI GRN – a multilateral initiative co-founded with UK & Singapore
- IndiaAI – India's flagship initiative under MeitY | Implemented through – Digital India Corporation (DIC)
- HQs of ICMR – New Delhi, India | Director General – Rajiv Bahl | Established in – 1911

News - 338

- Maritime India Foundation – formalised MoUs with IIT Madras, IIT Bombay, & Indian Maritime University, Chennai
  - Aim: to establish Maritime Innovation Hubs (MIHs)
- MoU with the 4th hub, IIT Kharagpur, will be signed subsequently
- With this, 'Sagarmala Startup Innovation Initiative' program now advances into its execution phase
  - MIHs will now onboard, engage, & mentor 36 startups selected to work on 40 innovation projects
  - Implementing agency for this initiative – Maritime India Foundation

News - 339

- Office of India's PSA + FICCI = an MoU to foster a robust ecosystem for R&D in India
- The partnership will aim to bridge the gap between industry, academia, & research institutions and promote research
- Current PSA to the Govt of India – Prof. Ajay Kumar Sood
- HQs of FICCI – Delhi | DG – Jyoti Vij | President – Anant Goenka | Founded – 1927

News - 340

- CSIR-NIScPR + RIS = an MoU to strengthen collaboration in science, technology, innovation policy & diplomacy
- On this occasion, three documents were released:
  - 'India-Republic of Korea S&T Cooperation: Co-Creating the Future'
  - 'Proceeding of Workshop on Strengthening India's Semiconductor Ecosystem: Policies, Challenges & Opportunities'
  - A policy bulletin titled 'The Key Drivers of Particulate Pollution from Road Transportation in Indian States'
- CSIR-NIScPR – formed through merger of National Institute of Science Communication and Information Resources (NISCAIR) & National Institute of Science Technology and Development Studies (NISTADS) in 2021
  - It functions under – Council of Scientific and Industrial Research (CSIR)
- RIS – an autonomous policy research institute under Ministry of External Affairs
- Location of CSIR-NIScPR – New Delhi | Director – Dr Geetha Vani Rayasam
- HQs of RIS – New Delhi | Chairperson – Sanjay Kumar Verma | DG – Prof. Sachin Chaturvedi

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News - 341

- DYPIU (MH) + Dassault Systèmes = an MoU to establish an advanced Digital Engineering & Digital Manufacturing Experience Centre on its campus
  - Powered by – Dassault Systèmes
- Establishment of Experience Centre – to be one of first of its kind in field of Smart Manufacturing in Maharashtra
- HQs of Dassault Systèmes – Vélizy-Villacoublay, France | Chairman & CEO – Pascal Daloz

News - 342

- India + Trinidad & Tobago = signed eight MoUs across key sectors
- S Jaishankar – handed over first batch of 2,000 laptops to selected school children
  - He also inaugurated an agro-processing facility for which machinery worth $1 million was provided by India last year
- Trinidad and Tobago's National Prosthetics Centre – jointly inaugurated in Penal
- Trinidad & Tobago – Port of Spain – Trinidad & Tobago dollar | President – Christine Kangaloo | PM – Kamla PersadBissessar

News - 343

- Dhash Defense Systems Pvt Ltd + DRIF (IIT Ropar) = an MoU to bring together cutting-edge academic research & homegrown manufacturing to reshape India's ground mobility landscape
- HQs of Dhash Defense Systems – Bengaluru, Karnataka | Founder & Chairman – Manjunath N. Reddy

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News - 344

- AIFF + DSYS (Odisha) = a renewed 5-year MoU to continue & expand their elite youth football partnership
  - Backed by – FIFA's 'Talent Development Scheme'
- 1st MoU – signed in Nov 2023
- HQs of AIFF – New Delhi | President – Kalyan Chaubey | Established in – 1937

News - 345

- I4C (MHA) + RBIH = an MoU to strengthen collaboration in combating cyber-enabled financial frauds & curbing mule accounts across India's banking & digital payments ecosystem
- Aim: To enhance fraud-risk intelligence sharing, analytical support & operational coordination
- HQsf of I4C – New Delhi | CEO – Rajesh Kumar
- HQs of RBIH – Bengaluru, Karnataka | CEO – Sahil Kini | Established in – 2022

Join us

News - 346

- Indian Pharmacopoeia Commission (IPC) – signed MoUs with pharmacy councils of Bihar, Maharashtra & Mizoram
  - To strengthen medicine safety, promote rational use of medicines & enhance pharmacovigilance activities
- They will establish ADR Monitoring Centres in coordination with Pharmacovigilance Programme of India (PvPI)
- HQs of IPC – Ghaziabad, UP | Secretary-cum-Scientific Director – Dr. V. Kalaiselvan | Established in – 2005
- Bihar: Capital – Patna | CM – Samrat Choudhary | Governor – Lt. Gen. (Retired) Syed Ata Hasnain
- Maharashtra: Capital – Mumbai | CM – Devendra Fadnavis | Governor – Jishnu Dev Varma
- Mizoram: Capital – Aizawl | CM – Lalduhoma | Governor – General V. K. Singh

News - 347

- IndiaAI Mission (MeitY) + Karya = signed an MoU
  - Aim: development, curation, & sharing of high-quality language and multimodal datasets
- HQs of Karya – Mumbai, Maharashtra | CEO – Manu Chopra
- CEO of IndiaAI Mission – Abhishek Singh

News - 348

- MoPSW + (HD KSOE + NSHIP-TN + SMFCL) = an MoU to develop India's 1st mega greenfield shipyard at Thoothukudi, TN
- Envisaged annual capacity – 2.5 million gross tonnage (GT)
- The project has been launched under the India-Republic of Korea maritime cooperation framework, 'VOYAGES'
  - VOYAGES – Shared **V**ision for **O**peration of **Y**ard **A**ssisted **G**rowth with **E**fficiency and **S**cale
- NSHIP-TN is a SPV jointly promoted by = V.O. Chidambaranar Port Authority (VoCPA) + SIPCOT
  - It will anchor the broader Thoothukudi Shipbuilding Cluster
- The initiative aims to place India among the Top 5 shipbuilding nations globally
  - Targeted output by 2047 – 4.5 million GT per annum

News - 349

- DBN + AP Govt + APBIL + BSNL + APSFL = a pact for 'Amended BharatNet Programme' (Fin Outlay - Rs 2,432 Cr)
  - Aim: To accelerate rural broadband connectivity in Andhra Pradesh
- Union Cabinet approved Amended BharatNet Programme on Aug 4, 2023 – optical fiber connectivity to 2.64 lakh Gram Panchayats & on-demand OF to non-GP villages
- 'National Optical Fibre Network (NOFN)' launched in 2011 – renamed as 'BharatNet' in 2015;
  - under – Ministry of Communications
- HQs of Digital Bharat Nidhi – New Delhi | Administrator – Niraj Verma | Established in – 2024
- HQs of BSNL – New Delhi | CMD – Robert Jerard Ravi (additional charge)

Join us

News - 350

- Ministry of Ayush + DIBD (MeitY) = an MoU to strengthen multilingual Ayush digital services
  - AYUSH – Ayurveda, Unani, Siddha, Yoga & Naturopathy, Sowa-Rigpa & Homoeopathy
  - Title of initiative – "BHASHINI Rajyam - A BHASHINI Sahayogi Program"
- Aim: To integrate BHASHINI Platform across various digital platforms & services of Ministry of Ayush
- MoS (I/C) in AYUSH: Jadhav Prataprao Ganpatrao | Constituency – Mehkar, Maharashtra

News - 351

- Tata Electronics + ASML = an MoU to advance India's semiconductor manufacturing ecosystem
  - By deploying ASML's advanced lithography tools & solutions for Tata Electronics' Dholera fab in Gujarat
- ASML will enable establishment & ramp-up of India's 1st commercial 300 mm semiconductor fabrication plant
  - Planned investment – $11 billion
- Tata Electronics is investing Rs 91,000 Cr in semiconductor fabrication facility
- Tata Electronics + PSMC = for semiconductor technologies across 28nm, 40nm, 55nm, 90nm & 110nm process nodes
- HQs of Tata Electronics – Bengaluru, Karnataka | MD & CEO – Randhir Thakur | Chairman – N Chandrasekaran

News - 352

- India + UAE = signed agreements with UAE entities committing $5 billion in investments to India across multiple sectors
  - ISPRL + ADNOC = an MoU to strengthen India's energy security
  - IOCL + ADNOC = Strategic Collaboration Agreement to facilitate new opportunities in sale & purchase of LPG
  - A Framework for Strategic Defence Partnership
  - UAE plans to double its crude oil export capacity by building additional 400km pipeline to Port of Fujairah by 2027
  - UAE entities pledged $5 billion in investments to India including:
    - $3 billion by Emirates New Development Bank (ENDB) in RBL Bank
    - $1 billion by Abu Dhabi Investment Authority (ADIA) with NIIF for priority infrastructure projects
    - $500 million for Samman Capital | $500 million in additional infrastructure investments
- UAE – Abu Dhabi – Dirham | President – Khalifa bin Zayed Al Nahyan

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News - 353

- India + Netherlands = upgraded bilateral ties to a 'Strategic Partnership' during PM Modi's visit to Netherlands
- India + Netherlands = signed 17 agreements & MoUs in areas of "WAH" (water, agriculture & health), renewable energy & critical minerals
- TATA Electronics + ASML = pact to support semiconductor fabrication facility in Gujarat's Dholera
- India + Netherlands = to support MoC between Eindhoven University of Technology and University of Twente & 6 Indian Institutes (IISc Bangalore, IIT Bombay, IIT Delhi, IIT Gandhinagar, IIT Guwahati & IIT Madras)
  - For a brain bridge in semiconductors & related technologies | Supported by – NXP, ASML, TATA & CG Semi

Join us

- Society of Indian Defence Manufacturers + Netherlands Industry for Defence and Security = to promote cooperation between defence industry & research centre
- Netherlands – The Hague – Euro | PM – Rob Jetten

News - 354

- Bharat Forge Ltd + Andhra Pradesh = an MoU to establish India's 1st private-sector Marine Gas Turbine (MGT) Repair, Overhaul & indigenous Development complex at Visakhapatnam
- Andhra Pradesh: Capital – Amaravati | CM – N Chandra Babu Naidu | Governor – Syed Abdul Nazeer
- HQs of Bharat Forge – Pune, Maharashtra | Chairman – Baba Kalyani | Founded in – 1961

News - 355

- M&M + DBS Bank India = an MoU to launch India's 1st sustainability-linked dealer financing programme in automotive sector
- Dealers will be ranked against a set of ESG parameters drawn from Mahindra's 'Green Dealership Programme'
- ESG metrics were jointly designed by – Mahindra & DBS Bank India
- DBS Bank India – named Best Bank for Sustainable Finance in India by Global Finance in 2024
  - It has been recognised as Best Bank for Corporate Banking in India by Crisil Coalition Greenwich in both 2025 & 2026
- HQs of DBS Bank India – Mumbai, Maharashtra | MD & CEO – Rajat Verma

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News - 356

- Tata Power + DGPC (Bhutan) = to build a training framework for developing 5,000 MW clean energy capacity in Bhutan
  - Training programmes will be delivered through – Tata Power Skill Development Institute (TPSDI)
- HQs of Tata Power – Mumbai | Chairman – N. Chandrasekaran | MD & CEO – Praveer Sinha

News - 357

- SAIL's Management Training Institute + MDI Gurgaon = an MoU to collaborate on executive education programmes
  - To develop future-ready leaders within SAIL
- HQs of SAIL – New Delhi | CMD – Dr Ashok Kumar Panda | Founded – January 24, 1973

News - 358

- NISM (SEBI) + IICA (MoCA) = an MoU to strengthen cooperation in corporate governance, ESG practices & capital markets regulation
- HQs of NISM – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman – Tuhin Kanta Pandey | Director – Sashi Krishnan
- HQs of IICA – Gurugram, Haryana | DG & CEO – Gyaneshwar Kumar Singh | Works under – MoCA

Join us

News - 359

- MP + Google = partnered to manage "Simhastha Kumbh" to be held in Ujjain in 2028
  - A Centre for Excellence (CoE) will be set up in Indore
- Simhastha 2028 – scheduled to be held in Ujjain (Mar 27 to May 27, 2028)
- Madhya Pradesh: Capital – Bhopal | CM – Mohan Yadav | Governor – Mangubhai Chhaganbhai Patel
- HQs of Google – California, US | CEO – Sundar Pichai | Founded in – 1998

News - 360

- Maharashtra + NTPC Ltd + RIL + Adani Power + Lalitpur Power Generation = an MoU for nuclear energy generation projects with a combined proposed capacity of 25,400 MW & an estimated investment of ₹6.5 lakh Cr
- Adani Power – proposes a 6,000 MW nuclear power project at Barsu in Ratnagiri | Outlay – ₹1.5 lakh Cr
- RIL – proposes a 7,200 MW nuclear power project at Purnagadh in Ratnagiri | Outlay – ₹2 lakh Cr
- NTPC Ltd – proposes a 7,200 MW nuclear facility at Devgad in Sindhudurg | Outlay – ₹1 lakh Cr
- Lalitpur Power Generation (Bajaj Group) – proposes a 5,000 MW nuclear energy project | Outlay – ₹2 lakh Cr
- Maharashtra: Capital – Mumbai | CM – Devendra Fadnavis | Governor – Jishnu Dev Varma
- HQs of NTPC – New Delhi | CMD – Gurdeep Singh | Founded in – 1975
- HQs of Reliance Industries Ltd – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman – Mukesh Ambani | Founded in – 1973
- HQs of Adani Power – Ahmedabad, Gujarat | CEO – Shersingh B Khyalia | Chairman – Gautam Adani

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News - 361

- British International Investment + Copenhagen Infrastructure Partners = partnered for 300-million-dollar renewable energy platform, "North Star"
- They will each commit up to $150 million for platform
  - To address funding gap required to build & scale renewable projects in India
- It marks 1st investment made through 'British Climate Partners (BCP)', a £1.1 billion climate finance initiative launched by BII in Apr 2026
- HQs of BII – London, UK | Chairman – Diana Layfield | CEO – Leslie Maasdorp | Established in – 1948
- HQs of CIP – Copenhagen, Denmark | Established in – 2012

News - 362

- Ladakh + ONGC = MoU extended for 5 years for setting up India's 1st geothermal power project at Puga valley, Ladakh
  - at an altitude of over 14,000 ft
- Ladakh + LAHDC Leh + ONGC Energy Centre = a tripartite MoU on Feb 6, 2021 (expired on Feb 5, 2026)
- ONGC Energy Centre will deepen existing geothermal well up to 1000 metres during 2026 working season itself
  - It will also drill another geothermal well of 1000 meters in next phase of project
- Testing, evaluation & commissioning of pilot geothermal power plant – expected in FY27

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- Under Phase-II of project, surveys & geothermal investigations will be conducted in Chumathang area
- Proposed pilot power plant – expected to operate at a turbine inlet temperature of ~200 degrees Celsius
  - Targeted generation capacity – 1 MW
- Ladakh: Capital – Leh | Lieutenant Governor – Vinai Kumar Saxena
- HQs of ONGC – New Delhi | Chairman & CEO – Arun Kumar Singh | Founded in – 1956

News - 363

- BIT Mesra (Jharkhand) + NESAC = a 5-year MoU to deepen academic & research engagement in emerging domains
- HQs of NESAC – Umiam, Meghalaya | Director – Dr. S. P. Aggarwal | Established in – 2000

News - 364

- AYUSHEXCIL + Spices Board of India = an MoU to strengthen India's global leadership in traditional wellness & natural products through integrated promotion of Ayush products & medicinal spices
- Aim: To promote global cooperation in Ayush products & medicinal spices
- HQs of Spices Board of India – Kochi, Kerala | Chairperson – Sangeetha Viswanathan | Founded in – 1987
- HQs of AYUSHEXCIL – New Delhi | Chairman – Anurag Sharma | Established in – 2022

News - 365

- Gujarat + Meta = an MoU in Gandhinagar to introduce WhatsApp-based access to government services across state
- Around 20 citizen services from 5 major departments will be integrated into state's 'Sugam Digital Gujarat' platform
- Services will be available through a chatbot in – Gujarati & English
- Gujarat: Capital – Gandhinagar | CM – Bhupendra Patel | Governor – Acharya Dev Vrat
- HQs of Meta – California, US | CEO – Mark Zuckerberg | Founded in – 2004

News - 366

- NSDC + FVCC (Japan) = partnered to strengthen & facilitate workforce mobility opportunities for Indian talent in Japan
- It will leverage 'Credibility Check' framework provided by NSDC Trust
  - To establish a structured & reliable verification mechanism for Indian candidates travelling to Japan through FVCC
- HQs of NSDC – New Delhi | CEO – Arun Kumar Pillai | Chairman – A. M. Naik (works under MoSDE)

News - 367

- India + US = a bilateral framework on sidelines of 11th Quad Foreign Ministers Meeting
  - To secure supply, mining & processing of critical minerals & rare earth elements
- On Feb 20, 2026, India became a signatory to US - led Pax Silica initiative
- Currently, China controls 90% of global critical mineral processing
- US – Washington, D.C. – US Dollar | 47th President – Donald Trump | 50th VP – James David Vance

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News - 368

- TCS + SKF (Swden) = partnership to roll out a next-generation enterprise resource planning (ERP) platform
- TCS will help SKF create a globally connected operating model, combining centralised, AI-enabled systems and harmonised processes with the flexibility to meet local market needs
- HQs of TCS – Mumbai, Maharashtra | CEO – K. Krithivasan | Founded in – 1968

News - 369

- NSE + SUFI = an MoU to develop steel & commodity derivatives ecosystem for price-risk management & better price discovery
- India crude steel production – ~168.4 million tonnes in FY26, up ~11% YoY | projected 300 million tonnes by 2030
- HQs of NSE – Mumbai, Maharashtra | MD & CEO – Ashishkumar Chauhan | Established in – 1992
- HQs of SUFI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Founder President – Nikunj Turakhia | Established in – 2015

News - 370

- RITES Ltd + CRISIL = an MoU to offer integrated, data-driven infrastructure solutions in India & overseas
- It combines RITES' transport infrastructure & engineering consultancy expertise with CRISIL's data intelligence, analytics, research & advisory services
- HQs of RITES – Gurugram, Haryana | CMD – Rahul Mithal
- HQs of CRISIL – Mumbai, MH | Chairman – Yann Le Pallec | MD & CEO – Amish Mehta | Established in – 1987

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